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Hindustan Times

NEW DELHI
TUESDAY
NOVEMBER 03, 2026

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-Chemistry, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1.	**Tender Enquiry No. 220/GATP/Chemistry/20018435 dated 02.11.2026** **"Procurement of Non-Ferric Alum required at GATP Site"** at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **02.11.2026** from **1700 Hrs.** onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GATP-112/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16717

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regn Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003 Telangana, India, CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD C&I, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the work of:

1.	**Tender Enquiry No. 224/GATP/IMD/BTG/20018429 dated 02.11.2026** **"Procurement of Modules for Max DNA DCS System at GATP, GOINDWAL SAHIB."** **Area of 2 x 270 MW Thermal Powe Plant GATP, Goindwal Sahib"** at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02.11.2026 from 1700 Hrs. onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

RO No. 1079/12/2026/27/16716 GATP-111/26

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of The President of India, Deputy Chief Mechanical Engineer (Carriage Works), Kharagpur Workshop, Kharagpur Division, South Eastern Railway invites e-Tender for the following works. **e-Tender Notice No:** LHBUpgradtoIlet-NAC735-R1; **Name of the work :** Up-gradation of toilets of non-AC LIM coaches; **Place of Work:** Kharagpur Workshop, South Eastern Railway, Post Kharagpur, Dist- Paschim Midnapore, Pin-721301; **Quantity:** As per tender document; **Tender Value:** ₹ 84,57,49,301.15 (Rupees Eighty four crore fifty seven lakh, forty nine thousand three hundred one and fifteen paisa only); **Earnest Money:** ₹1,69,15,000.00 (Rupees One crore sixty nine lakh fifteen thousand only); **Contract period:** 48 Months from the date of issue of LOA; **Closing Date and Time of Tender :** at 10/12/2026 15:00 hrs.; **Cost of Tender Document:** NIL; **Bidding System:** Two Packet System; **Are .TV allowed to bid:** Yes; **Number of JAI Member Allowed:** 03; **Pre-Bid Conference required:** Yes; **Pre-Bid Conference Date & Time :** 11/11/2026 11:00 hrs.; **Contract Type:** Works — General; **Tender Type :** Open; **Detail Tender Notice and Tender Document https://www.ireps.gov.in** is available in the e-Portal website **(PR-963)**

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-tender Notice

Divl. Rly. Manager, N.W.Rly. Bikaner for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender for the following works up to 15.00 hours on 20.11.2026 as below: **Tender No:** 190; **Name of Work with its Location: Zone No.4(II)- Zonal Works for Service Building over ADEN/ Line/Bikaner Sub Division for LGH (Ex.)-PLC (Ex.) Section (For 2026-27 & 2027-28).; Approx. Cost of Work:** Rs. 21290907.38; **Earnest Money:** Rs. 425800.00; **Note:** Other terms & conditions will be shown on the website **www.ireps.gov.in** **1575-AM/26**

Please join us on /NWRailways

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-Tendering Tender Notice No. 63/2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.) N.E. Railways Izatnagar for and behalf of President of India invites **"OPEN"** e-tender through Online (E-Tendering) for the following work:- **S.No. 1. Description of works:** Outsourcing for track maintenance Work for one year in jurisdiction of ADEN/PBE Section. (2026-27); **Approx. Value(₹):** ₹3,51,49,295.97; **EMD Money (₹) :** ₹7,03,000/-; **Cost of Tender Forms :** ₹Nil; **Completion time/period from the date of issue of acceptance letter:** 12 Months. **S.No. 2. Description of works:** Outsourcing of track maintenance Work for one year in jurisdiction of ADEN/KPV Section. (2026-27); **Approx. Value(₹):** ₹3,12,23,850.45; **EMD Money (₹):** ₹6,24,500/-. **Cost of Tender Forms :** ₹Nil; **Completion time/period from the date of issue of acceptance letter:** 12 Months; **1.** Online e-tender can be submitted up to **15:00 hrs.** of dated **23.11.2026. 2.** For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways IREPS website **www.ireps.gov.in**

Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.) CPRO/W-399 Izatnagar

DO NOT SMOKE BIDI/CIGARETTE IN TRAINS

COMPREHENSIVE CONSULTANCY SERVICES

Tender Notice No.: CPM-GS-MLG-PC-2026-09. **Dated:** 29-10-2026. E -Tender are invited by the undersigned for the following work. **Tender No.:** CPM-GS-MLG-PC-2026-09. **Name of Work:** Request for Proposal (RFP) for providing Project consultant (PC) for providing 'Comprehensive Consultancy services from the stage of Feasibility Study & DPR preparation for elimination of Level Crossing gates in N.F. Railway by constructing ROB and/ RUB/LHS/Other Structures/ Road Diversion as required including Detailed Design of required components of finalised scheme, Tendering for execution of works as per finalized scheme, Techno-Managerial Consultancy, Processing & Facilitation for land acquisition, Project supervision Services/Project Management Consultancy etc. for execution of work till closure of level crossings/Defect Liability Period of execution contract'. **Tender Value :** ₹129,37,17,978/-; **Date** & time of **closing/opening** at **15:00** hrs. on **23-11-2026**. For complete information and tender document of e-Tender are available in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

CPM/GS/MLG

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NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of work and its location	**120-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27** Electrical Improvement of Staff Amenities including Rewiring of Railway Quarters and Allied Electrical Works under SSE/PS/SP Marg.
Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 23402148.00/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Administrative Block, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 468100.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	25.11.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	25.11.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	**www.ireps.gov.in** & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3839/2026

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Regd. Office: PSEB H.O. Building, The Mall, Patiala
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Contact No.: 96461-18773

TENDER ENQUIRY No.: QO-1354/PO-C&S

Chief Purchase Officer/MM, Central Purchase Organization, PSPCL, 2nd floor, Multistorey Building, The Mall, Patiala, invites e-Tender for procurement of LINEMAN/ALM TOOL KITS (HAND TOOL & SAFETY TOOL KIT) as per tender specification no. QO-1354/PO/C&S. For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 03.11.2026 (11.00 AM) onwards.

NOTE: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1046/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16730

DIRECTORATE Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board

Mandi Bhawan, Rudrapur (U.S.Nagar)
Ph-05944-250056 Fax- 05944-50059
U.K.A.P.M.B/2026-2014 Date: 02/11/2026

Public Information

Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board, Rudrapur is Inviting Auction on Land in DGM(T) Office, Agro Campus Haldwani to be given on lease rent.

Auction of Selected Bidders to be Carried out on 04.11.2026 (Wednesday) from 12:00 pm to 6:00 pm on https://www.procfox.com for further necessary action.

General Manager (Finance)

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall)
Website: www.pspcl.in
(Contact No. 96461-11084)

Tender Inquiry No. 28/Dy. CE/DS/Circle Sangrur/2026-27 Date: 02.11.2026

Dy. CE, DS Circle, Sangrur invites e-tender for the execution of works comprising only labour component for execution of various works such as releasing of T/well connection, deloading of overloaded T/fs, bifurcation of feeders/Erection of new Links, releasing ISC/GSC Connections or any other development work to be executed on labour rates during the year 2027-28 Under DS Division PSPCL Patran. For detailed NIT 7 & tender Specification please refer to **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02.11.2026 from 05.00 PM onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and amendments, if any will be published online at **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1047/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16733

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited

Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India, CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of Spares of Bottom Ash Hopper Feed Gate and Jet Pump which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/ GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1	**Tender Enquiry No. 222/ GATP/MMD/AHP/20018365** **"Procurement of Spares of Bottom Ash Hopper Feed Gate and Jet Pump which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL , Goindwal Sahib"** at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **02.11.2026** from 1700 Hrs. onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GATP-116/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16728

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala)
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website:- www.pspcl.in
(Contact No. 96461-10021)

Tender Inquiry No. 27/Dy. CE/DS/Circle Sangrur/2026-27 Date: 02.11.2026

Dy. CE, DS Circle, Sangrur invites e-tender for the execution of works comprising only labour component for execution of various works such as releasing of T/well connection, de-loading of overloaded T/fs, bifurcation of feeders/Erection of new Links, releasing ISC/GSC Connections or any other development work to be executed on labour rates during the year 2027-28 Under DS Division *PSPCL Dirba.* For detailed NIT & tender Specification please refer to **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02.11.2026 from 12.00 PM onwards.

Note:- Corrigendum and amendments, if any will be published online at **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

RO No. 1079/12/2026/27/16715 C1040/26

Uttar Pradesh Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Pashu Chikitsa Vigyan Vishwavidyalaya Evam Go Anusandhan Sansthan, Mathura (U.P.)-281001

Advertisement No. 04/2026 Date:10/10/2026

RECRUITMENT ADVERTISEMENT-2026

Applications are invited from citizens of India on prescribed form for the post of Dean, College of Veterinary Science & Animal Husbandry, Mathura of the University. For more details please visit university website www.upvetuniv.edu.in from 10 October, 2026 10:00 a.m. Correspondence/queries if any should be addressed to duvasurecruitment@gmail.com. Last date of submission of application form is 23 November, 2026 by 5:00 P.M.

REGISTRAR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Open E-Tender Notice

For & on behalf of the President of India, Chief Workshop Manager, N. Rly. C&W workshop, Jagadhri Workshop/Yamuna Nagar invites **open e-tender** for the following work:

1	**Name of work :** Work of Repair and Maintenance of 13 Nos. Industrial Sewing Machine of Trimming Shop for a period of two years at Northern Railway, Jagadhri Workshop.
2	**Location :** Northern Railway, Carriage & Wagon Repair Shop, Jagadhri Workshop, Yamuna Nagar, Haryana-135002
3	**Tender Value :** Rs. 2,26,560/- Two lakh twenty-six thousand five hundred sixty only.
4	**Quantity :** As per Scope
5	**Cost of Tender form :** Nil
6	**Earnest money amount :** Rs. 4,500/- Four thousand five hundred only.
7	**Completion period of the work :** 24 months from the date of issuance of Letter of Acceptance
8	**Date & Time for submission of tender form :** 23.11.2026 till 15.30 hrs.
9	**Opening of tender :** 23.11.2026 till 15.35 hrs. Tender opening will be done any time after the tender closing time. The tenderers are not required to be present during the opening. Railway reserves the right to open the tender any time after closing of tender.
10	**Website particulars : www.ireps.gov.in**

No.: 6-SI/21/Tender/2026-27/JUDW Dt: 30.10.2026 3825/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Office of the Superintending Engineer, DS Circle, PSPCL, Patiala
66 KV Grid Sub Station Colony, DCW Road, Patiala -147001 (Punjab)
96461-01201, 96461-10963, E-mail: circlepatiala1@gmail.com
Reg. Office: PSPCL Head Office, The Mall, Patiala (Punjab)

Tender Enquiry No. 41/SE/DS Circle, Patiala/2026-27 Dated: 02.11.2026

Superintending Engineer/DS Circle, PSPCL Patiala invites e-tender for Outsourcing of Labour Part for Erection, Testing & Commissioning of New 11KVLT/HTLines on Rail/PCC Poles, Distribution T/Fs, Augmentation/Sagging of ACSR of HT/LT Lines, Cables laying, Guarding, Stay Set for Various Works such as Releasing of T/Well Connections, GSC/ISC Connections, Deloading of Overloaded T/Fs, Shifting of Meters Outside Consumer Premises, Preventive maintenance of HT/LT lines not involving conductor replacement or insertion of extra poles Earthing of DTs/Lines or any Development Works under DS Division Nabha under DS Circle Patiala for F.Y. 2027-28.

For detailed NIT and, Tender Specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **02.11.2026, 06.00 PM onwards.**

NOTE: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at https://eproc.punjab.gov.in

C1043/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16721

DIRECTORATE Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board

Mandi Bhawan, Rudrapur (U.S.Nagar)
Ph-05944-250056 Fax- 05944-50059
U.K.A.P.M.B/2026-2013 Date: 02/11/2026

Public Information

Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board, Rudrapur is Inviting Auction of 01 No Cafe in Agro Campus haldwani to be given on lease rent.

Auction of Selected Bidders to be Carried out on 04.11.2026 (Wednesday) from 12:00 pm to 6:00 pm on https://www.procfox.com for further necessary action.

General Manager (Finance)

North Bihar Power Distribution Company Limited

(Regd. Office : Vidyut Bhawan, Baily Road, Patna)
(Department of Stores & Purchase)
Email- cesnp5.nb@gmail.com

TENDER CANCELLATION NOTICE

Online tender was invited vide EOI/NIT No.- 46/PR/NBPDCL/2026 & 47/PR/NBPDCL/2026 (PR No.-IPRD_PR_011224/26-27) for Empanelment of Manufacturers for Supply of Power and Distribution Transformers in North Bihar Power Distribution Company Limited (NBPDCL) and South Bihar Power Distribution Company Limited (SBPDCL) for all central/state Govt. funded schemes and internal procurement for period of 5 Years.

This Tender is hereby cancelled with immediate effect due to unavoidable reasons.

This information is available on **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar also**

PR. No. 014682 (B&C) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार। **(Abhijeet Kumar)** Chief Engineer (S&P)

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MAHARAJA AGRASEN MEDICAL COLLEGE, AGROHA (HISAR)	COMPREHENSIVE HOUSE KEEPING AND COLLEGE MECHANISED SANITATION SERVICES WITH CLEANING MATERIALS FOR TWO YEARS EXTENDABLE BY ONE ADDITIONAL YEAR SUBJECT TO SATISFACTORY PERFORMANCE COMPLETE IN ALL RESPECTS IN THE PREMISES OF MAMC, AGROHA (HISAR)	29.10.2026 16.11.2026	12,68,000/-	https:// etenders. hry.nic.in	8930200823 ebl@mamc. edu.in
2	MAHARAJA AGRASEN MEDICAL COLLEGE, AGROHA (HISAR)	1.SITC OF EQUIPMENTS OPHTHALMOLOGY 2026_HRY_549026_2 2.INSTALLATION OF ESR ANALYZER FOR PATHOLOGY 2026_HRY_540864_4	30.10.2026 12.11.2026	130 LACS	https:// etenders. hry.nic.in	8930200824 purchase@ mamc.edu.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO NO 13/2027/60/506921/19/7

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH.	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1.	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF VARIOUS IPB AND CC STREETS (ULB_RTK_04551, 04552, 04624, 04635, 04416, 04418, 04415, 04245, 04530, 04531, 02292, 02213) IN WARD-13, MCR + 11 WORKS	30.10.2026 10.11.2026	1,56,64,608/-	https:// etenders.hry. nic.in	9467283967 xenmcrohtak@ gmail.com
2.	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF GATE IN MAL GODAM ROAD, WARD NO. 18, M.C ROHTAK. + 1 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	8,70,740/-	https:// etenders.hry. nic.in	9467283967 xenmcrohtak@ gmail.com
3.	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION ROHTAK	ESTIMATE FOR CLEANING AND MAINTENANCE WORK OF VARIOUS COMMUNITY CENTRES, PEHRAWAR STADIUM AND OTHER STADIUM WITHIN THE LIMIT OF M.C. ROHTAK.	31.10.2026 09.11.2026	40.28 LACS	https:// etenders.hry. nic.in	9467283967 engg-rohtak@ ulbharyana.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO No. 13/2027/60/506940/1/9/7

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

Name of Work with its location	Part-B: Provision of feeder wire for enhancement of existing OHE capacity to cater increasing load requirements of KHV/TSS of DLI Division.
Approx. Cost of work	**Earnest Money Deposit** **Pre-Bid Conference Date & Time**
Rs. 15,31,65,385.89/-	Rs. 30,63,300/- 09.11.2026 (11.00 hrs.)
E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	
11.11.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 25.11.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)	
E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	25.11.2026 15:00 hrs.
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	**www.ireps.gov.in**

E-Tender No.: 30A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated 02.11.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3828/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, NARWANA	SPECIAL REPAIR OF ROAD FROM UCHANA TO JALAB KHERI ROAD IN JIND DISTRICT (ROAD ID 6816) (ODR VT) UCHANA CONSTITUENCY + 1 WORKS	29.10.2026 10.11.2026	1055.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	7599999782 pwdnarwana@gmail.com
2	PWD B&R, KARNAL	WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING WITH WBM PLUS CCP AND 80MM IPB ON KALSAURA DRAIN TO YAMUNA GHAT TO NASEEB SINGH KA KHET (ROAD ID-11110) (ODR) IN KM 0.00 TO 1.750 IN INDRI CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27)	24.10.2026 06.11.2026	240.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, KARNAL	WORK OF 2 NOS ROADS (1) WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING WITH WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC ON TAPRANA TO DARAR ROAD (ROAD ID-11111) LENGTH KM. 0.00 TO 1.360 (2) WIDENING AND STRENGTHENING WITH WBM PLUS 50MM BM PLUS 20MM PC ON GHORGARH TO SIKRI ROAD (ROAD ID-11113) IN KM 0.00 TO 2.000 IN INDRI CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27).	28.10.2026 10.11.2026	246.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, SIRSA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING 30 MM THICK BC AND 50 MM THICK DBM OF ROAD FROM BY-PASS ON ROAD AT GHAGGAR BANDH (EASTERN SIDE) STARTING FROM DABWALI ROAD TO RANIA ROAD (VT) (ROAD ID 10561) BC IN KM 0.00 TO 16.80 IN SIRSA DISTRICT (SIRSA CONSTITUENCY WORK PROGRAM 2026-27)	CLOSING DATE 11.11.2026	926.74 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	01666-220530 pwd-eepd1-sirsa@hry.nic.in
5	SHKM GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR, NUH	TENDER FOR PURCHASE OF QR CODE STICKERS WITH AUTOMATED WASTE COLLECTION SOFTWARE FOR BIO MEDICAL WASTE MANAGEMENT	02.11.2026 15.11.2026	EMD 7171/-	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	01267-282007 tendergmcmewat@gmail.com
6	SHKM GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR, NUH	TENDER FOR PROVIDING CANTEEN SERVICES FOR CAFETERIA AT SHAHEEDHASAN KHAN MEWATI GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR, NUH	02.11.2026 15.11.2026	15.12 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	01267-282007 tendergmcmewat@gmail.com
7	SHKM GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR, NUH	TENDER FOR PURCHASE OF VARIOUS MEDICINE FOR DEPARTMENT OF ORTHOPEDICS, SURGERY AND OBS & GYNAE AT SHAHEED HASAN KHAN MEWATI GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE, NALHAR.	02.11.2026 15.11.2026	3.50 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	01267-282007 tendergmcmewat@gmail.com
8	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	BALANCE WORK FROM REACH RD KM 45.450 TO 58.665 FOR THE WORK OF REMODELING OF AUGMENTATION CANAL FROM RD KM 0.000 TO 75.250	28.10.2026 06.11.2026	284.13 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
9	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	CONSTRUCTION OF VR BRIDGE AT RD KM 33.983 AUGMENTATION CANAL.	30.10.2026 10.11.2026	179.57 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
10	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	BALANCE WORK OF INDRI ESCAPE AT RD 56.00 KM FOR THE WORK OF REMODELING OF AUGMENTATION CANAL FROM KM 0 TO 75.250 IE MERGING POINT WITH WJC MAIN BRANCH. + 2 WORKS	30.10.2026 19.11.2026	3475.08 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	0184-2258008 xeninddivn@yahoo.in
11	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	RECONSTRUCTION OF VR BRIDGE AT RD 4200 OF KAHNI LINK DRAIN + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 10.11.2026	680.41 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9034106126 xenconst21@gmail.com
12	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, MANDI DABWALI	ASA KHERA- DNIT FOR PROVIDING AND LAYING OF 400M I/D RCC PIPE CHANNEL AT VILLAGE ASA KHERA CH. TO. JOTTANWALI:- ESTIMATE FOR AUGMENTATION AND RENOVATION OF WATER SUPPLY SCHEME AND PROVIDING WATER SUPPLY FACILITY IN VILLAGE AND MGGBY COLONY AT VILLAGE JOTTANWALI, DISTT. SIRSA. (DEMAND DURING JAN SAMVAD)' + 1 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	9.95 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	8730000001 ee.mandidabwali@gmail.com
13	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR REQUIREMENT OF KITS FOR MD BIOCHEMISTRY THESIS AT KCGMC, KARNAL.	05.11.2026 16.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
14	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	RESEARCH STUDY KITS & CONSUMABLES REQUIRED FOR PROJECTS UNDER MRU, KCGMC, KARNAL.	05.11.2026 16.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
15	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (DISPOSABLE PATCH, TRYPAN BLUE DYE, BUDS, COTTON WOOL 500GM ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	03.11.2026 10.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9896154463 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
16	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR SUPPLY MEDICINE AND CONSUMABLE (DISPOSABLE SYRINGES 5ML AND UROBAG 01 LTR.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	03.11.2026 10.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9896154463 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
17	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR MEDICAL EQUIPMENT/INSTRUMENT (MCFARLAND DENSITOMETER ETC.) AT KCGMC, KARNAL	05.11.2026 16.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
18	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR MEDICAL INSTRUMENT (K FILES OF DIFFERENT SIZE, H FILES OF DIFFERENT SIZE, ROTARY FILE OF DIFFERENT SIZE, C PLUS FILES, DIAMOND BUR OF DIFFERENT SIZE AND OTHER VARIOUS INSTRUMENT OF DENTISTRY DEPARTMENT) AT KCGMC, KARNAL.	05.11.2026 16.11.2026	EMD 10,000/-	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9992132471 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
19	FOREST DEPARTMENT, SIRSA	REG. PROCUREMENT OF RCC FENCING POSTS AS PER SPECIFICATION AND DRAWING GIVEN SIRSA FOREST DIVISION, SIRSA	CLOSING DATE 04.11.2026	3.54 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	9416067122 forest_sirsa@yahoo.com
20	FOREST DEPARTMENT, BHIWANI	TENDER FOR MAINTENANCE OF HERBAL PARK KAIRU AND TOSHAM	30.10.2026 05.11.2026	21 LACS	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	01664-242430 dfo.bhiwani@yahoo.com
21	HORTICULTURE DEPARTMENT, IHDC HODAL, PALWAL	REGARDING PUBLIC NOTICE FOR E-TENDER (GOODS & SERVICES) RATE CONTRACT FOR MENIAL WORKS FOR VEGETABLES SEEDLING PRODUCTION AND OTHER CENTRE WORKS ON JOB ROLE BASIS" AT IHDC, HODAL (PALWAL) FOR THE YEAR 2026-27.	06.11.2026 16.11.2026	20000	https://etenders.hry. nic.in	7015157607 ddhihdchodal@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO NO 11/2027/420/50729/1/9/7

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH.	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1.	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	CONSTRUCTION OF KITCHEN/STORE IN THE AREA OF ARYA NAGAR COMMUNITY CENTRE IN WARD NO. 42, BALLABGARH. + 12 WORKS	29.10.2026 05.11.2026	2,18,04,166/-	https:// etenders.hry. nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf4@gmail. com
2.	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR REPAIRING OF ROADS THROUGH CEMENT CONCRETE M-25 GRADE AT GALI NO 06.07 22 ROAD. MANJEET WALI GALI FCA 100 WARD NO. 18 FARIDABAD + 15 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	4,67,04,105/-	https:// etenders.hry. nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf4@gmail. com
3.	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR CONSTRUCTION OF BOUNDARY WALL AND GRASSING IN FRONT OF HOUSE NO. 1939, SECTOR 28, WARD NO. 30 DIV-V + 3 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	53,26,142/-	https:// etenders.hry. nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf4@gmail. com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO No. 13/2027/60/50695/1/9/7

Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority

First Floor, Commercial Complex, P-2, Sector Omega 1, Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh 201308
Toll Free No. 1800180829 Website: www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com

Reference Number: YEA/GM(P)/2026/609 Dated: 02/11/2026

Detailed RFP document is available on the E-Procurement Portal of Government of UP [https://etender.up.nic.in/] from **04/11/2026**. The authority seeks Hiring of Design development and Project Management Consultants for Internal Infrastructure Development of Sector 8 and 8D at YEIDA.

Interested Applicants are required to submit their proposal online on the E-procurement website on or before **25/11/2026, 1700 hrs (IST).** In case of any queries, the Bidders are invited to contact on the following email id: gmproj@yamunaexpresswayauthority.com.

GM, Project

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अधिसूचित क्षेत्र में प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्वीकृत मास्टर प्लॉन के अंतिरिक्त प्लॉटिंग / हाउसिंग / कॉलोनी या किसी भी प्रकार का अन्य निर्माण पूरी तरह से अवैध है। सामान्यजन इस प्रकार की खरीदफरोख्त से पूर्णतः सचेत रहें तथा कॉलोनाइजर के भ्रामक विज्ञापनों से बचें। अधिक जानकारी के लिए प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com देखें।

Government of Jharkhand, Department of Industries

3rd Floor, Nepal House, Doranda, Ranchi-834002

NIT No. 2436 Dated 02.11.2026

VERY SHORT RE-TENDER NOTICE

Selection of Logistics Partner

Due to minimum number of bid not received, sealed re-tenders are invited by Director of Industries, Government of Jharkhand for Selection of a Logistics Partner for End-to-End Travel, Accommodation, Transportation and On-Ground Support Services for the High-Level Delegation of Jharkhand at the 31st CII Partnership Summit, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh on 12th-13th November 2026.

S. No.	Particular	Details
1.	RFP/Tender Availability	03/11/2026 10.00 AM
2.	Last date of Submission	07/11/2026 till 03:00 PM
3.	Technical proposal opening	09/11/2026 at 11:30 AM
4.	Technical Presentation Online/ Offline	09/11/2026 at 02:00 PM onwards at the office

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Hindustan Times
FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

CENTRE CAN STEP IN ON AIRFARES IN RARE CASES, SAY NEW RULES

Neha LM Tripathi
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Centre can directly intervene on ticket pricing in extraordinary situations under a new set of aviation rules that also require airlines to disclose cancellation charges and refund conditions separately while displaying airfares to passengers.

The provisions do not introduce a routine cap on airfares or require government approval for every ticket price. Hence, airlines will continue to determine fares in normal circumstances. The new framework does, however, provide for tariff monitoring by the aviation regulator. →P9

3 hrs on 2 days: SC clears green crackers for Diwali

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday allowed the sale and bursting of certified green firecrackers in Delhi-NCR for a limited period around Diwali, permitting their use between 6am and 7am and 8pm and 10pm on November 7 and 8, while making it clear that a complete ban on firecrackers will be restored from November 9.

A bench of justices MM Sundresh and PB Varale said it was opting for a "regulated" approach rather than a blanket prohibition, pointing out that the complete ban imposed earlier had neither significantly improved air quality nor prevented the illegal sale and use of conventional firecrackers. It also noted that the restrictions had repeatedly been flouted, with conventional crackers being sold under the guise of green firecrackers.

AIR WE BREATHE

The court's observation is a damning indictment of Delhi Police, which has proved inadequate to the task of enforcing orders on the sale and bursting of firecrackers.

"Though imposition of a blanket ban seems to be the ideal solution, we are of the opinion that this Court, at this point in time, is short of adequate data to decide whether or not a complete ban would be the best solution to solve the problem of environmental pollution caused by bursting firecrackers."

continued on →8

What the top court said

2 windows to burst fireworks
6am-7am & 8pm-10pm (on Nov 7, 8)

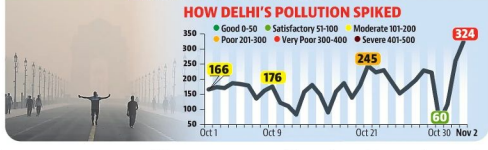
ON BLANKET BANS
"Though imposition of a blanket ban seems to be the ideal solution, we are of the opinion this Court , at this point in time, is short of adequate data to decide whether a complete ban would be the best solution to the problem of environmental pollution caused by bursting firecrackers."

ON REGULATION
"We are inclined to regulate the manufacture, storage, sale and bursting of green firecrackers, instead of maintaining the complete ban for a temporary period..."

ON ENFORCEMENT
The measures undertaken either by the authorities based on the orders of this Court or by their own, have not yielded the desired result... The problem lies in the implementation.

WHAT'S CLEARED
Manufacturers with valid certifications from CSIR-NEERI and PESO can make approved green firecrackers from Nov 2-6. Only products uploaded on CSIR-NEERI's website can be made and sold. Their boxes must be sealed to stop conventional firecrackers from being mixed with them.

HOW DELHI'S POLLUTION SPIKED



Debate in Parl: Shah; Rahul challenges PM

HT Correspondents
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Union home minister Amit Shah on Monday said the government was ready to convene a special session of Parliament and dared the Opposition to debate allegations of vote theft in the House, but Congress leader Rahul Gandhi hit back, challenging Prime Minister Narendra Modi to a public debate.

The separate statements came a day after leaders of the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) came together in Delhi for the largest Opposition mobilisation in recent years, renewing calls for the removal of chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, and saying he will be jailed for treason in the future.

Leading the Bharatiya Janata Party's "Save Democracy, Remove Anarchy" march in Hyderabad, Shah launched a counter-attack on the Opposition and defended the special intensive revision of voter rolls.

"Rahul holds the Constitution

continued on →8

"The West Asia crisis is ongoing. But 140 crore (1.4 billion) Indians take pride in how effectively the nation managed the turmoil... If India had not invested in clean energy and created new systems for this over the past decade, then our crisis could have been much more severe than the rest of the world."
— NARENDRA MODI, Prime Minister

Modi: Future of energy security in clean power

Jasjeev Gandhiok
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday said India's decade-long shift to renewable energy had helped the country sustain high economic growth despite global disruptions, including the Covid-19 pandemic and the West Asia crisis. Inaugurating the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit & Expo 2026, Modi warned that continued over-reliance on fossil fuels would repeatedly disrupt the global economy. He said the future of energy security lay in clean energy. →P10

NCP LEADERS MEET SHAH WITHOUT SUNETRA, PARTH, FUEL SPECULATION

Faisal Malik
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: A group of senior Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) leaders met Union home minister Amit Shah in Delhi late on Sunday, said people aware of the matter, triggering further speculation of turmoil within the regional party that failed to win a single seat in the recently concluded Maharashtra legislative polls. The party denied any internal rift, saying the meeting – which happened in the absence of deputy chief minister Sunetra Pawar and her son, MP Parth Pawar, according to an official statement by the NCP – was a pre-arranged, formal engagement. →P10

Grap 2 in effect as Delhi AQI becomes 'very poor'

Saloni Bhatia and Paras Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi's air quality deteriorated sharply for the fourth consecutive day on Monday, pushing the city into the "very poor" category for the first time this season and prompting the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) to invoke Stage 2 of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) across the National Capital Region (NCR).

The city was enveloped in a thick haze less than a week before Diwali, when firecracker emissions could further worsen pollution levels.

Delhi recorded an air quality index (AQI) of 324 at 4pm on Monday, 63 points worse than Sunday's 261, but a staggering 264-point deterioration from Friday, when the AQI was 60 in the "satisfactory" category. Monday's reading was the worst in 271 days, since February 4, when the city recorded an AQI of 339. →P4

MESS AT BORDERS CONTINUES AMID VEHICLE CHECKS

Gargi Shukla, Arun Singh, Debashish Karmakar and Vidhi Bhutra
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI/NOIDA/GURUGRAM: The first weekday of Delhi's drive to keep out vehicles registered outside the Capital that do not meet BS-VI emission standards triggered major traffic snarls in Gurugram and at the UP Gate-Ghazipur border on Monday, even as enforcement remained patchy at several entry points from Noida and Ghaziabad. →P4

Before retiring, ex-air chief asked govt not to take over IAF's Sports Complex

Rahul Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: On October 26, days before his October 31 retirement, Air Chief Marshal AP Singh urged defence minister Rajnath Singh to protect the Indian Air Force's control of prime land within the Race Course Air Force Station, near the Prime Minister's residence, citing operational imperatives and the facilities located there, a senior official familiar with the matter said, requesting anonymity.

The letter came against the backdrop of the ministry of housing and urban affairs reclaiming a sprawling sports complex within the station. The reclamation has been controversial in defence circles, and even forced the cancellation of a farewell for the outgoing Air Chief.

The defence ministry spokesperson did not respond to calls for comment. →P5

Realise investor anxiety, will consider feedback, says FM

Rajeev Jayaswal
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Ahead of the Union budget, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday acknowledged investor concerns amid changing circumstances and said the government will consider the need to deepen and widen equity and bond markets while keeping its focus on trust-based taxation, ease of compliance and new-age skilling to generate employment.

Asked whether the budget would roll out a red carpet for foreign portfolio investors, Sitharaman said she understood the sensitivity and anxiety among retail investors and equity market participants. She pointed out that the taxation structure had been similar in 2023-24, when India recorded its highest inflows.

"Nothing differently was done for drawing investments. But, of course, the situation is very different now," she said. →P16

Nirmala Sitharaman

SEBI'S LTCG PROPOSAL, RELIANCE SURGE LIFT MARKETS NEARLY 2%

A rally in Reliance Industries shares and growing optimism over a possible rollback of long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax for foreign investors gave Dalal Street plenty to cheer about on Monday, lifting both benchmark indices nearly 2%. Markets regulator Sebi has recommended scrapping LTCG tax for foreign investors as India seeks to revive its underperforming equity markets, Reuters reported. Sebi has also proposed an LTCG exemption for mutual fund investors who sell existing holdings to reinvest in other funds. →P16

Kimi Antonelli, 20, is youngest F1 champ ever

Mercedes's Kimi Antonelli is hoisted aloft by Red Bull's Max Verstappen (left) and Ferrari's Lewis Hamilton after being crowned F1 champion. The 20-year-old is the youngest F1 champion ever, beating the record held by Sebastian Vettel, who became champion aged 23 in 2010. →P2,18 REUTERS

SC stops monitoring probe into donation theft at Ram temple

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday ended its monitoring of the investigation into the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya after the Uttar Pradesh government informed it that a charge sheet had been filed against eight accused, while allowing petitioners to assist the trial court in the proceedings in view of the public interest involved.

A bench, comprising Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, directed the jurisdictional judicial magistrate to proceed with the case in accordance with the law, making it clear that its order should not prejudice any party since it expressed no opinion on the merits of the allegations.

"Since there is an element of public interest involved, liberty is granted to the petitioner to assist the court of judicial magistrate as the law enables the victims of crime to also assist the court," stated the bench in its order, disposing of the writ petition and connected matters.

The order came after solicitor general (SG) Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Uttar Pradesh government along with additional advocate general and senior counsel Sharan Dev Singh Thakur, informed the bench that the investigation had been completed and a charge sheet filed. Mehta said the probe traced the alleged theft during the counting of donations to the bank accounts and property purchases of those involved.

"Theft was done at the time of counting and those counting were stealing. Although the recorder can have recordings up to 45 days, we traced it back to their bank accounts and purchase of properties, including land etc. There has been an audit as well. All artefacts and donations have been accounted for," Mehta told the bench.

The eight accused are Avinash Shukla, Anukalp Mishra, Lavkush Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey, Rama-

continued on →12

THE ORDER CAME AFTER U.P. GOVT TOLD THE BENCH THE PROBE HAD BEEN COMPLETED AND A CHARGE SHEET FILED

THREE PUNJAB MLAs JOIN BJP IN SETBACK TO AAP AHEAD OF POLLS

Ravinder Vasudeva
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHANDIGARH: Three AAP legislators in Punjab joined the BJP on Monday, as more strains emerged within the state's ruling party. The development came two days after the AAP released its first list of 40 candidates for the 2027 assembly polls. None of the three MLAs — Harmeet Singh Pathanmajra, Chetan Singh Jouramajra and Kunwar Vijay Pratap Singh — were named in the list. →P10

State regulator didn't propose the rule that froze Tata Trust board

mint

Nehal Chaliawala, Varun Sood and Satish John
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI/BENGALURU: The Maharashtra Charity Commissioner did not propose the rule that has paralysed Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), the second-largest shareholder in Tata Sons, for nearly six months. The rule that resulted in the suspension of the trust's board proceedings was introduced by the state government and invoked by the commissioner on 15 May this year, as per the public trusts regulator's office.

In response to a Mint query under the Right to Information Act, 2005, the charity commissioner's office said it had sent no proposal to the state's Law and Judiciary Department regarding the Maharashtra Public Trusts (Amendment) Ordinance, 2025.

Promulgated on 1 September 2025, the ordinance capped the number of perpetual trustees at one-fourth of a public trust's total board strength, where its trust deed does not specifically provide for their appointment. The earlier law did not prescribe such a numerical cap.

"In the above context, it is hereby informed that no proposal has been submitted by the Charity Commissioner, State of Maharashtra to the state's Department of Law and Justice," the commissioner's office said on 15 October in a response to the Mint RTI query.

continued on →8

Tata trustee says won't opt for reappointment

Varun Sood and Satish John
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU/MUMBAI: Senior Supreme Court lawyer Darius Khambata has chosen not to seek another term as a trustee of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, the two principal Tata Trusts, and termed "astounding" the Tata Sons directors' rebellion against Tata Trusts chair Noel Tata, which he said is 'a day that will live in infamy'. →P16

STATES UP SAFETY STEPS IN WAKE OF CYCLONE MURASU

HYDERABAD/CHENNAI/BHUBANESWAR: Thousands of people have been relocated to safer areas in Odisha and at least 19 domestic flights have been cancelled in Andhra Pradesh as the eastern states are bracing for a fresh severe cyclone within a week after very severe cyclone Arnab lashed the states, even as some parts received heavy rain on Monday. According to IMD, cyclone Murasu is expected to make landfall early Tuesday. →P10

Imran apologises, HC lets him stay in India

Karuna Nidhi
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Bombay High Court on Monday allowed actor Imran Khan, a US citizen and an Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholder, to continue staying in India after he tendered an "unconditional apology" for his alleged participation in a protest against the special intensive revision of electoral rolls.

The HC was hearing a petition filed by the actor challenging the Foreigners Regional Registration Officer's Leave India Notice issued to him on October 15. The HC said OCI cardholders are "at the mercy of the country and cannot live here and criticise it." →P10

{ VOTING TODAY }

Republicans, Democrats set midterm closing arguments as Michigan rift roils Senate race

US President Donald Trump speaks at a midterm campaign rally in Dubuque, Iowa. REUTERS

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump closed out the final weekend of a turbulent midterm campaign with rallies in two states he has handily won in the past while Democrats began to fracture in Michigan, risking their effort to retake the Senate.

With more than 54 million votes already cast, the trips reflect the Republican Party's defensive posture as the elections become a referendum on Trump's White House second term.

They are a reminder of how starkly the political environment has changed since Trump's last campaign. In 2024, he worked to flip states that had previously backed Democrat Joe Biden in 2020. This year, Trump has focused largely on states he has dominated before as voters, including previous supporters, question the economic fallout of his decision to impose tariffs and launch the war in Iran.

Polls show Democrats are all but certain to take the majority from Republicans in the House of Representatives in Tuesday's vote and have a real shot at winning the Senate. →P15

KILLED CHEETAH WHILE HUNTING BOAR: 2 ARRESTED ACCUSED TO COPS

Shruti Tomar
letters@hindustantimes.com

BHOPAL: The Madhya Pradesh Special Task Force has arrested two brothers for allegedly shooting dead a 19-month-old cheetah outside the Kuno National Park, and recovered the licensed double-barrel gun, police said on Monday.

The accused, Bhagwan Singh and Pritam Singh, on October 24 had gone to the forest to hunt a wild boar when they spotted the cheetah. Bhagwan fired at it, police said. The two have been booked under the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 (Amended 2022). →P13

8 ELECTROCUTED, 5 INJURED DURING RAJASTHAN ROAD CONSTRUCTION

Pulkit Bhardwaj
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JAIPUR/JHUNJHUNU: Eight workers were electrocuted and five others sustained burn injuries after a concrete mixer came into contact with an overhead power line during road construction in Rajasthan's Jhunjhunu, police said. The incident triggered a protest by villagers, who alleged the electricity department and administration had ignored warnings about low hanging power lines. →P13

{ MY INDIA } FOREIGN SECRETARY

Misri in UAE: Focus on trade, energy ties

Foreign secretary Vikram Misri met the leadership of the United Arab Emirates (UAE) during a two-day visit, with the focus on ramping up economic engagement and strategic cooperation with one of India's closest partners in West Asia. Misri, who was in the UAE during November 1-2, held talks with Reem Al Hashimy, the minister of state for international cooperation and UAE's special envoy for India in Abu Dhabi to review the strategic bilateral partnership across sectors and to explore new avenues of cooperation, the external affairs ministry said on Monday. They also exchanged views on regional and global developments. He also met Mohamed Khalifa Al Mubarak, chairman of the department of culture and tourism of Abu Dhabi. HTC

{ MY INDIA } DIWALI CAMPAIGN

Mayor lashes out over BMC's Dia Mirza video

Mumbai mayor Ritu Tawde on Monday lashed out at actor Dia Mirza over her participation in the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation's (BMC) firecracker-free Diwali campaign, saying she did not need to tell Hindus how to celebrate their festival. Tawde also reprimanded the BMC administration for including Mirza in the campaign, saying the decision was taken without consulting the civic body's elected political leadership. "Her selective agenda is becoming increasingly evident," Tawde said. In response, Mirza questioned "why should anyone be critical of a video that the Bombay High Court and BMC made me record in the public interest?". →P10

{ MY INDIA } NO CASUALTIES, SAY POLICE

Fire breaks out at HPCL facility in Andhra's Vizag

A fire broke out at the Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL) refinery in Gajuwaka industrial area in Andhra Pradesh's Visakhapatnam late on Monday night, police said, adding that no casualties were reported. "The fire is believed to have erupted at the sulphur pitch tank of the refinery's Residue Upgradation Facility (RUF) within the HPCL refinery premises. The tank caught fire, resulting in eruption of flames and thick smoke," Malkapuram inspector of police Prakash Rao said. Locals said they had heard sounds of an explosion in the area, but police have not confirmed it. "Flames quickly spread to nearby areas, sending thick clouds of black smoke into the sky and engulfing the surrounding locality," an employee of HPCL said. HTC

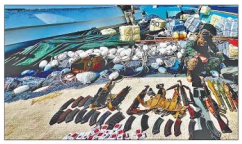
{ SPORT } SETS NATIONAL RECORD

India bags first Youth Oly swimming medal

Dhinidhi Desinghu on Monday slapped the touchpad, lifted her goggles and looked up at history. The 16-year-old became the first Indian swimmer to win a medal at the Youth Olympic Games. The Bengaluru teen won bronze in the 100m freestyle final in Dakar with a timing of 56.27secs, a national record. It bettered her own previous record – 56.57s – set at the Senior National Championships in June. The gold and silver went to Croatia's Ana Bobanovic and New Zealand's Alyssa Lawson, respectively. Earlier in the day, Dhinidhi topped her heat clocking 56.80s, becoming the first Indian female swimmer to make the Youth Olympics final. →P18

{ MY INDIA } SEIZED BY SOMALI PIRATES

Navy saves Iran crew from hijacked vessel



The Indian Navy coordinated a 48-hour operation to rescue all 20 crew members of Iranian fishing vessel Azini on Monday, officials said. It was seized by Somali pirates on October 29. The operation was carried out 3,000km from Mumbai in the Arabian Sea. Defence minister Rajnath Singh congratulated the navy for the "meticulously coordinated operation." "The swift localisation, interception and safe release of the crew and vessel from significantly armed pirates, with timely support from the Indian Air Force, speak well of the Indian Navy's high operational readiness and ability to respond decisively to maritime threats across the region," Singh said. The Azini was hijacked between Bandar Bayla and Hafun in northeastern Somalia. HTC

India-made generic of HIV-prevention shot gets FDA nod

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LOUISVILLE (US): The US Food and Drug Administration has approved an India-made generic version of the world's only twice-a-year shot to prevent HIV — a big step toward making the drug available inexpensively and more quickly in 120 low- and middle-income countries.

The announcement was made on Monday by the manufacturer and organisations that helped to speed up development of the medication, called lenacapavir.

The generic was developed by Dr. Reddy's Laboratories under an agreement brokered by Unitaid, the Clinton Health Access Initiative and Wits RHI, a health research institute in Africa. The partners sought to accelerate development and make the drug available at an affordable price.

The drug is expected to cost US$40 a year per person in the countries where it will be available, the same price as daily preventive pills available now. But the shots are much more convenient than the pills because they're needed much less frequently and they nearly eliminated new infections in two groundbreaking studies of people at high risk.

People don't always take their daily dose of medication, "and if you do not take it, you cannot get protected against HIV," said Carmen Perez Casas, HIV lead for the grant-making organisation Unitaid, a global health agency. "With lenacapavir, we are much more hopeful."Ultimately, advocates said, the medication should help drive down cases of HIV and AIDS — and deaths. According to the WHO, 41 million people worldwide were living with HIV and 570,000 died from HIV-related causes last year. With an affordable, high-quality generic medication now available, "we could help to scale this to the 20 million people around the world who need PrEP," prescription medicine taken by people at risk of HIV before being exposed to the virus, said Carolyn Amole, who leads the HIV programme for the Clinton Health Access Initiative, a global health organisation.

"And if we scale to those levels," she added, "we can actually begin to bring an end to the HIV epidemic."Generic lenacapavir can't be sold in US because a brand-name version, Yeztugo, made by Gilead Sciences and approved last year, is still protected by a patent. The US list price for that version, meaning the cost before insurance, is US$28,218 a year.

The new generic was approved by FDA under a longstanding practice designed to ensure the quality of HIV-related drugs provided to other countries by the US government. The approval is considered "tentative," the FDA's standard designation for generics while the originator remains under patent. Until now, Gilead has been the sole supplier of lenacapavir. Generic lenacapavir should start to become available in some places within weeks, those helping with the effort said, although it could take a bit longer in countries that require the drug to go through their own approval processes.

Ice loss locked in even at 1.5°C, say reports

Two reports from the International Cryosphere Climate Initiative (ICCI) and UNEP, released ahead of COP31 in Türkiye, say significant, irreversible ice loss is already under way at current warming of around 1.4°C — By Jasjeev Gandhiok

WHAT IS THE CRYOSPHERE?

The UN's Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) defines the cryosphere as all regions on and beneath the surface of the Earth and ocean where water is in solid form, including sea ice, lake ice, river ice, snow cover, glaciers and ice sheets, and frozen ground (which includes permafrost).

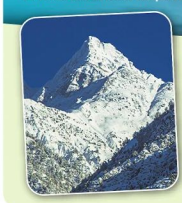
ICE SHEETS AND SEA LEVEL

At a constant 1.5°C, ice loss would continue for millennia, the State of the Cryosphere 2026 report says. Past temperatures at this level coincided with sea levels around 2-9 metres higher, owing to loss of parts of the West Antarctic, Greenland and possibly East Antarctic ice sheets. The best case is that this rise unfolds over centuries to millennia, giving coastal communities time to adapt or relocate.

THE THRESHOLDS

The 'Overshoot and the Cryosphere: Averting Global Meltdown' report says Greenland's threshold for long-term ice loss could be crossed well below 2°C, possibly closer to 1.5°C. Parts of West Antarctica could be vulnerable at lower temperatures still.

1°C
The "safe" limit for stable polar ice sheets lies



MOUNTAIN GLACIERS

More than half of the world's glaciers, by number, could face extinction even without temperatures exceeding 1.5°C. Around one-third of glacier ice in the Hindu Kush Himalaya and Central Asia could disappear. In the Caucasus, Scandinavia, Iceland and the North American Rockies, only 18-35% of 2020 ice will remain after several centuries.

IMPACT ON THE HIMALAYAS

In the Alaknanda basin, Uttarakhand, one of the Ganga's two main headwaters, glaciers are thinning and detaching, leaving ice perched on steep slopes. Research cited in the report puts exposure to hazards from such hanging glaciers in the Ganga headwaters at nearly 20 times higher today. The reports cite the Rasuwa disaster in Nepal in August as an example of rising cryosphere-linked risk.

WHAT'S THE ROUTE BACK?

Even the most ambitious plausible action would see temperatures peak at around 1.7°C for about two decades, then fall below 1.5°C by 2100 and below 1°C by 2150. This requires net zero by 2050 followed by sustainable carbon drawdown. The reports call for emissions cuts of at least 5% annually, a rapid fossil-fuel phaseout and cuts in methane and black carbon. Returning below 1.5°C could let some glaciers and sea ice begin recovering over decades to centuries.

Source: ICCI/UNEP, Overshoot and the Cryosphere; State of the Cryosphere 2026

Lewis, Max and Kimi: The weight of a photograph

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NEW DELHI: Lewis Hamilton took one side and Max Verstappen the other, and on the podium in Mexico City on Sunday they lifted a 20-year-old onto their shoulders. Kimi Antonelli had finished third in the race, enough to make him world champion, and the two men holding him up had 11 titles between them.

At 20 years and 68 days, Antonelli is the youngest champion in Formula 1's history. Sebastian Vettel, who held the record before him, was 23 when he won his first title in 2010.

"I will definitely frame the picture and put it in my house," Antonelli said afterwards.

The picture *(carried on page one)* will hang on a wall in his house, but it also belongs to a much older gallery. Since his karting days in Bologna, Antonelli has carried a heavy label: generational talent. Formula 1 hands the label out rarely and takes it back often. The few drivers who have kept it earned it in different ways, and the parameters of what makes a generational talent changes depending on whose career you put the label against.

Hold it against Ayrton Senna's and it means a single lap, driven at the outer edge of what a person and a car can do together. At Monaco in 1988, Senna took pole position 1.4 seconds clear of his McLaren teammate Alain Prost, a gap that made no sense in identical cars. He later said he had felt as if he was driving in a tunnel, beyond conscious control, and the feeling frightened him enough that he backed off. He led the race by nearly a minute — a minute is stupendously long time in F1 — then crashed at Portier with about a dozen laps left and walked back to his apartment without a word to the team. Brilliance and fallibility belonged to the same afternoon.

A ruthless streak

With Michael Schumacher, the word means will, applied without pause for over a decade. He arrived at Ferrari in 1996, joining a team that had not produced a drivers' champion since 1979. He won his first race for them that June in Barcelona, in rain so heavy that much of the field could barely keep their cars on the circuit. Then he spent four years building the team around himself, with Jean Todt, Ross Brawn and Rory Byrne, until the titles came in a run of five, from 2000 to 2004. In the last of those seasons he won 13 of 18 races.

PICK OF THE DAY

His ruthlessness had a darker edge, in the collision with Damon Hill at Adelaide in 1994 and the swerve into Jacques Villeneuve at Jerez in 1997, which cost him every point he had scored that season. He finished with 91 wins and seven titles, and for years both numbers looked permanent.

Hamilton's version of greatness is writ large in the numbers that define his career, the numbers that eventually overtook Schumacher's. He drew level on seven titles in 2020, and that same season, at Portimao, he won for a 92nd time and moved past the German. He now has 106 wins and 105 pole positions. In his debut season in 2007, alongside the reigning double champion Fernando Alonso at McLaren, Hamilton finished on the podium in each of his first nine races and turned the most experienced driver in the team into the junior partner. He led the championship with two races left and eventually finished one point behind. A year later, in only his second year, much like Antonelli now, he took the championship.

What followed was longevity, the hardest kind of greatness to see because it accumulates slowly.

Hamilton won six titles in seven seasons in the turbo-hybrid era that began in 2014. He lost an eighth on the last lap at Abu Dhabi in 2021, in circumstances he has never quite been allowed to forget, and then left Mercedes for Ferrari to make room for the teenager he was lifting up on Sunday. At 41, he won in Barcelona this season and finished second in Mexico City.

Verstappen came to his greatness the other way round, with everything early and all at once. He won on his Red Bull debut in Spain in 2016, at 18, and became the youngest race winner in the sport's history. Later that year, in the rain at Interlagos in Brazil, he climbed from 16th to third in the closing laps, finding grip where other drivers found none – and in a car that was far from the best. He raced hard enough to make enemies and precisely enough to keep winning, and from 2021 he won four titles in a row. In 2023 he won 19 of 22 races. Last year, with a car that was no longer the best, he clawed back a deficit of more than 100 points and lost the title by two, a defeat that showed his talent as clearly as any of his wins.

So the club Antonelli joined on Sunday is not a tidy one. Its members share little beyond the ability to do things in a racing car that others cannot.

Kimi Antonelli (centre) celebrates with Red Bull Racing's driver Max Verstappen (left) and Ferrari's driver Lewis Hamilton at the Hermanos Rodriguez racetrack in Mexico City. AFP

How Antonelli got here

A year ago, almost nobody would have put Antonelli forward for it. Mercedes had chosen him to replace Hamilton, no less, and through much of 2025 he looked like a driver who had been promoted too soon. There were flashes of what he could do, including a first podium in Canada, but the season was full of errors, and he scored less than half the points of his teammate George Russell. He later admitted he had doubted himself. The first race of 2026 promised more of the same. He crashed heavily in practice in Australia and finished behind Russell.

In China, he passed Hamilton at the start and simply drove away from him, from Russell and from Charles Leclerc. He became the second-youngest race winner in F1 history. Holding back tears, Antonelli could barely speak on that day. Then he won the next four races as well.

Over 2026, bad luck played its part against George Russell, but the Briton too could barely bounce back from the series of setbacks. Unlike Antonelli. Car problems in Barcelona, where Hamilton won, and a Russell victory in Austria cut Antonelli's lead. At Silverstone, with the bodywork around his left-front wheel damaged so badly that he could barely turn into corners, he ignored the team's pleas to retire and nursed the car on in pursuit of a single point. A penalty for running off track took even that away, but the stubbornness told Mercedes something about him.

At Monza, two years after crashing there on his first F1 weekend (he drove Russell's car for a test in free practice), he started 19th and by lap 17, he was in lead. No Italian had won the Italian Grand Prix in 60 years, and no driver had won from that far back since 1983. He ate spaghetti from the trophy. "For me personally, I'm not even thinking about a fight or a comeback or anything," Russell said afterwards, and with that, the title fight was effectively over.

By the time the circus reached Austin, Red Bull and Ferrari had caught Mercedes on pace, and the car had become skittish after its latest upgrades. Russell could not make it work and finished eighth, Antonelli took pole and controlled the race from the front, keeping Verstappen and Leclerc behind him. Toto Wolff called it probably the best race he had seen from his driver.

The numbers tell the rest. Antonelli began the season without a win in Formula 1 and has now won nine races. He has stood on the podium 16 times, five more than Verstappen, the next best. He has 380 points, 119 clear of Verstappen with three rounds left. His nine wins are one more than the four drivers behind him -- put together. Those four, Verstappen, Hamilton, Russell and Leclerc, are separated by just 16 points, from 261 down to 245. Antonelli is more than seven times that distance ahead of all of them.

Seen in context, the achievement looks larger.

Foregone conclusion

In 2025, Antonelli scored less than half of Russell's points. This season, in the other Mercedes, he has 130 more than Russell, three times as many wins and twice as many podiums. Had the gap between them stayed where it was in 2025, this would probably have been a season-long fight between Russell and Hamilton, who are nine points apart, a fight between Mercedes and Ferrari. Instead, Russell has slipped to fourth, behind Verstappen and Hamilton, and the championship belonged to one driver for most of the year.

He drained the jeopardy out of it so thoroughly that it has not always been thrilling to watch, and that is the measure of how well he drove. Antonelli kept winning after Mercedes lost its advantage, and he kept scoring when his car and his luck turned against him.

Hamilton is 41 and Verstappen is 29. Antonelli will still be 20 when next season begins. At 20, Hamilton was racing in the Formula 3 Euroseries and was two years from his first grand prix win. Antonelli already has nine wins and a world title. Hamilton once reached Schumacher's numbers, and if anyone on the grid is to reach Hamilton's, the likeliest candidate is the driver with the most years ahead of him. On Sunday the two greatest drivers of their era carried him on their shoulders, and from March they will be trying to catch him.

{ FIRECRACKERS SOLD OPENLY ACROSS DELHI }

'Everything is available': City markets flout rules

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NEW DELHI: Sharp pops and deafening bangs echoed through the narrow lane opposite Gate No. 3 of Jama Masjid in Chandni Chowk on Monday as shopkeepers enticed customers, demonstrating the various firecrackers – most of which were illegal – available for purchase. Across markets in the Capital, firecrackers are being openly sold days ahead of Diwali. It raises questions about enforcement, accountability and the meaning of environmental restrictions in a city where the air quality index has already started plummeting ahead of what is likely to be yet another spell of winter toxic air.

On Monday, the Supreme Court allowed the sale and bursting of certified green firecrackers in Delhi-NCR for a limited period around Diwali, noting that a complete ban had repeatedly been flouted, with conventional crackers being sold under the guise of green firecrackers.

The court's observation was a damning indictment of Delhi Police, which has proved inadequate to the task of enforcing orders on the sale and bursting of firecrackers.

However, a spot check by HT on October 22 and on Monday, showed firecrackers being sold openly in major markets such as Sadar Bazaar, Shastri Nagar, Chandni Chowk, Jama Masjid, Sarojini Nagar and New Friends Colony. Vendors displayed products labelled "green crackers", "pollution-free" and "zero pollution", while other firecrackers were available on request, often from nearby warehouses or concealed stocks.

Delhi Police said they are intensifying efforts to catch as many offenders as possible. Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP) (north) Niharika Bhatt said, "In the last 12 days (since Dussehra), we have lodged more than 13 FIRs and seized 1,200 kgs of firecrackers. We have taken out operations at Lahori Gate, Chandni Chowk, Burari, Kotwali area, Bara Hindu Rao area and Subzi Mandi area. We have also sent out pleas to residents and traders to not burst crackers during this time..."

Hawkers sell crackers near Jama Masjid police station in New Delhi on Monday, days ahead of the permitted sale window. RAJ K RAJ/HT

'Everything is available'

In Chandni Chowk, more than 20 carts were lined up displaying a variety of firecrackers, from sparklers to poppers. At one stall, Naimuddin said he usually sells vegetables but had shifted to selling firecrackers during the festive season.

"I sell firecrackers meant for children only, for just six to seven days during Diwali," he said, stationed at the entrance of Dariba Kalan's silver jewellery market, barely 10 metres from the Jama Masjid police station.

"We don't sell fountains, spinners, rockets, and other bigger bombs. But if you want, you can check Sadar Bazaar. Everything is available there," he told HT.

Even though five to six shops in the same lane run by families that have been in the firecracker business for over two generations have been permanently shut, one of the owners, seated outside, said, "Come back after 6pm; all the firecrackers will be available then."

Street vendors in the market told HT their carts have been present in the lane since October 20. The various carts were seen stacked with multiple layers of colourful firecracker boxes. Nearly all the crackers appeared to contravene the regulations even on selling green crackers. While most boxes lacked QR codes to help verify that a firecracker is a certified green cracker, a few that contained the codes redirected users to online catalogues of firecrackers. Yet others had QR codes that were too small to be scanned.

To be sure, the court's directions only allow manufacturers holding valid certifications to manufacture approved green crackers between November 2 and 6. Furthermore, the sale will be permitted only through designated locations. Online sales have been prohibited.

To ensure that consumers can distinguish genuine green crackers from conventional products, the bench mandated product-specific QR codes on every box. It also prohibited the manufacture of "laris" as well as crackers containing barium.

But, on the ground and in the market, neither sellers nor buyers appeared particularly concerned about adherence to rules.

In another Old Delhi market, Sadar Bazaar, firecrackers of all kinds — both conventional and green — were being sold openly.

"For kids, I bought a small popper and sparklers. I am waiting for spinners and fountain bombs which the shop guy has gone to bring from the warehouse," said Himanshi Anand Jain, who purchased crackers worth ₹2,500.

A seller, requesting anonymity, told HT that his daily sales typically range between ₹2 lakh and ₹2.5 lakh, rising to as much as ₹4 lakh a day or two before Diwali. "Online deliveries are risky, so we prefer to take orders only when the sale of firecrackers is permitted," he said.

However, a street vendor selling firecrackers next to him said he was already accepting orders, subject to two conditions: a minimum order value of ₹5,000, and that buyers would have to bear risks associated with delivery.

"No matter which part of Delhi you reside in, I will send crackers. I have already received calls from more than 100 people for online delivery. But have asked them to wait till November 6," the street vendor said.

Enforcement in residential areas not feasible: Cops

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NEW DELHI: Delhi Police said that it was taking action against vendors in popular markets and people who are bursting crackers out in public spaces. While it is taking action when it receives information, patrolling inside residential areas and finding violators, police said, was not possible, even though, days ahead of Diwali prohibited firecrackers are being sold and used rampantly across the Capital

On Monday, as the Supreme Court allowed the sale and bursting of certified green firecrackers in Delhi-NCR for a limited period around Diwali, it noted that previous restrictions had failed due to lack of enforcement.

In north Delhi, where areas like Chandni Chowk, Lahori Gate, Burari and nearby markets are flooded with fire crackers, police said they are intensifying efforts to catch as many offenders as possible.

"In the last 12 days (since Dussehra), we have lodged more than 13 FIRs and seized 1,200 kgs of firecrackers. We are complying with the orders and based on our own enforcement drives and PCR calls, we have taken out operations at Lahori Gate, Chandni Chowk, Burari, Kotwali area, Bara Hindu Rao area and Subzi Mandi area. We have also sent out pleas to residents and traders to not burst crackers during this time," said deputy commissioner of police (DCP) (north) Niharika Bhatt.

In DCP (northwest) Akanksha Yadav also said that the teams in the district were taking strict measures to enforce the ban on firecrackers. "In the last 15 days, we have registered eight cases against those selling crackers illegally and over 3,000 kg of crackers have been seized."

For outer north, DCP Shobhit Saksena said that four cases have been registered under the Explosives Act and eight persons have been arrested. "Between October 1 and November 2, 2,878kg of firecrackers have been seized and several drives are yet to be conducted."

In outer Delhi, the Delhi Police said more than 2,100kg of banned firecrackers were seized and three vendors were arrested in a single day two weeks ago.

Though there is no collective data, police response appeared not to capture the scale of the issue.

A spot check by HT on October 22 and on Monday, showed firecrackers being sold openly in major markets such as Sadar Bazaar, Shastri Nagar, Chandni Chowk, Jama Masjid, Sarojini Nagar and New Friends Colony. Vendors displayed products labelled "green crackers", "pollution-free" and "zero pollution", while other firecrackers were available on request, often from nearby warehouses or concealed stocks.

Police said while it was taking action against vendors where possible, it was difficult to track people who burst crackers deep inside residential areas.

"We will respond to every call that comes regarding the bursting of firecrackers. So far, we have registered seven cases against those selling firecrackers illegally and recovered more than 1,700 kilograms of firecrackers," said DCP (east) Rajeev Kumar.

In Shahdara, DCP Rajendra Prasad Meena said one case has been lodged in the last three days. "Our staff is being asked to do patrolling and conduct checks around residential areas and markets," he said.

In the west, DCP Hareshwar V Swami said no major incidents had been reported.

{ NIGHT TIME CLEANING }

MCD hires 2k workers, triggers union protest

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has hired 2,000 sanitation workers for three months on an outsourcing model to increase the presence of field workers for night time cleaning and the winter pollution season, said senior municipal functionaries. The move has however triggered objection from the sanitation workers union who accused it of increasing the number of contractual workers, instead of creating more permanent posts.

The union staged a symbolic protest at the Civic Centre on Monday, opposing the privatisation of these appointments. They also held a meeting with Mayor Pravesh Wahi. The union has demanded that all existing daily-wage and temporary sanitation workers currently employed by the corporation be regularised.

Furthermore, they have called for the cancellation of the appointments of the 2,000 contractual workers. In a letter to the chief minister, the union threatened to hold a protest in Shalimar Bagh near the CM's residence.

"This hiring has been carried out to ensure that the larger markets and railway can be cleaned and night time cleaning can be introduced at a larger level. This is just a one time hiring for 89 days and it will not be extended," said an MCD functionary.

The mayor said MCD intends to regularize 3,000 sanitation workers in a phased manner in the coming days. He explained that the 2,000 temporary workers were hired in light of Diwali and concerns over air pollution. HTC

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Honda (Mahavir Enclave) - 9650415522; (Dabri) - 9212670291; (Bijwasan) - 7290068240; (Rajapuri) - 9212670292; (Kapashera) - 7290068238; **EAST DELHI:** Rajindra Honda (Shahdara) - 9310457400; (Dilshad Garden) - 9818372386; (Bhajanpura) - 7042024650; (Karawal Nagar) - 9810833961; (Ill Pusta) - 9560734814; (Johripur, Shiv Vihar Metro Station) - 9311957772; Swarup Honda (Vikas Marg) - 9810806600; (Mayur Vihar Ph-III) - 9717099729; (Kondli) - 9717099726; (Pandav Nagar) - 9717099723; Celebrate Honda (Jagatpuri) - 8130547053; (Jheel) - 9821707756; (Khichripur) - 9871481114; **NORTH DELHI:** Globus Honda (Azadpur) - 8826993152; (Rani Bagh) - 8826993157; (Pitampura) - 8130093651; (Zakira) - 8130093650; (Burari) - 8826993156; (Jahangirpuri) - 8130093655; (Libaspur) - 8130093656; (Prashant Vihar) - 8130093654; Rohini Honda (Sector 3) - 8882201000; (Rithala) - 8527479000; (Budh Vihar) - 8527724000; Santoshi Honda (Narela) - 8467085731; **BALLABGARH:** Kabir Honda - 9625268154; **GAUNCHI BALLABGARH:** Kabir Honda - 9717967717; **FARIDABAD:** Pick Up Honda - 9873875500; Regent Honda - 9311485006; Faridabad Honda - 8130515558; **GREATER FARIDABAD:** Pick up Honda - 9873820000; **GURUGRAM:** Big Swing Honda (Sohna Road) - 9773548833; Ganpati Honda - 9910894235; Yume Honda - 9818250011; Malwa Gurugram Honda - 9311980996; **BADSHAMPUR:** Big Swing Honda - 9773548844; **CHAKKARPUR:** Big Swing Honda - 9355990083; **KHANDSA ROAD:** Malwa Gurugram Honda - 9289223507; **PALAM VIHAR GURUGRAM:** Ganpati Honda - 9910894234; **GURUGRAM RAILWAY ROAD:** Ganpati Honda - 9910894233; Yume Honda - 9650186777; **SEC-52 GURUGRAM:** Yume Honda - 8130364222; **SEC-82 GURUGRAM:** Ganpati Honda - 9220309621; **MANESAR:** Ganpati Honda - 9910894239; **PATAUDI:** Yume Honda - 8222840011; **HAYATPUR:** JSS Honda - 9992539657; **FARUKH NAGAR:** JRV Honda - 9211298103; **NUH:** Sri Madhav Honda - 8708512346; **HODAL:** Mukund Honda - 8168971032; **PALWAL:** Parashar Honda - 7056575100; **SOHNA:** Sohna Honda - 9812872333; **GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR:** Parkash Honda - 9999806883; Pioneer One Honda - 8130788666; Pioneer One Honda (Sec-58) - 8130968666; Pioneer One Honda (Noida City Center) - 8130788666; Parkash Honda (Bhangel) - 7838474152; P.S. Honda (Dadri) - 9811669969; Bhagat Honda (Jewar) - 9711716890; National Honda (Chapraula) - 7042351351; **GHAZIABAD:** JKM Leela Honda - 9999767614; Hindon Honda - 9910110017; Sangam Honda (Sahibabad) - 9311051166; Om Honda (Loni) - 9312254126; Hindon Honda (Modinagar) - 08449790925; Chauhan Honda (Muradnagar) - 9897088340; JKM Leela Honda (Vijaynagar) - 8750324000; SD Honda (Kadrabad) - 7520320611; Shri Vashu Honda (Niwari) - 8445334455; Sangam Honda (Khoda Colony) - 9540651166; BK Honda (Premvihar) - 9311114333; **GREATER NOIDA:** Parkash Honda - 9971992604; Pioneer One Honda (Gaur City) - 7838950960; Shanti Honda (Kulesra) - 9582823843; Khanna Honda (Surajpur) - 9810203519; Republic Honda (Kasna) - 8368861995; **BULANDSHAHR:** Shri Masha Honda - 7351489999; Sri Ganga Honda (Anoopshahr) - 9719524751; KLA Honda (Khurja) - 7078677972; Agarwal Honda (Dibai) - 9412563721; Veer Honda (Shikarpur) - 9758097121; Shri Bhagirathi Honda (Jahagirabad) - 9927544326; Al Uzair Honda (Gulaothi) - 9997729105; **JHAJJAR:** Shree Shyam Honda - 8607200651; **ROHTAK:** Lohchab Honda - 8684888804; Shri Krishna Honda - 9896655630; **SAMPLA:** Rama Honda - 8684840808; **GOHANA:** Shirin Honda - 9053922215; **SONEPAT:** Triumph Honda - 9254015907; **CHOTU RAM CHOWK (SONEPAT):** Triumph Honda - 9254015901; **GANNAUR:** Triumph Honda - 9254015908; **KUNDLI:** Triumph Honda - 9254015904; **BAHALGARH:** Triumph Honda - 9034015921.
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Grap-2 kicks in as city sees season's 1st 'very poor' day

Saloni Bhatia and Paras Singh
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NEW DELHI: Delhi's air quality deteriorated sharply for the fourth consecutive day on Monday, pushing the city into the "very poor" category for the first time this season and prompting the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) to invoke Stage 2 of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) across the National Capital Region (NCR).

The city was enveloped in a thick haze less than a week before Diwali, when firecracker emissions could further worsen pollution levels.

Delhi recorded an air quality index (AQI) of 324 at 4pm on Monday, down 63 points from Sunday's 261, but a staggering 264-point deterioration from Friday, when the AQI was 60 in the "satisfactory" category.

Monday's reading was the worst in 271 days, since February 4, when the city recorded an AQI of 339 ("very poor").

CAQM, in a statement on Monday, said that its Grap sub-committee reviewed the air quality situation, along with forecasts from the India Meteorological Department (IMD) and the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), and decided to invoke Stage 2 to prevent further deterioration.

"The air quality index (AQI) has further increased owing to unfavourable meteorological conditions. The forecast ... has also predicted AQI to remain 'very poor' in coming days," the commission said in a statement.

Under Stage 2, the Delhi government and NCR state governments have been directed to stagger office timings for government and municipal employees in Delhi and the districts of Gurugram, Faridabad, Ghaziabad and Gautam Buddha Nagar.

Other measures include higher parking fees to discourage private vehicle use and ensuring resident welfare associations (RWAs) provide electric heaters to security staff to prevent open burning. These measures are also part of Delhi's winter action plan, which came into effect on November 1.

According to Delhi traffic police, a total 8,263 vehicles were checked, 37 challaned, two impounded, and 1,228 returned in border checks on Monday.

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) announced 20 additional weekday train trips from Tuesday, taking the total number of additional trips across its network to 40. The move is aimed at encouraging commuters to use public transport, it said.

Of the 58 monitoring stations for which data was available, 39 recorded "very poor" air quality and three reported "severe" air. Jahangirpuri was the most polluted, with an AQI of 442.

An AQI between 301 and 400 is classified as "very poor", while readings above 400 fall in the "severe" category.

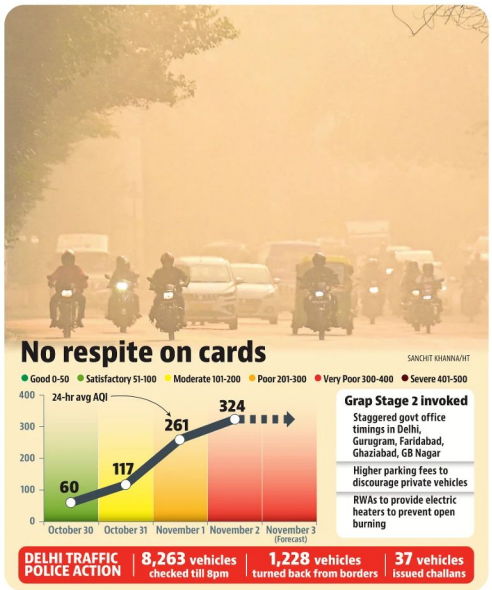
The worsening air comes as stubble burning in the neighbouring states gathers pace. NASA satellite data detected 1,394 farm fires in Punjab and Haryana between October 1 and November 1 — 1,249 in Punjab and 145 in Haryana. Of these, 171 were recorded on November 1. The corresponding count over the same period last year was 1,861. The actual number of fires could be higher, as the satellite passes over the region at around 1.30pm and may miss subsequent burning, officials said.

Meteorologist Navdeep Dahiya said stubble burning in Punjab and Pakistan was intensifying, with northwesterly winds carrying smoke plumes towards Punjab, Haryana, Delhi-NCR and Uttar Pradesh. Relatively calm winds and the landlocked geography of the northern plains were also contributing to the pollutants, he said.

Dahiya warned that air quality across the region could deteriorate further, with the first "severe" AQI reading possible within three days. Smog was likely to intensify during night and morning hours, he said, advising people, particularly children and the elderly, to limit outdoor exposure.

The Air Quality Early Warning System forecast that Delhi's air would remain "very poor" on Tuesday and from November 3 to 5, with conditions likely to range between "poor" and "very poor" over the subsequent six days.

Weather conditions are also expected to remain unfavourable for dispersal. IMD said Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 29.5°C on Monday, one degree below normal, and a minimum of 16.4°C, 1.1 degrees above normal. Shallow fog was reported at Safdarjung airport, where visibility fell to 800 metres between 6.30am and 7.30am.



Long snarls on NH-24 on Monday due to heavy weekday traffic and vehicle checks. ARVIND YADAV/HT

Vehicle emission checks choke some city borders

Gargi Shukla, Arun Singh, Debashish Karmakar, and Vidhi Bhutra
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DELHI/NOIDA/GURUGRAM: The first weekday of Delhi's drive to keep out vehicles registered outside the Capital that do not meet Bharat Stage-VI (BS-VI) emission standards triggered major traffic snarls in Gurugram and at the UP Gate-Ghazipur border on Monday, even as enforcement remained patchy at several entry points from Noida and Ghaziabad.

On the Delhi-Jaipur Expressway, slow movement near Samalka led to a nearly five-kilometre-long tailback stretching up to Moulsari Avenue in Gurugram by Monday evening, police said. At the UP Gate-Ghazipur border, heavy weekday traffic and vehicle checks caused brief snarls. While at Noida's Chilla border, random checks led to a queue stretching around 1.7km, smaller entry points such as New Ashok Nagar and Anand Vihar saw few or no checks.

At the DND flyway, constable Khem Chand said that between 8am and 12.30pm, four vehicles were turned back for not meeting BS-VI standards, while five motorists were challaned for expired PUCCs.

Chand said police had asked the MCD toll staff at DND to alert them about vehicles violating the restrictions. But officers said stopping vehicles on busy roads was difficult without causing congestion. "There is no space to stop vehicles apart from the main road," a constable at another entry point said.

Manjit Pratap, 25, a Noida resident working for an online delivery platform, was stopped at DND on his two-wheeler.

"I was on my way to Gurugram to deliver an order worth ₹453. I was unaware of the checks, and now officials have asked me to pay ₹10,500 because my PUC certificate expired a month ago."

Thin deployment at some borders

At Noida's Chilla border and DND toll plaza, only three to four Delhi Traffic Police personnel were seen conducting checks. A constable at Chilla claimed 30-35 vehicles from Noida had been turned back, but said the volume of traffic made it difficult to check every vehicle.

The checking led to a queue of around 1.7km at Chilla. Noida police personnel said they had asked Delhi counterparts to ease checks when traffic built up. A senior Noida traffic police officer said Delhi Police had sought assistance but questioned how state police could stop vehicles when the restriction had not been imposed in Uttar Pradesh.

Day 2 of Gurugram congestion

In Gurugram, Monday's snarls followed severe congestion on the same stretch on Sunday, when intensive checks left commuters stranded for hours. Police said barricades and checking teams at Sirhaul toll plaza, along with a bottleneck near Samalka, peak-hour office traffic, and the festive rush, contributed to the tailback.

Assistant commissioner of police (Gurugram traffic headquarters) Satyapal Yadav said teams had been deployed on the Delhi-Jaipur expressway, MG Road, Old Delhi-Gurugram Road and Dwarka Expressway.

Police were coordinating with their Delhi counterparts to regulate traffic, he said.

AIR WE BREATHE

Smog caused by farm fires that evaded satellites

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NEW DELHI: Smoke from farm fires in Punjab and Haryana drove the sharp rise in Delhi's pollution on Sunday, which pushed the air into the "very poor" range on Monday, an HT analysis of air-quality, weather and satellite data has found. Most of the fires were lit in the evening, after the Nasa satellite whose count is the standard measure of stubble burning, had passed over the region.

According to the latest CAQM monitoring report on Monday, more than 500 farm fires were reported in the previous 72 hours, with Punjab recording 1,514 farm fire incidents as of November 1.

Meanwhile, Delhi's air quality index (AQI) rose from 117 on Saturday to 261 on Sunday. By Monday morning the Central Pollution Control Board's (CPCB) hourly reading had crossed 300, the threshold for "very poor" air. Monday's 4pm bulletin put the index at 324, the season's first very poor reading. The last "very poor" reading this year was on February 11.

The weather in the run-up was poor, with little wind and a still night. But Delhi had the same weather on October 18 and 28, and the air on those nights was far cleaner. The clearest measure is PM2.5, the fine particles that do the most harm because they reach deep into the lungs.

India's limit for PM2.5, averaged over a day, is 60 micrograms per cubic metre of air. On the night of November 1, from 10pm to 6am on Monday, it averaged 194, more than three times that limit. On the October nights it averaged 68 and 127.

Same weather, dirtier air

HT compared November 1 with every night this season on three measures from the India Meteorological Department's (IMD's) weather balloon and the Safdarjung airfield: how well the afternoon wind cleared the air, how strong the dawn inversion was, and how still the night was. The inversion is a lid of warm air that stops air near the ground from mixing upwards.

On October 18 and 28, all three were as bad as on November 1, or worse. Both nights were calm, and the lid was at least as strong. Yet the air on November 1 night held nearly three times as much PM2.5 as on October 18, and about half as much again as on October 28. See chart 1

Not a rebound from rain

Rain on October 29 and October 30 washed the air, and the air quality index fell to 60 on Friday.

The index is an average of the past 24 hours, so once those clean hours dropped out of it, the index would have risen anyway. The hourly readings, however, show that by the morning of November 1 the air was about as dirty as on the morning of October 28.

The two days diverged after that. And November 2 just carried forward the trend.

The pollution came in by day

On a bad morning in Delhi, pollution trapped overnight hangs low over the city. As the sun warms the ground, the air starts to churn, the pollution spreads upward, and readings at street level fall. Pollution from the city's own traffic, trapped overnight, thins out this way. On October 28, PM2.5 fell by nearly two-thirds by mid-afternoon. On October 18, it fell by more than half. On November 1, it did not fall at all: it was slightly higher in the afternoon than in the morning.

Readings hold steady only when the air higher up is as dirty as the air at street level, or when dirty air is blowing in. Either way, the extra pollution on November 1 came from outside Delhi.

It had begun to show a day earlier. Around midday on October 31, PM2.5 nearly doubled in three hours, the sharpest midday rise this season. It stayed high into Monday morning.

The extra pollution was also made up of the finest particles. On the night of November 1, they made up nearly six-tenths of all the particulate matter in the air by weight, against just over four-tenths on the October nights. Smoke is mostly fine; road and construction dust is coarse. See chart 2

The fires Nasa's count misses

The count most often quoted for stubble burning comes from a Nasa satellite that passes over Punjab once a day, at about 1.30pm. Farmers no longer burn at that hour. More than 90% of large fires in Punjab in 2024 and 2025 were lit after 3pm, against 3% in 2021, according to the Stubble Burning Status Report 2025 by IFOREST, a New Delhi research group.

HT checked this against geostationary satellites, which stay over the same spot and scan the region through the day. They see in coarser detail than Nasa's satellite and pick up only large or intense fires, but they show when the burning happens. Last season, 99% of the fires India's INSAT-3DS satellite spotted in Punjab and Haryana were burning after 3pm.

This season, INSAT-3DS saw almost no evening fires from October 15 to 28 – but that could be because INSAT-3DS is better at detecting large fires, and often misses the smaller ones. The count has climbed day after day, from 17 on October 29 to 90 on November 1. Because it sees only the bigger fires, far more fields burned than it counted.

Nasa's count also rose, to 171 on November 1, the season's highest. But through October it did not rise and fall with Delhi's air.

On October 18 and 28 it recorded more than 100 fires each day, yet Delhi's afternoons on both days were cleaner than usual for the season. The difference lay in the wind. See chart 3

The air had crossed the fires

The winds that carry pollution over long distances, a few hundred metres to a kilometre or two up and known as transport-level winds, blew from the north-west on the afternoons of October 31 and November 1, according to the Safdarjung balloon readings. That is the direction of the fire belt. On October 28 they blew from the south.

HT also used wind data from two global weather models to trace where the air reaching Delhi had been over the previous three days.

On November 1, it had spent most of that time over Punjab and Haryana, passing over dozens of fires that the satellites had spotted in the day before. On October 28, it came in from the east, away from the fire belt, and passed few fires. On October 18, it crossed Punjab, but before the evening burning had begun, and the city stayed comparatively clean. See chart 4

What the data cannot show

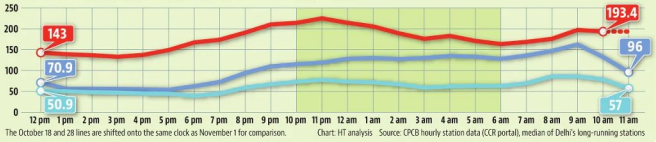
HT's analysis cannot measure how much of the November 1 pollution was smoke. The damp air left behind by the rain may also have played a part, because humid air helps some gases turn into fine particles. Humidity was above 90% on the nights of October 31 and November 1, against 76% on October 28. But it was just as humid on October 31 as on November 1, and the afternoon air on November 1 was far dirtier.

Nasa's count for the season so far is about a quarter lower than last year's for the same dates. Most burning now happens after its satellite has gone, so the lower count says little about whether fewer fields burned. INSAT's count of evening fires was still rising on November 1.

CHART 1

Same weather, far dirtier air: PM2.5 on three calm nights

PM2.5 hour by hour, micrograms per cubic metre, noon to 11am the next day. All three nights had poor dispersal, a strong dawn inversion and calm air. Night (10pm–6am) averages: November 1, 194; October 28, 127; October 18, 68.

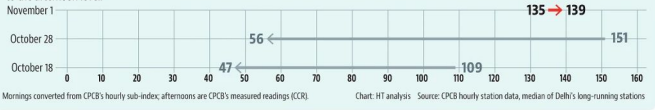


The October 18 and 28 lines are shifted onto the same clock as November 1 for comparison. Chart: HT analysis Source: CPCB hourly station data (CCR portal), median of Delhi's long-running stations

CHART 2

The afternoon cleared the pollution on October 18 and 28; on November 1 it did not

PM2.5, micrograms per cubic metre. As the sun warms the ground, mixing usually thins the morning's pollution. Arrows run from the morning level to the afternoon level.



Mornings converted from CPCB's hourly sub-index; afternoons are CPCB's measured readings (CCR). Chart: HT analysis Source: CPCB hourly station data, median of Delhi's long-running stations

CHART 3

Evening fires seen by India's INSAT went from almost none to 90 in four days

Farm fires in Punjab and Haryana, October 12-November 1, 2026. NASA's satellite sees the fields once a day; India's INSAT-3DS sees the evening, when most burning now happens. The two satellites count differently, so their numbers are not comparable.

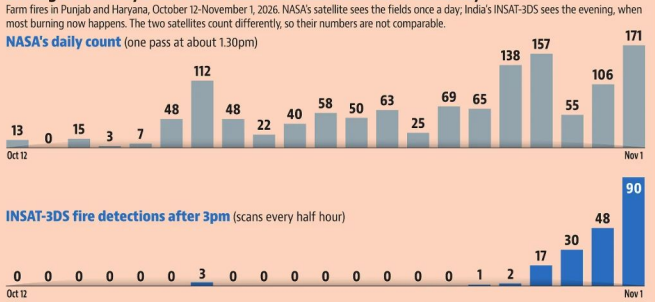


Chart: HT analysisSource: NASA FIRMS (VIIRS S-NPP), ISRO MOSDAC INSAT-3DS (Data Source MOSDAC/SAC/ISRO)

CHART 4

Sunday's air came down through Punjab's evening fires; on 28 Oct it missed them

Where the air reaching Delhi at 2pm had been over the three days before, about 800 m up, with the fires detected in those days.

Air's path, GFS model ECMWF model
NASA fire, 1.30pm pass INSAT fire detection after 3pm

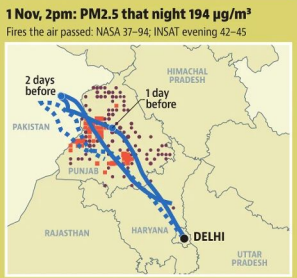
Fires in Punjab and Haryana in the 72 hours before each arrival. Fires the air passed: within 30 km of its path, up to a day before.

28 Oct, 2pm: PM2.5 that night 127 μg/m³

Fires the air passed: NASA 2–12; INSAT evening none

1 Nov, 2pm: PM2.5 that night 194 μg/m³

Fires the air passed: NASA 37–94; INSAT evening 42–45



72-hour back-trajectories at 925 hPa, GFS and ECMWF IFS winds via Open-Meteo; NASA FIRMS (VIIRS S-NPP), ISRO MOSDAC INSAT-3DS, Data Source MOSDAC/SAC/ISRO; state outlines DataMeet (CC BY 4.0). HT analysis

{ AIR FORCE SPORTS COMPLEX } AT RACE COURSE AIR FORCE STN

Outgoing IAF chief asked Centre to help retain control of land

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NEW DELHI: On October 26, days before his October 31 retirement, Air Chief Marshal AP Singh urged defence minister Rajnath Singh to protect the Indian Air Force (IAF)'s control of prime land within the Race Course Air Force Station, near the Prime Minister's residence, citing operational imperatives and the facilities located there, said a senior official familiar with the matter, requesting anonymity.

The letter came against the backdrop of the ministry of housing and urban affairs (MoHUA) reclaiming a sprawling sports complex within the station. The reclamation has been controversial in defence circles, and even forced the cancellation of a farewell for the outgoing air chief.

The defence ministry spokesperson did not respond to calls for comment.

The Air Force Sports Complex (AFSC), located within the Race Course Air Force Station established in the 1940s, was closed to members last month until further notice amid the government's move to reclaim land allotted to IAF, as first reported by HT on October 28.

In his letter regarding the transfer and regularisation of MoHUA land at the Race Course Air Force Station (or Air Force Station, New Delhi), AP Singh wrote that it is prudent for the land housing the AFSC to remain under IAF's control, a second official tracking the matter said, asking not to be named.

The land in question is spread over about 40 acres.

MoHUA hasn't spelt out a reason for the reclamation, but the move is in keeping with its efforts to take back large parcels of land in the vicinity of the Prime Minister's residence such as the Gymkhana Club and the Jaipur Polo Ground.

AP Singh also highlighted the station's multifaceted role, including the administrative support it provides to Air Headquarters and more than 5,000 personnel, the second official added. Its premises house accommodation for married and unmarried personnel, training areas for airmen and Agniveervayus, security infrastructure, recreational facilities, a medical centre, a school and a unit-run canteen, AP Singh wrote.

The sports complex holds a range of facilities, including a golf course, guest cottages, a swimming pool, a fitness centre and restaurants. Its abrupt closure forced the cancellation of Singh's farewell golf event, scheduled for October 28, raising questions over the timing of the Centre's move, also first reported by HT. A "golfing-out" is usually planned for outgoing chiefs in their capacity as patron-in-chief of the golf course.

IAF has also informed the defence ministry that the Race Course station is entrusted with countering unmanned aerial system (UAS) threats during various activities coordinated by the Delhi Integrated Air Defence Centre (DIADC), said a third official, requesting anonymity.

The Land and Development Office (L&DO), which comes under MoHUA, has completed a survey of the sports complex which is no longer is use. AP Singh urged the defence minister to direct the authorities to hand over the land to the IAF, saying the matter should be reconsidered, the officials said.

In his first public comments after taking over as 29th IAF chief on Sunday, Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit said "the training, professional excellence, morale, safety, welfare and dignity" of all air force personnel will have his "personal attention". Dixit is expected to take the matter forward now, the officials added.

06 Hindustan Times My De

Air Force Sports Complex near PM's residence closed

'Until further notice'

Delhi HC rejects plea seeking 250-cr

HT had reported last week that the Air Force Sports Complex on Lok Kalyan Marg was closed to members, leading to the cancellation of a farewell golfing event for outgoing IAF chief Air Chief Marshal AP Singh

Tracing the station's evolution

IAF historian Anchit Gupta traced the station's history and its evolution over the decades.

The air force's association with Race Course goes back to the Second World War when parachutists were training at the neighbouring Willingdon airport from 1941, and Royal Air Air Force (RAF) Station, New Delhi, was established in 1942, he said. In September 1947, the Royal Indian Air Force (RIAF) created No. 10 Administrative Wing here, amid the enormous reorganisation brought about by Independence and Partition. The air force was known as RIAF from 1945-50.

"It brought under one administrative umbrella an unusual collection of establishments, including the Signals Centre, No. 1 Radar Unit, the Record Office, Central Accounts Office and medical services. Its importance lay in being the administrative nerve centre supporting Air Headquarters and IAF, managing everything from personnel records, accounts and medical support to security, accommodation, transport and the movement of airmen between postings," Gupta said.

That remains a central part of the station's role today.

What makes its early history particularly interesting is how quickly it became involved in events of national importance, Gupta noted.

Just five days after its formation on September 1, 1947, communal riots erupted in Delhi. Its personnel patrolled affected areas, installed floodlights and loudspeakers in refugee camps, and helped accommodate some 900 airmen and 150 families arriving from stations in Pakistan, he said.

"The station provided transport and logistical support during the 1947-48 Kashmir war. Even during the 1971 war, the station had an unusual role, housing 15 Pakistani Air Force prisoners of war, including Flight Lieutenant Pervaiz Mehdi Qureshi, who subsequently became Chief of the Pakistan Air Force," Gupta added.

CHINTELS GETS PERMISSION TO DEMOLISH TOWER AT PARADISO

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GURUGRAM: The Municipal Corporation of Gurugram (MCG) has declared Tower J of the Chintels Paradiso residential complex in Sector 109 "dangerous", and directed the developer to demolish the structure in three months at its own cost, risk and responsibility.

Tower J is the sixth of the nine towers to receive clearance for demolition. Five towers — D, E, F, G and H — have already been demolished.

In an order issued on October 30, MCG commissioner Pradeep Dahiya directed Chintels India Pvt Ltd to engage a competent, technically qualified agency for the demolition and comply with all statutory and safety requirements before commencing work. The order follows the developer's request to the district authorities for permission to demolish the tower.

"In pursuance of the above issuance of Tower-J being dangerous building, M/s Chintels India Pvt. Ltd., being the owner/developer, is hereby directed to demolish the entire structure of Tower-J through a competent and technically qualified demolition agency at its own cost, risk and responsibility," it read.

Invoking Section 265(2) of the Haryana Municipal Corporation Act, 1994, the civic body said the tower was in a ruinous and structurally unsafe condition.

The order cited a structural assessment by IIT Delhi that found the tower unsafe for habitation. A district-level committee that examined the assessment also recommended its demolition. It also referred to an incident on January 12, 2024, when a portion of a balcony in Tower J collapsed, underscoring concerns about the building's structural safety.

MCG has directed the developer to install barricades and fencing around Tower J, display warning boards, restrict unauthorised entry and deploy security personnel round the clock.

Before beginning demolition, the company must obtain MCG approval for its construction and demolition (C&D) waste management plan, register on the corporation's C&D waste portal and comply with the applicable waste management rules.

JN Yadav, vice-president of Chintels, confirmed that the company had received permission to demolish Tower J.

"All safety and pollution norms will be followed during the demolition of the structure," he added.

DIRECTORATE
Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board
Mandi Bhawan, Rudrapur (U.S.Nagar)
Ph:05944-250066 Fax: 05944-50059
U.K.A.P.M.B/2026-2019 Date: 02/11/2026

Public Information

Uttarakhand Agriculture Produce Marketing Board, Rudrapur is developing Kishan Bazar Shops on land located in Mandi Samiti Tanakpur has already published information to give on lease rent.

Applying process and other related information (map, number of shops etc) and conditions may be seen on https://www.procfox.com from 03.11.2026 on 12:00 noon to 12.11.2026 till 5:00 pm.

Interested persons and firms may visit at https://www.procfox.com for further necessary action.

General Manager (Finance)

मध्यांचल विद्युत वितरण निगम लिमिटेड
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता (सा०प्र०– प्रथम), 4–ए, गोखले मार्ग, लखनऊ

ई–निविदा सूचना MEDCO / 4025 / 2026, पत्रांक : 1220 दिनांक: 02.11.2026	
कार्य का नाम: Third Party Inspection – 5000 Mandays	
ई–निविदा प्रपत्र शुल्क : रू0 7,080	धरोहर राशि: रू0 1.90 लाख
ई–निविदा की अन्तिम तिथि: 25.11.2026, 16:00 बजे	

विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रपत्र वेबसाइट https://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है अग्रेत्तर समस्त सूचनायें वेबसाइट पर ही प्रकाशित की जायेगी।

{ ACTIVISTS FLAG MP PROBE }

After row, Delhi govt drops NGO from 1st state wildlife board

Jasjeev Gandhiok
jasjeev.gandhiok@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government's announcement of its first-ever State Board for Wildlife (SBWL) on Monday has drawn controversy, prompting it to remove prominent wildlife NGO Wildlife SOS from the panel after activists questioned its inclusion amid an ongoing investigation in Madhya Pradesh into alleged links to wildlife trafficking.

Delhi environment and forest minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa told HT late on Monday that the NGO would be dropped from the board and its association with the Delhi government's forest department would end immediately. A formal order will soon be issued, he said.

"The proposal to include it as a member of the State Board for Wildlife was moved in February 2026, and the final proposal went to the Competent Authority for approval in July 2026. It has now come to our knowledge that some cases were made in August 2026 in MP relating to the NGO's alleged involvement in a wildlife crime," Sirsa said.

"There will be no compromise on protecting wildlife," he added.

Wildlife SOS's proposed inclusion was questioned by Madhya Pradesh-based activist Ajay Dubey, who wrote to the Delhi government alleging that it violated sub-section (l)(g) of Section 6 of the Wildlife (Protection) Act. He said the provision mandated the inclusion of NGOs and individuals with proven credentials, expertise and an unblemished record in wildlife conservation.

The Madhya Pradesh State Tiger Strike Force (STSF) is investigating alleged links between the NGO and the seizure of 10 leopard skins on the Gwalior-Agra highway in July. Two suspects, Bhagwan Singh and Wasim Akram, associated with the NGO, had also alleged the involvement of its CEO, a charge Wildlife SOS has refuted.

"We hope that decisions concerning this matter will be guided by verified facts and due process, rather than allegations that are yet to be established," a statement issued by the Wildlife SOS read.

NW Delhi: Man hits wife with hammer, arrested

NEW DELHI: A 30-year-old man has been arrested for allegedly attacking his wife with a hammer, repeatedly striking her on the head over suspicion of an extramarital affair in northwest Delhi's Wazirpur village in the early hours of Sunday, police said. The woman's condition is critical, they added.

Police said Sanjay Kumar, a mason, lives with his wife and two children in Wazirpur village. He was allegedly drunk when the incident took place.

The landlord, Akash Yadav, told police that Kumar approached him crying on Saturday night and said that his wife was planning to get him killed. He then returned to his room, locked the door and started assaulting the woman.

Kumar allegedly continued attacking his wife even after she fell, and pressed his foot against her neck, police said. "She sustained multiple head injuries," a police officer said.

Kumar told police that he believed she was planning to marry his younger brother. The hammer used in the attack has been seized, police added. HTC

Extract of Un-Audited Standalone & Consolidated Financial Results for quarter and half year ended 30th September, 2026

(All amounts are Rupees in crore, unless otherwise stated)

S. No.	Particulars	Standalone						Consolidated					
		Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended
		30-Sep-26	30-Jun-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26	30-Sep-26	30-Jun-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26
		Un-audited	Un-audited	Un-audited	Un-audited	Un-audited	Audited	Un-audited	Un-audited	Un-audited	Un-audited	Un-audited	Audited
1.	Total income from operations (net)	7,200.35	5,554.14	11,009.13	12,754.49	22,888.99	43,494.91	7,202.22	5,557.84	11,009.13	12,760.06	22,888.99	43,494.91
2.	Net Profit for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	1,659.10	1,514.43	1,082.66	3,173.53	2,218.77	5,157.55	1,658.24	1,490.84	1,078.65	3,149.08	2,188.51	5,123.90
3.	Net Profit for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	1,659.10	1,514.43	1,082.66	3,173.53	2,218.77	5,157.55	1,658.24	1,490.84	1,078.65	3,149.08	2,188.51	5,123.90
4.	Net Profit from ordinary activities after tax	1,235.40	1,132.72	805.75	2,368.12	1,656.33	3,842.67	1,256.43	1,137.14	830.30	2,393.57	1,672.18	3,912.53
5.	Other Comprehensive Income	-	-	-	-	-	(5.39)	0.01	0.01	(0.01)	0.02	(0.01)	(5.24)
6.	Total Comprehensive Income	1,235.40	1,132.72	805.75	2,368.12	1,656.33	3,837.28	1,256.44	1,137.15	830.29	2,393.59	1,672.17	3,907.29
7.	Equity share capital	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00
8.	Other Equity (excluding revaluation reserve)	-	-	-	-	-	20,219.66	-	-	-	-	-	20,784.82
9.	Earnings per share (Face value of ₹10/- each)												
	a) Basic (₹)	8.24	7.55	5.37	15.79	11.04	25.62	8.38	7.58	5.54	15.96	11.15	26.08
	b) Diluted (₹)	8.24	7.55	5.37	15.79	11.04	25.62	8.38	7.58	5.54	15.96	11.15	26.08
		(not annualised)					(annualised)	(not annualised)					(annualised)

Notes:

1. The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at the meeting held on 02nd November 2026. The Statutory auditors of the Company have carried out limited review of the aforesaid results.
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Statements of Un-Audited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results, for the quarter and half year ended 30th September 2026, filed with the stock exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Statements of Un-Audited Standalone and Consolidated Financial results are available on the websites of National Stock Exchange, the Bombay Stock Exchange and the website of the company (www.petronetlng.in).

Place : New Delhi
Date : 02nd November 2026

By order of the Board
Sd/-
Saurav Mitra
Director (Finance) & CFO
(Whole-time Director)
DIN: 07684414

PETRONET LNG LIMITED
Registered Office: 4th Floor, Tower-I, World Trade Center, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi - 110029, India
Email: webmaster@petronetlng.in
CIN: L74899DL1998PLC093073

PETRONET ENERGY LIMITED
Registered Office: Cabin No. 5009, 5th Floor, Tower -I, World Trade Center, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi -110029
Email: info@petronetenergy.in
Website: www.petronetenergy.in
CIN: U11202DL2021PLC469966

PETRONET LNG SINGAPORE PTE. LIMITED
Registered Office: 12 Marina View, #12-05, Asia Square Tower - 2 Singapore - 018961
Email: plisingapore@petronetlng.in

PETRONET LNG FOUNDATION
Registered Office: 5th Floor, Tower -I, World Trade Center, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi -110029
Email: info@petronetlngfoundation.org
Website: www.petronetlngfoundation.org
CIN: U85320DL2017NPL469981

MC2 FOUNDATION
Registered Office: 5th Floor, Tower -I, World Trade Center, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi -110029
Email: info@mc2plus.in
Website: www.mc2plus.in
CIN: U72100DL2026NPL465178

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Govt begins Yamuna defoaming work, clears ₹91L for froth study

Paras Singh
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NEW DELHI: With another bout of froth formation reported in the Yamuna over the past few days, the Delhi government has resumed sprinkling defoaming agents in the river near Kalindi Kunj ahead of Chhath Puja, continuing an annual practice that experts stressed addresses only the symptoms of a much deeper pollution problem.

To find a lasting solution to the toxic foam in this stretch – an issue that triggers a political showdown every year before the festival – the Delhi government has commissioned a structural feasibility study of the Okhla barrage by the Irrigation Research Institute (IRI), Roorkee.

The government has entrusted the work to Uttar Pradesh's irrigation and water resources department, providing it ₹91 lakh to examine possible changes to the slope of the barrage's outfall points to minimise water churning, officials said.

Separately, ₹68.46 crore has been allocated for a permanent Chhath ghat near Kalindi Kunj.

A worker sprays a defoaming solution into the river near Kalindi Kunj on Monday. SUNIL GHOSH/HT

How vertical lift gates create froth

According to officials from Delhi's irrigation and flood control department, the Okhla barrage has 27 gates, of which 19 are vertical lift gates, each approximately 5.1 metres high. Water cascades down from these gates into the river.

"When water falls into the river from a height of over five metres, it creates significant turbulence, which increases the formation of foam. Between October and December, the water level in the Yamuna drops, and the river consists primarily of discharge from drains containing surfactants, phosphates, and organic waste which further accelerates the formation of foam," an official said.

The proposed study will examine structural changes to reduce the height from which water falls and, consequently, the turbulence. HT has seen a copy of the communication regarding the study.

The froth, in this section of the river, forms when soap-like surfactant molecules in polluted water are agitated. The churning at the barrage intensifies foam formation. Sources of surfactants include detergents in untreated domestic sewage, industrial pollutants, wastewater from dhobi ghats and organic matter released by decomposing water hyacinth trapped near the barrage, officials said.

Bhim Singh Rawat, Yamuna activist and member of the South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People, said: "Treating symptoms during the festive season serves political aims but does not address the root cause. Additionally, a massive amount of chemicals is being sprayed into the river during defoaming drives, which will impact downstream ecology. Changing the barrage slope will not reduce the water's pollution level; it may just impact the froth's visibility."

{ SEXUAL HARASSMENT CASE }

HC stays sacking of JNU professor

Shruti Kakkar
shruti.kakkar@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Monday stayed the Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU)'s order sacking professor Angomcha Bimol Akoijam over sexual harassment allegations.

A bench of Anup Jairam Bhambhani passed the issued after Akoijam's lawyer told the court that the order was issued without issuing him a notice and giving him an opportunity of being heard.

Akoijam, a Congress MP who represents the Inner Manipur parliamentary constituency, was a professor at JNU's School of Social Sciences. He was sacked on October 9 after an inquiry by the university's internal committee formed to investigate into allegations of sexual harassment made by female students. Akoijam has denied the allegations.

"Based on the findings, the IC recommended major punishment... upon following the due process and considering all available facts, the punishment of dismissal from the services of the university is hereby imposed on the professor with immediate effect," the order signed by JNU vice-chancellor Santishree D Pandit said.

On September 6, HT reported, citing a person aware of the development, that 11 university students filed complaints against the professor this May, accusing him of "sexual misconduct".

The university formed an internal complaints committee that same month to investigate the allegations.

According to the complaints, the professor was accused of making inappropriate remarks with sexual connotations during the viva examinations in May. Delhi Police also registered an FIR against Akoijam on October 11 following a complaint by the university's chief security officer.

Akoijam later hit back at the university, insisting that its inquiry disregarded established rules and procedures and was essentially a political witch hunt.

Even as the high court stayed the termination, a trial court is set to hear Akoijam's petition for anticipatory bail on Tuesday.

POLICE WRITE TO MCD, DSIIDC OVER MANGOLPURI SHOE FACTORY FIRE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Monday said they have written to civic agencies to understand the lapses and fix accountability for negligence at the four-storey shoe factory in Mangolpuri, where a massive fire broke out on Friday, killing four people.

A police officer said, "A survivor, who is on oxygen support, said the workers repeatedly told the supervisor and owners to clear out the basement because of the risk it posed. But nobody responded to their pleas. While the building has no fire NOC, it is built on a Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation (DSIIDC) area and also has a licence. We have written to MCD as well as DSIIDC about the lapses there."

The fire broke out around 9.30 pm. While the Delhi Fire Services contained it in the basement itself, the smoke killed the victims trapped inside.

Police have booked the building supervisor and three owners for culpable homicide not amounting to murder and negligence. With two owners yet to be arrested, police said documents and verification about the building licences is still pending. HTC

DELIVERY AGENT KILLED, FRIEND INJURED IN BIKE CRASH IN NE DELHI

NEW DELHI: A 20-year-old delivery executive died while his 18-year-old friend suffered severe injuries allegedly after their bike skidded and crashed in northeast Delhi's Shahdara on Sunday morning.

Officers said they were yet to ascertain whether the bike skidded due to rain, speed or patches of gravel and debris on road.

According to police, the accident took place near Nand Nagri depot on the main Wazirabad Road. The victims were heading towards east Delhi for a job interview when their bike skidded and they fell on the road.

Both victims — Aryan Singh and pillion rider Dev — were not wearing helmets when the accident took place, police said. HTC

{ CLASH WITH LAWYERS IN SHAHDARA } DELEGATION MET COMMISSIONER TWICE

500 cops hold protest outside police HQ

Hemani Bhandari
hemani.bhandari@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Around 500 Delhi Police personnel, including an assistant commissioner of police (ACP) and a station house officer (SHO) transferred after a face-off with lawyers in east Delhi's Shahdara, protested outside police headquarters on Monday, demanding action against the lawyers involved and safeguards against alleged intimidation at police stations and courtrooms.

The protest, led by ACP Mansavi Vashishta, continued for over 10 hours, with a delegation meeting senior officers, including Delhi Police commissioner Anurag Kumar, twice during the day.

Late in the night, Vashishta said that senior officers had assured him that his transfer order "would be looked into" and that no action would be taken against those who participated in the protest. He termed the gathering a "success".

ACP Vashishta and others called off the gathering in the evening, following a meeting with senior officers. SANCHIT KHANNA/HT

He said he and four other officers met joint commissioner of police Nupur Prasad in the evening, when they were told that his transfer order would be examined. The officers were also assured that legal action against those named in the FIR he had registered would be considered, he said.

The protesting personnel submitted five demands, including that the FIR registered on Vashishta's complaint against lawyers should not be quashed, that a grievance redressal committee be set up, and that standard operating procedures be framed to deal with confrontations involving lawyers. They also sought restrictions on the number of lawyers entering a police officer's office at one time, and security for police personnel inside courtrooms.

The protest was the first by police personnel outside headquarters on Jai Singh Road since November 2019, when thousands of officers held an hours-long demonstration following successive clashes with lawyers.

The latest confrontation stems from an altercation between lawyers and police in Shahdara on October 23, in which an advocate suffered a head injury. An FIR was registered at Shahdara police station following a complaint by an advocate.

Ggm road rage against biker: Attempted murder charge filed

Debashish Karmakar
htcorrespondent@hindustantimes.com

GURUGRAM: Gurugram Police on Monday filed the charge sheet against both accused in the road rage incident on Golf Course Road on September 13. Charges under attempt to murder have been framed against the accused for deliberately ramming Delhi woman Shivani Chauhan alias Sia's bike with their car, as per the charge sheet.

The two accused Kalyan Bainsla, 33, and his cousin Lavnish, 34 -- both from Palwal -- were arrested from Rajasthan Dausa's on September 15.

Inspector Sukhpal, station house officer of Sector 56 police station, confirmed the charge sheet filing on Monday.

"Attempt to murder charge under Section 109(1) of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita invoked in the FIR against Kalyan as well as Lavnish were retained in the charge sheet," he said.

Charges under sections 78 (stalking) and 79 (word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman) of BNS were also retained against the two men, he said.

According to police and a video footage posted by Sia, the incident took place on September 13, when she was riding a motorcycle with other bikers on Golf Course Road. Kalyan, who was driving a Maruti Ciaz, allegedly approached her, attempted to talk, and later made obscene gestures and comments.

Sia said she had gestured to him to maintain distance to avoid collision, then she sped away to avoid being followed.

However, Kalyan, raced behind her and suddenly changed lanes to ram her. The incident came to light after Sia posted a video of the road rage on social media, recorded in her helmet-mounted camera. The footage showed Sia's bike falling after the car rammed her, injuring her. Other bikers attempted to stop the car at a traffic signal, but the driver sped away.

Sia told HT on Monday that she was glad the police retained these charges in the chargesheet. "Police didn't even let the two get bail yet from the court by opposing it vehemently. Such people should have the fear of law which, though exists to safeguard citizens, is not always used. This step by the police has set an example," she said.

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IRCTC invites Expression of Interest (EOIs-2027) for empanelment for participation in limited e-tenders for Provision of Onboard Catering Services in various types of trains on Indian Railways up to **31.12.2027**. Empanelment is continuous process & shall be live on GeM portal from date of uploading to opening date. EOI will be closed on **05th of every month** and will be opened on **06th of every month.**

For more details visit IRCTC website: **www.irctc.com** & application can only be submitted online at **https://gem.gov.in**.

In case of any further corrigendum / addendum issued on the above advertisement, it will be published only on IRCTC's website **www.irctc.com** & **https://gem.gov.in**.

GGM/P&T, 3rd Floor, Tower-D, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi – 110029, E-mail: ggmprocurement@irctc.com, tendercellcc@irctc.com. In case any clarifications, please contact on 8287930467 & 8287930164

INDIAN RAILWAYS
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PATIALA - 147003
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E-TENDER NOTICE
Visit us at www.ireps.gov.in

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer / Elect. Services, Patiala Locomotive Works, Patiala (Pb.) for & on behalf of President of India invites open E-Tender on website **www.ireps.gov.in** for the following work. Tenderer may upload their original offer on website upto prescribed closing time & date. The offers will be uploaded up to 15:00 hrs. of closing date and uploaded offers will be opened on same day at 15:30 hrs for the under noted work. No tender will be accepted manually.

Tender Notice No	PLW/ EL/437/R/25
Name of work	Electrical work for "Phase-I Improvement in illumination level in LA group of Shops (LAS,ECS,ABS & LFS) in workshop area, PLW/Patiala"
Approx. cost of work (in Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (in Rs.)
Rs. 4286339/-	Rs. 85700/-
Completion period	Closing date & Time of Tender
03 Months	23.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Tender Notice No	PLW/EL/455/26
Name of work	Work required for "Repair and Rewinding of Submersible Pump Motors sets of different capacities under running repair for two years in PLW/PTA".
Approx. cost of work (in Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (in Rs.)
Rs. 869331.14/-	Rs. 17400/-
Completion period	Closing date & Time of Tender
24 Months	23.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Tender documents are available on Railway website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** and the same can be downloaded from there. All terms and conditions may be seen and downloaded from Railway website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**. Payment of Earnest Money (EMD) in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through Net Banking or only payment modes available on IREPS portal only.
Tenderer shall submitted valid Electrical licence issued by any state govt./UT for any State/UT. Tender without Electrical licence will be summarily rejected.

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

PRAYAGRAJ DIVISION
Expression of Interest (EOI)

Expression of interest (EOI) for beautification (Plantation) of Railway area/ premises at station approaches along the track through participation of the Jan Bhagidari at Churk (63000 sqm), Sonbhadra (35000 sqm), Pahara (124800 sqm), Manikpur (30000 sqm), and Hathras Fort (60000 sqm) Stations of Prayagraj division, North Central Railway.

Last date of submission of EOI is up to 12:00 hrs on 06.11.2026

Senior Division Engineer (Co-ordination), Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Nawab Yusuf Road, Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh -211001

Allotment will be done through lottery in case application received more than one

for more details regarding may please Contact : 9794837448, 9794837220
For more inquiry please go to website:- https://ncr.indianrailways.gov.in.

North central railways @www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR 2505/26(AK)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.: DRM/C/Agra/Catg /e-auction/26 Date: 29.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-AUCTION

On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager- North Central Railway, Agra invites E-Auction for 07 Catering Stalls at Platform of various Railway Stations over Agra Division for a period of Five years.

Category: Catering Stalls | Auction Catalogue No.: AGRA-CATG-26-07

Name of Station	Category	Station Code	Total No. of Stalls	Auction Starting Time
Mathura Jn.	A-1	MTJ	03	Date 13.11.2026 Time 12.00 Hrs.
Agra Cantt	A-1	AGC	01	
Idgah	D	IDH	02	
Patholi	E	PTLI	01	

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (**www.ireps.gov.in**) for more details. The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 2487/26(A)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India, CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of APH Seals and grating bar set. which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 Tender Enquiry No. 217/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018403
"Procurement of APH Seals and Grating Bars Set which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **02.11.2026** from 1700 Hrs. onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GATP-113/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16725

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India, CIN:U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of APH BASKETS. which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib.

1 Tender Enquiry No. 223/GATP/MMD/BOILER/20018404
"Procurement of APH BASKETS which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt.: Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **02.11.2026** from 1700 Hrs. onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GATP-114/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16726

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN: U40109TG1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guru Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)

HOD-MMD, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for Procurement of REFRACTORY FOR BOTTOM ASH HOPPER which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib:

1. Tender Enquiry No. 221/ GATP/MMD/AHP/20018412
"Procurement of REFRACTORY FOR BOTTOM ASH HOPPER which will be used in 2x270 MW BHEL Units during Annual overhauling for Both the Units of GATP/GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib"
at 2X270 MW Guru Amardas Thermal Plant (GATP), Goindwal Sahib, Distt. Tarn Taran, Punjab as per details given in the tender specifications.'

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GATP-115/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16727

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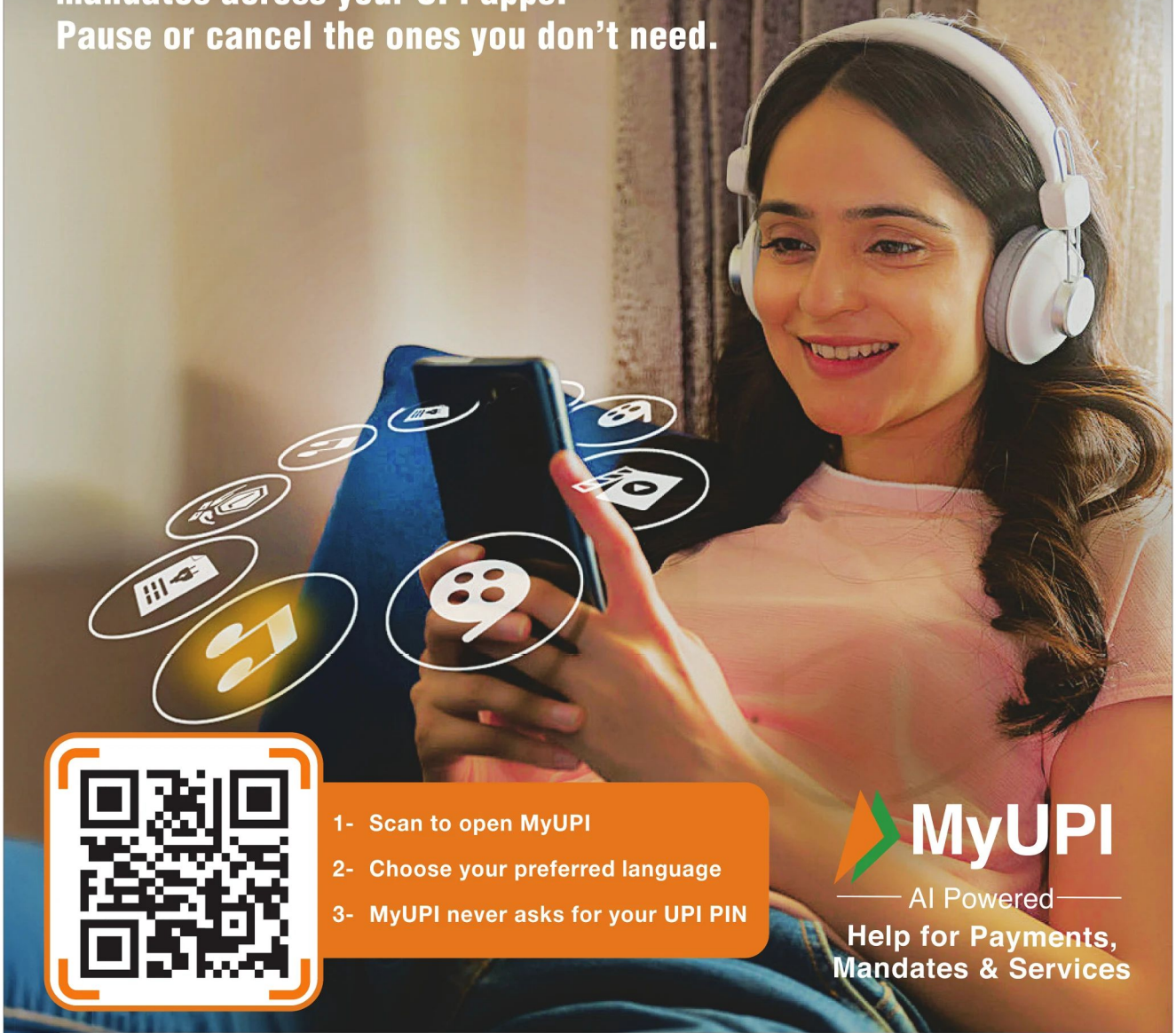

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{ FROM PAGE 1 }

SC-FIRECRACKERS

ronmental pollution caused by bursting firecrackers," noted the bench.

The court said that while bursting firecrackers undoubtedly contributed to pollution, the measures undertaken by authorities, whether pursuant to judicial directions or on their own, had failed to produce the desired results. The problem, it said, lay in implementation, requiring better coordination among stakeholders and sustained monitoring beyond the festive season.

"We are inclined to regulate the manufacture, storage, sale and bursting of green firecrackers, instead of maintaining the complete ban on the same, for a temporary period," it said.

The court also flagged the emergence of an illegal market for conventional firecrackers despite the prohibition, observing that the complete ban was facilitating their sale while preventing consumers from purchasing legitimate green crackers and next-generation joined green crackers that had undergone testing at established facilities.

The bench underlined that the right to practise, profess and propagate religion under Article 25 of the Constitution was subject to public order, morality, health and other fundamental rights, including the right to life under Article 21, which encompasses a healthy and pollution-free environment. It said an individual's right to engage in a religious practice, even one with a religious colour, was qualified and could not override constitutional restrictions.

The order also acknowledged the religious, social, psychological and emotional significance of Diwali, describing it as a festival that had acquired a national and even international character over centuries. Tracing the use of firecrackers to the introduction of gunpowder in India, the bench noted that ancient Hindu scriptures such as the Skandapurana and Padmapurana referred to the use of lamps as a ritual associated with the festival.

"Allowing the environment to degrade, which results in a health hazard to all the living beings, defeats the very purpose of the festivities, and the celebrations would be rendered nugatory," said the court, adding that all parties before it were in agreement that bursting firecrackers contributed enormously to pollution in Delhi-NCR.

The court's directions allow manufacturers holding valid certifications from the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI) and the Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO) to manufacture approved green crackers between November 2 and 6. Only products uploaded on CSIR-NEERI's website can be manufactured and sold, and their boxes must remain completely sealed to prevent conventional firecrackers from being mixed with them.

The sale of firecrackers will be permitted only through designated locations identified by district collectors and commissioners in consultation with district police chiefs. Online sales have been prohibited. Traders whose licences were cancelled will have them temporarily restored between November 4 and 6 to facilitate the sale of approved green crackers, but any violation of the court's conditions will invite immediate cancellation.

To ensure that consumers can distinguish genuine green crackers from conventional products, the bench mandated product-specific QR codes on every box. Scanning these codes must disclose the manufacturer, NEERI registration, PESO or district magistrate licence, formulation and test certificate. The codes will be non-transferable, with their sale itself treated as a violation warranting cancellation of registration or licence.

The court prohibited the manufacture and sale of firecrackers joined in series, commonly known as "laris", as well as crackers containing barium or those not approved by CSIR-NEERI. It also directed authorities to confiscate illegal and conventional firecrackers and initiate prosecution against offending manufacturers and traders.

The permitted bursting window will not extend to areas within 300 metres of hospitals, nursing homes, primary and district health centres, old-age homes, educational institutions and notified silence zones. These will be declared no-cracker zones, marked on the ground and publicised.

The bench further directed authorities to require manufacturers and traders across Delhi-NCR to furnish a substantial monetary security deposit, which will be forfeited if they violate the court's directions or applicable regulations. Police and district administration teams will conduct regular inspections at designated sale locations, verify QR codes and check vehicles entering Delhi-NCR to prevent the movement of illegal and conventional firecrackers.

The order also puts the onus on pollution-control authorities to generate comprehensive data on the environmental and health consequences of the relaxation. The Central Pollution Control Board, in consultation with state pollution control boards, has been directed to prepare daily air-quality reports for November 2-6, November 7-8 and the post-Diwali period from November 9-30. Samples of sand and water will also be collected for comparative analysis.

The bench directed authorities to inspect air-quality monitoring stations alleged to be non-functional and immediately rectify any defects. It further ordered the collection of hospital data on the increase in patient admissions and any reported deaths attributable to pollution following the festival. The state governments will have to file affidavits detailing compliance, enforcement action and the health impact of firecracker use by December 14.

The court said it would monitor implementation through periodic hearings and warned that contempt action would be taken against officials responsible for non-compliance.

The latest order follows the court's October 2025 decision to permit the sale and bursting of green crackers for three days, between October 18 and 20, as a temporary measure, after a complete ban imposed in Delhi-NCR in December 2024. That relaxation was accompanied by strict conditions on designated sale points, QR-code verification, restrictions on timings and monitoring of air quality.

However, the bench in its latest order said the states had failed to comply with those directions and had not furnished the requisite material to assess the impact of the relaxation. It noted that despite the resumption of the complete ban, there was a significant spike in AQI levels on Dussehra and the following day this year, while conventional firecrackers continued to be sold as green crackers.

The proceedings originates from a 2015 petition filed on behalf of three minors, including Arjun Gopal, seeking a ban on the sale and use of firecrackers in Delhi-NCR because of their harmful effects on children and other vulnerable sections. The Supreme Court has since issued several directions to regulate the manufacture, sale and use of fireworks, including restrictions on barium-containing crackers and joined firecrackers.

While the court rejected the petitioners' renewed plea for a complete prohibition at this stage, it stressed that the limited relaxation was not an endorsement of unrestricted use. Instead, it was intended to allow legitimate, tested products to reach consumers under strict safeguards while generating scientific evidence on their environmental and health impact.

In its concluding observations, the bench called for a broader change in public attitudes towards celebrations and pollution, invoking the precautionary principle and urging preventive rather than merely reactive measures. It also appealed to members of the Bar, celebrities and sportspersons to voluntarily participate in public-awareness campaigns encouraging responsible celebrations.

The court listed the matter for further compliance on December 16.

TATA TRUST BOARD

"Therefore, the records in this regard are not available in this office," it said in a letter drafted in Marathi, which Mint has translated.

The charity commissioner's office reiterated its position in a subsequent email to Mint on Monday, adding: "However, the deliberations were made in the Law and Judiciary Department."

The amendment has prevented SRTT from conducting board proceedings, contributed to a deadlock at Tata Sons and stalled the company's annual general meeting (AGM), complicating efforts to resolve a leadership dispute.

The state's Law and Judiciary Department, which issued the ordinance, has declined to provide details of how the amendment was drafted.

Asked for copies of Cabinet proposals, stakeholder representations and lobbying records, and inter-departmental correspondence relating to the ordinance, it said work on the file was "in progress at the Government level" and the information could not be provided "at present".

The ordinance made several changes to the law governing public trusts. The state legislature ratified it in December 2025 as the Maharashtra Public Trusts (Second Amendment) Act, 2025.

Experts said it was unusual to amend a law without a proposal from the regulatory body responsible for implementing it.

"Generally, the introduction of law or any amendments to existing laws are introduced with consultation of the regulatory body (state or central) of that law because ultimately, such regulatory body ensures the effective implementation of the law or its amendments," said Gaurav Pingle, partner at Forefront Legal Consulting LLP.

"In case of amendments, there could be reporting or disclosure requirements which would require the overview of the concerned regulatory body," he said.

The charity commissioner's office, however, functions under the state's Law and Judiciary Department. This differs from the institutional structure of federal regulators such as the Reserve Bank of India and the Securities and Exchange Board of India, whose offices are outside government ministries, even though the Centre appoints their heads and can issue policy directions.

Emails sent to Maharashtra's Law and Judiciary Department seeking comment went unanswered until press time.

SRTT under a freeze

The amendment became central to the dispute on 28 April, when Tata Trusts vice chairman Venu Srinivasan complained to the charity commissioner that SRTT's three permanent trustees were violating the law governing public trusts. SRTT had six trustees at the time.

On 15 May, the charity commissioner ordered that the Trust could not hold meetings or take decisions while an investigation was under way. The order was issued without giving Tata Trusts an opportunity to explain its position, the charitable organizations had said then in a statement.

The amendment has fuelled confusion because it does not clearly state whether its restrictions apply only to appointments made after 1 September 2025 or also to existing appointments.

Tata Trusts maintains that the amendment is prospective and does not affect appointments made before it came into force. It says all three of SRTT's perpetual trustees — Noel Tata, Jimmy Tata and Jehangir HC Jehangir—were appointed before the amendment.

"It is the understanding of the Tata Trusts that the said amendment is prospective in nature and does not affect the appointments of perpetual trustees made prior to its coming into force on 1st September 2025. This is substantiated by both opinions and clarifications obtained by the Tata Trusts," Tata Trusts said in a statement on the evening of 15 May.

Deadlock spreads to Tata Sons

The paralysis at SRTT has had consequences beyond the trust itself. Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT), which owns 27.98% of Tata Sons, and SRTT, which owns 23.56%, are the two principal Tata Trusts. Together with smaller trusts, they hold 65.9% of the company.

Tata Sons' rules require representatives of both SDTT and SRTT to be present for a general meeting to proceed. With SRTT unable to take decisions or send representatives, Tata Sons' AGM was adjourned on 18 August for lack of quorum.

The impasse has also prevented shareholders from resolving a separate disagreement over Tata Sons' leadership.

Noel Tata, chairman of Tata Trusts, was outvoted by the Tata Sons board on 17 September, when N. Chandrasekaran was reappointed chairman for a third five-year term. Tata Trusts has called the decision "illegal". Tata Sons maintains that the reappointment of Chandrasekaran was done while abiding by all due processes.

A shareholder decision is required to complete the appointment process, but the company cannot hold the AGM until the quorum issue is resolved.

The dispute has now acquired a political dimension. Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi suggested political involvement in the boardroom conflict last week.

"Tata is being criminally destroyed, and no business leader dares say a word. How long will you stay silent? Until they own you?" Gandhi wrote on X.

Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman rejected the suggestion, urging Gandhi not to politicize the matter.

She said it was unacceptable to casually describe business and legal matters as criminal, and accused him of repeatedly criticizing the achievements of Indian industries and entrepreneurs

SHAH-RAHUL

in hand, but doesn't respect the Constitution. Rahul ji, you don't allow Parliament to run. Be it EVMs, SIR, infiltrators, I challenge you from Hyderabad. We are ready to convene a special session of Parliament. Come for debate," he said.

"If a Parliament session is held, Prime Minister Narendra Modi will shred Congress into pieces," he said, accusing the Congress of hogging the limelight through anarchy.

Gandhi, also the leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, targeted Modi over the latter's remarks that certain forces were trying to obstruct India's progress and divide the country.

"Mr Modi, stop lying to this nation. You became PM because of foreign help. Your financial system is fully controlled and supported by foreigners. Foreign social media fully backs you," he said on X.

"I challenge you to an open debate about this. Any stage, any time. Come if you have the guts. You won't dare, because you are terrified of what I know about you," he added.

The Opposition's march and rally on Sunday – attended by tens of thousands — was the largest show of strength by the INDIA bloc, which has been pushing for Kumar's removal over allegations of irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission of India and SIR, which has already removed 130 million names from India's electoral rolls, many of them under absent, shifted or dead categories.

The BJP has responded with rallies of its own in multiple cities, alleging that Gandhi was acting at the behest of foreign powers to create anarchy in the country.

On Saturday (October 31) , Modi had said the Opposition's role in a democracy was to oppose the government's policies but added that it had become an obstructionist force.

"Certain forces are continuously engaged in conspiracies to divide the country... After more than a decade of frustration and disappointment, these forces have now come out in the open... Who is secretly meeting whom abroad? Whom are anti-India forces supporting? Who is speaking the language of India's enemies? We must recognise all these patterns and confront them together... Especially the way social media is being weaponised, rumours are being spread, and attempts are being made to tarnish India's image," he had said at Ekta Nagar in Narmada district of Gujarat

In Hyderabad on Monday, Shah accused the Congress of hypocrisy.

"Rahul ji, if EVMs are faulty, how did your Revanth Reddy become chief minister? How did your government come to power in Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Himachal Pradesh? If EVMs are so bad, you should not have taken the oath of office. When you win, the credit goes to the people, but when you lose, you blame the EVMs," he said. He was referring to previous Congress allegations that electronic voting machines were faulty.

Recalling past governance records and projecting the BJP's expanding national footprint, Shah listed recent electoral successes and said Telangana was next in line.

"Revanth Reddy ji, you have turned the entire Telangana into an ATM for the Congress leaders sitting in Delhi. The people of Telangana will never forgive you for this. Rahul ji had promised six guarantees. Not even one guarantee has been fulfilled."

In Kolkata, BJP chief Nitin Nabin alleged that Gandhi was leading those behind anarchy.

"Rahul Gandhi is a toolkit of those forces which engineered the unrest in Nepal and other neighbouring countries. He is leading those forces who are behind the anarchy across the country," he said.

Nabin also targeted West Bengal's former chief minister Mamata Banerjee, saying she was crying in Delhi after losing the state. "Just as Bengal has become Mamata-mukt, we will make Delhi Rahul-mukt. We defeated Congress and Rahul Gandhi in 2014, 2019 and 2024. We will do so again in 2029," he said, drawing cheers from the crowd.

Congress general secretary K C Venugopal said, "Let them mock whatever they want. But the public is completely convinced that they are doing vote chori."

The ongoing protests are part of a longer string of events that have mounted pressure on Kumar. The developments follow an Indian Express investigation that said election commissioners SS Sandhu and Vivek Joshi recorded written dissents and objections at least 14 times between November 2025 and August 2026 and even wrote to the cabinet secretary. It also alleged that election officials found their access to the ECI software curtailed by the central IT team. ECI said differing views and observations were a normal part of deliberation and that all its digital platforms operated under strict data security protocols.

Over the past month, thousands of people have hit the streets, braving Metro closures, internet shutdown, prohibitory orders and 40,000 security personnel who turned the Capital into a virtual fortress and sparked controversy by dragging, manhandling and detaining many agitators. While the Opposition is seeking the removal of Kumar and scrapping the controversial special intensive revision, the BJP blames them for trying to destabilise constitutional bodies to deflect attention from their own political and electoral failures.

HT Homage

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Sh. Ram Lal Sachdeva
29th October 1934 - 3rd November 2022
Fondly remembered by
Smt. Savitri Sachdeva
(WIFE)

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Yogesh & Renu Sachdeva
Jitender & Poonam Sachdeva
Sunil & Suman Sachdeva
Pankaj & Abhilasha Sachdeva

GRANDCHILDREN & SPOUSES
Vishwa & Muskan Sachdeva
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Vani & Nitin Chawla
Surbhi Sachdeva
Eva Sachdeva
Krishna Sachdeva

GREAT GRANDCHILDREN
Ahaan
Veer
Nayantara

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S/o Late Dr. Naurang Singh Sabharwal.
11th Death Anniversary
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Mayank Austen Soofi

Sidney Sheldon on the Violet Line

A select anthology of Delhi Metro readers

{ PUBLIC INTEREST }

Something suspicious is going on aboard a train coach on the Delhi Metro Violet Line, just as it leaves the JLN Stadium station. Almost everybody has a mobile out. So far, so normal. But this man is holding a book. An open book! He stands amid a crush of shirts and pants, his Ho Chi Minh beard lowered towards the bulky hardbound of Akshaya Mukul 's "Writer, Rebel, Soldier, Lover: The Many Lives of Agyeya."

Truth be told, Delhi Metro commuters are dedicated readers. But of mobile screens. A paper book remains a rare sighting. Here is an abridged anthology of such rare sightings, gathered over many journeys.

One sighting, on the Blue Line: a bespectacled young man is reading George Orwell's "1984." An enormous eye stares from the book's cover into the coach. Everybody else has their eyes on their respective mobile.

The bitter truth of the matter is that with a mobile close at hand, it is easy for the eyes to leave a book mid-sentence to check a notification, then forget to return. But these metro readers seem better at resisting. Take the next sighting on the Magenta Line. A masked passenger is reading Mary Elizabeth Braddon's "Lady Audley's Secret," legs elegantly crossed. As the train nears Vasant Vihar station, he gets up and moves to the door, continuing to read until it slides open.

The train rattles on. Stations fly past one after another. The chaotic city goes by in a blur. Fellow commuters shove past. But these readers rarely look up from the page. Could this be their only time for a book in a day otherwise claimed by colleges, offices, families and friends?

Sidney Sheldon gets a sighting, too. On the Violet Line. A bearded man is reading "The Stars Shine Down," his paperback supported by a backpack worn in front. The commuter is Mithilesh, see left photo.

Metro readers earlier chronicled in this space include Dwarka's Nikhil, who read the whole of Vikram Seth's "A Suitable Boy" during his commutes to and from work. Noida's Manika travelled equally far with Rebecca West's "Black Lamb and Grey Falcon: A Journey Through Yugoslavia."

One afternoon brings a heavyweight sighting: a book by historian Eric Hobsbawm. Between Gurugram and Green Park on the Yellow Line, a long-haired man is absorbed in "How to Change the World: Tales of Marx and Marxism."

A final sighting: a young man with a jhola beside him. His head is bent over Douglas Adams's "The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy." The commuter is Tanmay, see right photo. But his Blue Line train is reaching merely its last station, Vaishali in zila Ghaziabad. Hunuz Galaxy dur ast.

READ: For more stories by Mayank Austen Soofi, scan the QR code

{ NEW RULES NOTIFIED }

Govt can intervene in rare airfare cases

Neha LM Tripathi
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NEW DELHI: The Centre can directly intervene on ticket pricing in extraordinary situations under a new set of aviation rules that also require airlines to disclose cancellation charges and refund conditions separately while displaying airfares to passengers.

These rules under the Bharatiya Vayuyan Niyam, 2024, were notified by the civil aviation ministry (MoCA) on October 26 and published in the Gazette of India on October 31. They will come into effect on January 1, 2027, replacing the Aircraft Rules, 1937. The Bharatiya Vayuyan Adhiniyam, which replaced the Aircraft Act, 1934, came into force on January 1, 2025.

The new rules shift the intervention power on specified tariff-related grounds from the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) to the Central Government. Under Rule 135(4) of the Aircraft Rules, 1937, the DGCA could issue directions to an airline if it was satisfied that the airline was charging excessive tariff. A new rule, 192(6), however, empowers the Central government itself to issue written directions in the public interest when it considers a situation extraordinary and intervention necessary. Such directions must be proportionate to the circumstances and remain in force only for a specified period, the rules say.

The provisions do not introduce a routine cap on airfares or require govt approval for every ticket price.

The provisions do not introduce a routine cap on airfares or require government approval for every ticket price. Hence, airlines will continue to determine fares in normal circumstances. The new framework, however, provides for tariff submission and monitoring by the DGCA.

Under the new rules, airlines will have to show the total amount payable by a passenger on their booking websites and on the booked ticket, along with a complete break-up indicating the fare, taxes, fees, cancellation charges, refund conditions and any other charges separately.

The requirement applies to Indian airlines operating scheduled services as well as foreign airlines operating scheduled flights to, from, or across India. All such airlines will also have to publish their tariffs on their websites or other digital platforms in a specified format .

The rules also require airlines to establish tariffs based on factors including the cost of operation. Indian scheduled airlines will have to submit their tariffs to DGCA,which will monitor the prices.

The new provisions build on disclosure requirements that already existed under the Aircraft Rules, 1937. The earlier rules required airlines to display the total amount payable by passengers and its break-up, including the fare, taxes, fees and other charges. The 2026 rules explicitly include cancellation charges and refund conditions in the list of particulars that must be displayed.

India, Vietnam discuss bolstering defence ties

Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India and Vietnam reviewed cooperation under their bilateral strategic partnership, including trade and defence, as National Security Advisor (NSA) Ajit Doval met the top leadership of the Southeast Asian country in Hanoi on Monday.

Doval and Vietnam's deputy prime minister and defence minister General Phan Van Giang reviewed bilateral defence cooperation and agreed to further deepen engagements in the domain, the Indian embassy said on social media.

Phan suggested to Doval that India should continue supporting and advancing defence cooperation, "commensurate with its role as a key pillar of the enhanced comprehensive strategic partnership between the two countries", according to an official readout from the Vietnamese side.

The readout quoted Doval as saying that he highly valued the relations between Vietnam and India, and emphasising that "cooperation with trustworthy partners in a fast-changing world is becoming increasingly important for national development and autonomy".

Doval expressed satisfaction at the advancement of India-Vietnam relations. Phan noted that Doval's visit is significant as it comes after the two sides enhanced their ties to a comprehensive strategic partnership in the spirit of "shared vision, strategic convergence, substantive cooperation".

2 State-owned shipyards to build 8 next-gen corvettes

Rahul Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The defence ministry on Monday signed contracts worth ₹53,867 crore with two public sector yards to boost the Indian Navy's operational capabilities with eight next-generation corvettes, according to an official statement.

THE DEFENCE MINISTRY HAS INKED ₹53,867-CR CONTRACTS TO BOOST THE NAVY'S OPERATIONAL CAPABILITIES

In a boost for the self-reliance drive, Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited (GRSE) will build and supply five of the warships at a cost of ₹32,000 crore, while Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) will handle the remaining three. The two contracts were signed in the presence of defence secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh.

"The project marks a significant milestone in India's indigenous warship design and construction capabilities as it is the first project in which the ships will be indigenously designed by the Indian Navy and constructed by defence public sector undertakings selected through a competitive process," the defence ministry said in a statement.

The corvettes will be equipped with modern capabilities, including advanced missiles, weapons and sensor suites, enabling them to undertake missions across the air, surface and sub-surface domains.

"Great news for India's indigenous shipbuilding ecosystem. The next-generation corvettes (NGCs) project for the Indian Navy will provide a significant impetus to India's shipbuilding sector by strengthening collaboration among DPSUs, private shipyards and Indian industrial partners, including MSMEs," defence minister Rajnath Singh wrote on X.

The construction of these warships is expected to generate 7.2 million person-days of employment in the shipyards and 46 million person-days in ancillary industries and MSMEs over the next ten years, it added.

The development comes as the navy works towards full self-reliance by 2047 when India celebrates 100 years of independence.

NO CHAR DHAM CHOPPER SERVICES FOR THIS SEASON

Amit Bathla and
Neha LM Tripathi
letters@hindustantimes.com

DEHRADUN/NEW DELHI: The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has called off charter helicopter services on the Char Dham route for the remainder of the season, which ends on November 16, when the Badrinath temple is set to close its portals.

Earlier, a meeting between DGCA officials, officials with the Uttarakhand Civil Aviation Development Authority (UCADA) and helicopter operators at 11am on Monday failed to resolve a deadlock over the DCGA's fresh rule making co-pilots mandatory on all flights on the Char Dham circuit. It was introduced a day after a helicopter returning from Badrinath crashed near Jyotirmath, killing all six people on board.

Many helicopter operators argued that the two-pilot rule was commercially unviable to implement because of the associated physical modifications to helicopters. Despite the pushback, the DGCA refused to roll back the order.

"The objective (of the rule) was to enable better airspace monitoring with two pilots. However, operators opposed the decision because twin-pilot operations require physical modifications to helicopters, such as installing additional dual controls, and reducing passenger capacity to manage payload limits," said UCADA chief executive officer Prateek Jain.

"With only seven to eight days remaining in the season, carrying out these modifications requires time and is not commercially viable, according to them," Jain added.

Resolve VB-G RAM G grievances within 15 days: Govt to states

Pallavi Singhal
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Monday notified rules requiring state governments to establish grievance redressal mechanisms at the gram panchayat, block and district levels under the VB-G RAM G act, mandating that complaints be resolved within 15 days of receipt.

THE RULES PRESCRIBE A 7-WORKING-DAY TIMELINE FOR ENQUIRY AND A 15-DAY DEADLINE FOR RESOLUTION

The rules, called the VB-G RAM G (Grievance Redressal) Rules, 2026, aim to make grievance redressal "more accessible, transparent and accountable", while ensuring that citizens' concerns receive "timely attention and appropriate action", the ministry said in a press release.

Under the rules, every state government will have to designate grievance redressal officers at the gram panchayat, block and district levels to receive, register, investigate and dispose of complaints.

The district programme coordinator will oversee the process at the district level.

The rules allow any person to file a grievance relating to any matter arising out of or connected with the implementation of the scheme. Complaints can be submitted in person to the designated officer, through speed post, on a digital platform designated by the Centre or through telephone and designated helplines.

A key provision is that no complaint can be refused registration on the grounds of its format, language, mode of submission or any procedural deficiency. Rule 4(5) of the notification states: "No grievance shall be refused registration on the ground of format, language, manner of submission or any procedural deficiency."

Complaints received physically will have to be entered into the designated digital platform on the day of receipt or, if that is not feasible, by the next working day. Complainants will receive an acknowledgement carrying the registration number, date of receipt and designation of the authority receiving the complaint.

The rules prescribe a seven-working-day timeline for enquiry and a 15-day deadline for resolution, both calculated from the date of receipt of the grievance.

"The Grievance Redressal Rules, 2026 are a welcome step towards institutionalising accountability in the implementation of the VB-G RAM G Act. A significant concern is the absence of clearly stipulated consequences for officials who fail to adhere to the prescribed timelines or neglect their grievance redressal responsibilities," said Tushar Agarwal, Founder & Managing Partner, C.L.A.P. JURIS, Advocates & Solicitors.

SC for uniform format to rescue, rehabilitate bonded labourers

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday gave states and Union territories six months to implement a uniform procedure for the rescue and rehabilitation of bonded labourers, directing that immediate financial assistance be disbursed within seven days of the issuance of a release certificate.

Hearing two public interest litigations, a bench of justices Vikram Nath and Aparesh Kumar Singh said "rehabilitation delayed is rehabilitation denied", underscoring the need for timely rescue and rehabilitation of bonded workers.

"A uniform procedural framework, prescribing definite timelines and clearly identifying the responsibilities of the concerned authorities, is therefore necessary to ensure consistency and accountability throughout the country," the bench said.

The court directed the Centre to ensure "uniform implementation throughout the country of the revised Standard Operating Procedure" prepared on May 14 this year. "All States and union territories shall take necessary steps to implement the SOP and comply with the directions issued hereunder within six months from the date of this order," it said. The court also said immediate assistance must not be withheld merely because an investigation or criminal proceedings were pending.

SC SAID IMMEDIATE ASSISTANCE MUST NOT BE WITHHELD MERELY BECAUSE OF PENDING PROBE OR CRIMINAL PROCEEDINGS

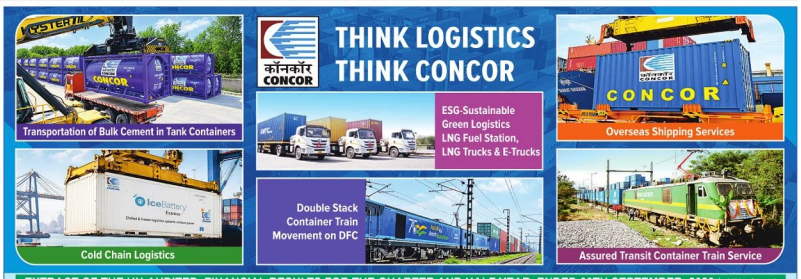
The court was hearing a petition filed by Surendra Manjhi, a bonded labourer rescued from a Uttar Pradesh brick kiln in 2019, and another filed by the National Campaign Committee for the Eradication of Bonded Labour and others.

Manjhi's case highlighted the difficulties faced by bonded labourers even after their rescue. Of the 42 workers rescued along with him, only 25 had received financial assistance of ₹20,000 till date. Manjhi received his entitled amount three years after his rescue.

The bench directed that "immediate financial assistance admissible under the rehabilitation scheme shall ordinarily be disbursed within seven days of issuance of the release certificate, subject to necessary verification".

Referring to Manjhi's case, the court directed the concerned states to release the amounts due.

"These circumstances demonstrate that rehabilitation delayed may, in substance, amount to rehabilitation denied....We are of the view that the entitlement of a rescued labourer cannot be made dependent upon differences in administrative practices or jurisdictional arrangements between states," it said.



EXTRACT OF THE UN-AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER, 2026 (₹ In Crore)

S. No.	Particulars	STANDALONE RESULTS					CONSOLIDATED RESULTS				
		FOR THREE MONTHS ENDED		FOR SIX MONTHS ENDED		FOR TWELVE MONTHS ENDED	FOR THREE MONTHS ENDED		FOR SIX MONTHS ENDED		FOR TWELVE MONTHS ENDED
		30 SEPT. 2026 (Un-Audited)	30 SEPT. 2025 (Un-Audited)	30 SEPT. 2026 (Un-Audited)	30 SEPT. 2025 (Un-Audited)	31 MAR. 2026 (Audited)	30 SEPT. 2026 (Un-Audited)	30 SEPT. 2025 (Un-Audited)	30 SEPT. 2026 (Un-Audited)	30 SEPT. 2025 (Un-Audited)	31 MAR. 2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	2,373.21	2,351.36	4,527.25	4,500.89	9,059.45	2,378.57	2,354.53	4,538.33	4,508.16	9,078.97
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items and Share of net profit/(loss) of joint ventures)	461.91	504.29	826.52	850.82	1,623.34	454.14	497.58	814.25	846.62	1,620.90
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax, Share of net profit/(loss) of joint ventures(after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	461.91	504.29	826.52	850.82	1,623.34	454.14	497.58	814.25	846.62	1,620.90
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	347.16	376.75	624.81	634.46	1,221.81	353.66	379.98	622.56	647.26	1,245.74
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	349.66	383.99	629.82	640.73	1,240.93	356.19	387.18	627.55	653.43	1,265.64
6	Equity Share Capital	380.81	380.81	380.81	380.81	380.81	380.81	380.81	380.81	380.81	380.81
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year					12,508.91					12,561.54
8	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 5/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) -										
	1. Basic (₹)	4.56	4.95	8.20	8.33	16.04	4.64	4.99	8.17	8.50	16.36
	2. Diluted (₹)	4.56	4.95	8.20	8.33	16.04	4.64	4.99	8.17	8.50	16.36

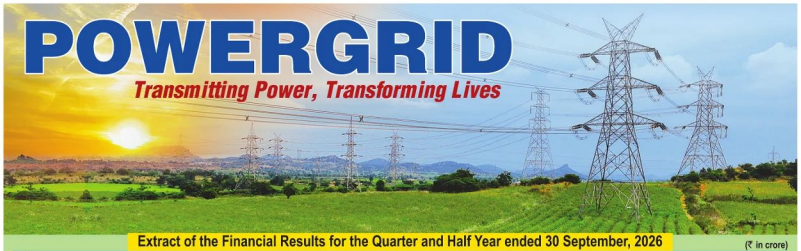
The Standalone and Consolidated Financial results of the Company for the quarter and half year ended 30th September, 2026 have been reviewed by Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors in its meeting held on 2nd November, 2026. The statutory auditors of the Company have carried out limited review of the above results for Quarter and half year ended 30th September, 2026.
Note : The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarter and half year ended Financial Results for September 30, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly and Half Yearly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchanges Websites www.nseindia.com, www.bseindia.com and on company's website www.concorindia.co.in

Scan the QR code to view the Un-Audited Financial Result

Place: Gurugram
Date : 2nd November, 2026

CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(A Navratna Undertaking of Government of India)
Regd. Office: CONCOR Bhawan, C-3, Mathura Road, Opp. Apollo Hospital, New Delhi-110076
(CIN: L63011DL1988GOI030915) | Phone: 011-41673093, 49512150/60 | Website: www.concorindia.co.in
Follow us on: @OfficialCONCOR @concor_india co.pro@concorindia.com, Email: investorrelations@concorindia.com

For & on behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
(Vivek Gupta)
Director(Finance) & CFO
DIN:11674836



Extract of the Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year ended 30 September, 2026 (₹ in crore)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone					Consolidated				
		Quarter ended		Half Year ended		Year ended	Quarter ended		Half Year ended		Year ended
		30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income	11,899.96	11,348.27	23,270.00	22,605.15	46,995.88	12,055.11	11,670.24	23,751.83	23,114.66	47,684.43
2	Profit before Tax and Regulatory Deferral Account Balances	4,369.26	3,744.13	8,615.58	7,916.40	16,759.10	4,568.44	3,878.17	9,155.76	8,163.92	17,321.03
3	Net Profit after Tax	3,819.08	3,554.80	7,230.03	7,208.03	15,921.00	3,866.16	3,566.08	7,464.58	7,196.66	15,927.95
4	Total Comprehensive Income comprising Net Profit after Tax and Other Comprehensive Income	3,872.49	3,600.98	7,323.51	7,443.92	16,066.78	3,897.32	3,612.26	7,424.53	7,433.60	16,193.78
5	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face value of share : ₹10/- each)	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60
6	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Balance sheet	96,788.94	89,196.39	96,788.94	89,196.39	90,628.01	97,447.78	89,631.05	97,447.78	89,631.05	91,193.43
7	Securities Premium Account	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28
8	Net worth	1,06,089.54	98,496.99	1,06,089.54	98,496.99	99,928.61	1,06,748.38	98,931.65	1,06,748.38	98,931.65	1,00,494.03
9	Total Borrowings	1,51,207.00	1,35,922.87	1,51,207.00	1,35,922.87	1,48,009.01	1,51,207.00	1,35,922.87	1,51,207.00	1,35,922.87	1,48,009.01
10	Debt Equity Ratio	1.43	1.38	1.43	1.38	1.48	1.42	1.37	1.42	1.37	1.47
11	Earnings per equity share including movement in Regulatory Deferral Account Balances (Face value of ₹10/- each): Basic and Diluted (in ₹) *	4.10	3.82	7.77	7.75	17.12	4.16	3.84	8.03	7.74	17.13
12	Earnings per equity share excluding movement in Regulatory Deferral Account Balances (Face value of ₹10/- each): Basic and Diluted (in ₹) *	4.01	3.26	7.79	6.96	20.15	4.06	3.28	8.04	6.95	20.11
13	Bonds Redemption Reserve	2,440.10	2,938.95	2,440.10	2,938.95	2,721.31	2,440.10	2,938.95	2,440.10	2,938.95	2,721.31
14	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	1.56	1.80	1.46	1.33	1.54	1.65	1.90	1.55	1.37	1.61
15	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	3.51	3.75	3.52	3.87	3.93	4.25	4.36	4.29	4.49	4.57

(*) Figures for the quarters and half year have not been annualized
Notes :
1. The above is an extract of the Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 and 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The Complete Financial Results are available on the Investors section of our website https://www.powergrid.in and under Corporates Section of BSE Limited & National Stock Exchange of India Limited at https://www.bseindia.com and https://www.nseindia.com respectively. These can also be accessed by scanning Quick Response Code:
2. Previous periods figures have been rearranged/reclassified wherever considered necessary.

Place : Ajmer
Date : 01 November, 2026

For and on behalf of POWER GRID CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
Sd/-
Amol Babulal Taori
Director (Finance)
DIN : 11890590

पावरग्रिड POWERGRID
POWER GRID CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
Corporate Office : "Saudamini", Plot No. 2, Sector 29, Gurugram-122001, (Haryana) Tel.: 0124-2571700-719
Registered Office : B-9, Qutab Institutional Area, Katwaria Sarai, New Delhi -110 016 Tel. : 011-26560112, 26560121
Website : www.powergrid.in **CIN :** L40101DL1989GOI038121

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A Maharatna PSU

PM: India's green-energy shift shielded it from global crises

Jasjeev Gandhiok
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday said India's decade-long shift to renewable energy had helped the country sustain high economic growth despite global disruptions, including the Covid-19 pandemic and West Asia crisis.

Inaugurating the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit & Expo 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, Modi warned that continued over-reliance on fossil fuels would repeatedly disrupt the global economy. He said the future of energy security lay in clean energy and announced that India planned to install another 500 GW of non-fossil energy capacity over the next 10 to 11 years.

"The West Asia crisis is still ongoing. But 140 crore (1.4 billion) Indians take pride in how effectively the nation has managed the turmoil while maintaining high economic growth," Modi said in his inaugural address. He said a decade of sustained domestic investment and systemic reforms in clean energy had shielded India from severe external shocks.

"If India had not invested in clean energy and created new systems for this over the past decade, then our crisis could have been much more severe than the rest of the world," he said.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, along with Union minister Pralhad Joshi, Bihar CM Samrat Choudhary, Assam CM Himanta Biswa Sarma and other dignitaries, at the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit and Expo 2026 in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

Noting that the summit coincided with the ninth assembly of the International Solar Alliance and included delegates from the Fourth Conference on Green Hydrogen, Modi said fossil reserves were finite and concentrated in a few regions, unlike the boundless and universally accessible potential of clean energy. "The future of energy security lies in clean energy," he said, describing India's 12-year clean energy journey as one defined by promises, passion and performance, exemplified by its COP-26 commitment to achieve 500 GW of non-fossil capacity by 2030.

"We have fulfilled our Paris pledge of sourcing half of the installed power capacity from non-fossil sources in 2025 — five years ahead of schedule. India now ranks among the top three nations in solar and renewable energy, with over 50% non-fossil installed capacity and nearly 300 GW already achieved towards the 500 GW target," Modi said.

"This target is somewhat difficult, but I have faith in the capability of my country; therefore I say, we will do it," he said.

Modi said India remained committed to ensuring that funding, technology and expertise reached every country in need. "For Africa, a proposal for a $200 million Africa Solar Facility has also been put forward," he said, adding that the coming decade was vital for global climate goals.

The four-day summit, which runs till November 5, 2026, will see participation from over 130 countries. India is targeting an investment of $220 billion in renewables by 2030. Multiple state chief ministers will also take part.

Reviewing the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana, launched in February 2024 to install rooftop solar panels in one crore homes, Modi said over 6.5 million households had joined the programme within 24 to 25 months, at a pace of 100,000 new homes every six days. He said the scheme had cut electricity bills by roughly 76%.

Over the past 12 years, Modi said, more than 44,000 government buildings had been connected to solar energy, saving nearly ₹700 crore annually, while the KUSUM scheme had provided solar irrigation to over 3 million farmers.

Modi said India's clean energy ecosystem extended beyond hydro, solar, wind and nuclear power, and was advancing rapidly under the National Green Hydrogen Mission, which aims to produce 5 million tonnes of green hydrogen by the end of the decade.

He acknowledged that power generation must be matched by efficient distribution from high-production solar and wind zones to regions with lower output, so that homes, farms and industries across the country benefit equally. He referred to the Centre's development of Green Energy Corridors, including transmission lines and substations supported by the 'One Nation, One Power Grid' network, which unified five regional grids onto a single frequency.

(From left) BJP general secretary Satish Poonia; former AAP MLAs Harmeet Singh Pathanmajra, Kunwar Vijay Pratap Singh, and Chetan Singh Jauramajra; and BJP Punjab president Kewal Singh Dhillon in New Delhi on Monday. HT PHOTO

Three AAP MLAs join BJP ahead of Punjab elections

Ravinder Vasudeva
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHANDIGARH: Three Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) legislators in Punjab joined the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Monday, two days after the AAP released its first list of 40 candidates for the 2027 state assembly elections.

None of the three MLAs were named in the list.

The MLAs -- Harmeet Singh Pathanmajra from Sanaur segment of Patiala district, Chetan Singh Jouramajra from Samana seat of Patiala and former Amritsar North MLA Kunwar Vijay Pratap Singh -- were inducted into the BJP in the presence of party's national general secretary and state in-charge Satish Poonia.

Pathanmajra resigned from AAP on Sunday, while Kunwar Vijay Pratap Singh, who was suspended in 2025 for "anti-party activities", submitted his resignation from the assembly on Monday. Jouramajra announced his exit on social media on Sunday, without formally resigning from the party.

Speaker in the state assembly Kultar Singh Sandhwan accepted the resignations of Pratap Singh and Pathanmajra, while Jouramajra was issued a notice over his "anti-party activities".

Addressing a press conference later in the day, the three leaders launched a scathing attack against the AAP government, accusing it of failing to manage the drug-menace in the state and pushing Punjab into debt.

Welcoming the three leaders, Poonia said their political, social and administrative experience would strengthen the BJP's campaign in Punjab.

Punjab Congress described the ruling party as a "sinking ship" and said that more leaders would quit in the coming days. The Congress further alleged that the AAP leadership in Delhi had exercised undue influence over Punjab's government.

Meanwhile, AAP state president Aman Arora alleged that the BJP had no leadership, agenda, or political base but wanted to win Punjab with the help of leaders facing allegations. "The AAP has taken action against its own MLAs, while the BJP was welcoming them into its ranks," he claimed in a statement.

AAP spokesperson Neel Garg asked the BJP leaders to stop worrying about the AAP and instead focus on their own party's declining political base and credibility.

ED RAIDS PJB CONG LEADER'S PREMISES IN PMLA CASE

CHANDIGARH: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Monday searched the premises of former Punjab minister and Congress leader Sunder Sham Arora, his family members and others in connection with a money laundering investigation, officials said.

The agency searched 14 premisses, including the residences of 68-year-old Arora, his son Prateek, and directors and associates of GRG Developers and Promoters LLP, SRG Developers and Gulmohar Township Group, officials said.

The money-laundering probe under PMLA originates from cases registered by the Punjab Vigilance Bureau involving alleged corruption, disproportionate assets, and irregularities in PSIEC plot allotments and ownership changes.

Key among the allegations is the sale of 31 acres of prime land belonging to the liquidated JCT Electronics in Mohali to a private realtor for a township project during Arora's tenure as minister. HTC

ASI SUSPENDED OVER RECOVERY OF DRUGS IN PJB

CHANDIGARH: An assistant sub-inspector, posted in Ludhiana's Khanna, was suspended after a purported video showing him allegedly keeping a packet under the mattress at the house of Shiv Sena leader Mahant Kashmir Giri surfaced, police said on Monday. Giri was arrested in connection with the "recovery of drugs" from his residence on Saturday in Khanna.

Police later discharged Giri after the purported video captured from a hidden camera at his residence showed a policeman in plain clothes allegedly entering the room and placing a packet under the mattress.

Khanna SSP Darpan Ahluwalia placed ASI Sukhdev Singh under suspension. She also formed an SIT under the SP to investigate the matter. PTI

Mumbai's mayor slams BMC over Dia Mirza's Diwali video

Linah Baliga
leena.baliga@htlive.com

MUMBAI: The mayor of Mumbai, Ritu Tawde, lashed out at actor Dia Mirza over her participation in the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation's (BMC) firecracker-free Diwali campaign, saying she did not need to tell Hindus how to celebrate their festival. Tawde also reprimanded the BMC administration for including Mirza in the campaign, saying the decision was taken without consulting the civic body's political leadership.

"Dia Mirza does not need to teach us how Hindus should celebrate Diwali. We know how to celebrate our own Diwali. Her selective agenda is becoming increasingly evident. That is why we opposed her video," Tawde told reporters after the BMC removed Mirza's campaign video from its website and social media accounts.

The video, featuring Mirza's appeal to citizens not to burst firecrackers or contribute to air and noise pollution, was removed after BJP Mumbai president Ameet Satam objected to the actor's participation in the anti-firecracker campaign.

"We don't need lessons on how to celebrate #Diwali from @deespeak. Our traditions are deeply rooted in our culture," Satam wrote in a post on X.

Dia Mirza

Tawde referred to Satam's post and said it represented the position of all BJP corporators.

Tawde accused Mirza of repeatedly opposing PM Narendra Modi and his initiatives and taking positions against Hindutva. She clarified that though Mumbai belongs to people of all religions and she and other BJP corporators worked for everyone, their agenda was Hindutva.

Meanwhile, deputy mayor Sanjay Ghadi, from the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena, questioned the objections to Mirza's campaign video and its removal from BMC's portal. He said the actor had done nothing wrong by urging citizens to refrain from bursting firecrackers.

HC permits Imran to stay in India after he tenders apology

Karuna Nidhi
karuna.nidhi@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Bombay High Court on Monday allowed actor Imran Khan, a US citizen and an Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholder, to continue staying in India after he tendered an "unconditional apology" for his alleged participation in a protest against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The court was hearing a petition filed by the actor challenging the Foreigners Regional Registration Officer's (FRRO's) Leave India Notice issued to him on October 15. A division bench of chief justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi and justice Advait Sethna said OCI cardholders like Khan are "at the mercy of the country and cannot live here and criticise it."

Questioning why Khan had attended the protest, held near August Kranti Maidan in Mumbai on October 10, when he was neither an Indian citizen nor entitled to vote in the country, the judges remarked, "If you were an Indian citizen, it would have been okay, but you're an OCI card holder. You can't act like an Indian citizen. You weren't even remotely connected to the protest."

Khan has, however, denied violating the rules, saying no agitation was underway when he reached the spot and that he did not cross the police barricades to enter the protest site. He said he was apprehended after media personnel surrounded him while he was returning to his vehicle.

Imran Khan

Senior advocate Venkatesh Dhond, appearing for Khan, argued that the action against him was disproportionate, considering he has lived in India for more than four decades.

Additional solicitor general Anil Singh, appearing for the FRRO, opposed Khan's petition, contending that he had participated in multiple illegal protests, given interviews to the press, and posted content on social media that allegedly instigated people. "If I have given you a visa, it is my discretion to ask you to leave. It is an admitted position that he's a US citizen," he added.

In his undertaking, Khan has submitted that he has no criminal antecedents and has "utmost love and respect for this great nation and its Constitution". He said, "I have never made any demands and have categorically stated that I am no one to make any demands. I was present there to see why the freedom of movement was being restricted and why people's voices were being oppressed and suppressed".

The bench also cautioned the actor, who has lived in India since childhood and built his career here, against assuming that his celebrity status placed him on an equal footing with Indian citizens. "You are a celebrity, a star. Your one statement can have a decisive effect. Young people are following you," the judges said, cautioning that the actor against involving himself in such activities in the future.

"You're a responsible person, you come from a responsible family. You can't say you didn't know about the consequences. Your livelihood, your bread butter, was earned in India but you cannot be put at par with Indian citizens," the judges added.

The court directed the Centre to file its affidavit in response to Khan's petition and posted the matter for further hearing on December 7.

SC TO HEAR AZAM'S PETITION AGAINST ARREST THIS WEEK

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to hear this week Samajwadi Party (SP) leader Azam Khan's plea, challenging his arrest by Enforcement Directorate (ED) after he got bail in a dual PAN card case.

Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant agreed to list the plea as he heard its urgent mention, expressing reservation over approaching the top court instead of first moving the high court. "Have faith in the high court. It has granted him relief in the past. We can relegate the matter to the high court and request the chief justice to hear it without any delay," said CJI Kant.

On Sunday, a court in Ghaziabad sent Khan to 14-day judicial custody in a case linked to Mohammad Ali Jauhar University in Rampur. ABRAHAM THOMAS

HDK denies 'sting op' phone was delivered to his Delhi residence

Arun Dev
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: Union minister HD Kumaraswamy on Monday denied allegations that a mobile phone used to upload a "sting operation" video targeting former Karnataka chief minister Siddaramaiah was delivered to his official residence in New Delhi, accusing the state government of orchestrating a cover-up.

"Where was the accused Ritesh Pandey arrested from in Delhi? Was he arrested at my residence? The investigation team did not arrest him at Kumaraswamy's house. What address did he give in the police case? He may have said he was at Kumaraswamy's house, but he was arrested in Ghaziabad," Kumaraswamy said, refuting allegations made by Bengaluru police commissioner Seemant Kumar Singh.

On Sunday, the police commissioner told reporters in Bengaluru that the second-hand phone was purchased from a Karol Bagh shop by Vinod Sharma and Ritesh Pandey on the instructions of Prajwal Prasad. "They later handed the phone over to Prajwal Prasad at Kumaraswamy's official residence in Delhi," Singh told reporters, citing Pandey's statement to the police.

Vinod Sharma and Prajwal Prasad are associated with Kumaraswamy's social media team and have been summoned by the Central Crime Branch (CCB). Pandey was arrested on October 24, the first person to be arrested in the case after CCB took over the probe.

HD Kumaraswamy and Siddaramaiah

The controversy centres on footage allegedly recorded in 2023 about an incident said to have occurred in 2011. The video surfaced online in September and was subsequently circulated on social media and broadcast by TV channels. On October 29, Bengaluru police said the allegations of sexual abuse portrayed in a viral video linked to Siddaramaiah were part of a fabricated and constructed narrative.

Karnataka home minister Priyank Kharge said the police possess "irrefutable technical evidence" linking multiple individuals associated with Kumaraswamy to the video's circulation. "If Kumaraswamy is serious about this investigation, he should tell his staff to appear before the police instead of seeking anticipatory bail," he said.

NCP delegation meets Shah; party denies rift speculation

Faisal Malik
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: A group of senior Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) leaders met Union home minister Amit Shah in Delhi late on Sunday, said people aware of the matter, triggering further speculation of turmoil within the regional party that failed to win a single seat in the recently concluded Maharashtra legislative polls.

The party denied any internal rift, saying the meeting – which happened in the absence of deputy chief minister Sunetra Pawar and her son, MP Parth Pawar, according to an official statement by the NCP – was a pre-arranged, formal engagement.

NCP national working president Praful Patel, Maharashtra unit chief Sunil Tatkare, senior ministers Chhagan Bhujbal and Hasan Mushrif, and senior leaders Dilip Walse Patil and Dhananjay Munde were among those who visited Shah, the people said.

Dilip Walse Patil told PTI that all leaders who met Shah returned to Mumbai. "The core group will meet now and DCM Sunetra Pawar in the evening," he said.

A senior NCP leader who attended the meeting said the leaders expressed unhappiness over the way the party was being managed by Sunetra and Parth Pawar. Talks about a merger with the Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) was not the focus of the meeting, this person said. Sunetra Pawar and Parth Pawar are opposed to any merger with the NCP (SP), which is part of the Opposition INDIA bloc.

> NCP LEADERS EXPRESSED UNHAPPINESS WITH THE WAY SUNETRA AND PARTH PAWAR WERE MANAGING THE PARTY, SAID A SENIOR LEADER

"The leaders who met Shah were the same faces who had met CM Fadnavis to say that they are opposed to a merger, which makes their meeting with Shah politically significant," said a senior NCP leader. "The fact that the Union home minister is entertaining them also makes the development more important in the backdrop of an open rift within the NCP," said a second NCP leader.

The developments come more than a week after Sunetra Pawar and Parth Pawar met Shah in Delhi, where they expressed their opposition to a merger, said people aware of the matter.

Last week, the NCP lost the Aurangabad graduate seat after 18 years in the legislative council polls. The party has also been demanding the finance portfolio, which was held by the late Ajit Pawar till his death in a tragic plane crash in January.

Officially, the party denied any speculation of dissent.

"Sunetra Pawar and Parth Pawar had earlier met Shah and discussed various issues facing the party following the death of Ajit Pawar. During that meeting, Sunetra Pawar had informed Shah that a delegation of senior party leaders would meet him and requested him to give them time," party spokesperson Umesh Patil said.

The senior leaders were well-versed with important issues from Ajit Pawar's tenure, matters concerning the state's interests and various party-related issues, he said, adding the meeting was held in this context. The leaders also raised various issues concerning their respective constituencies and held informal discussions with their counterparts from the Mahayuti alliance, Patil said.

"Attempts are being made to give an unnecessary political twist to the meeting and create a narrative of internal differences and lack of coordination within the party. The NCP is an important constituent of the Mahayuti alliance and remains united under the leadership of Sunetra Pawar," he said.

Rumours of a rift within the NCP began soon after Sunetra Pawar took charge as NCP chief in February and introduced a series of organisational and constitutional changes. Among the most contentious was the removal of senior leaders such as Praful Patel as national working president and Sunil Tatkare as Maharashtra state president. She later clarified that the omissions were inadvertent, but the changes were never reversed.

Probe ordered into assault claim by 17 TN recaptured inmates

BENGALURU: A week after 17 undertrial prisoners escaped from a sub jail in Theni district of Tamil Nadu and were later caught and brought back to custody by police, TN State Legal Services Authority on Monday ordered a probe into allegations of torture, assault and intimidation involving the inmates.

Keralam to move SC on Mullaperiyar safety inspection

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: The Keralam government will approach the Supreme Court and file a special leave petition to ensure the implementation of its 2024 judgment permitting a detailed safety inspection of the Mullaperiyar dam in Idukki district, state water resources minister Mons Joseph said on Monday.

SC dismisses ex-TN min's plea against HC's graft case order

NEW DELHI : The Supreme Court on Monday dismissed a petition filed by former Tamil Nadu minister KN Nehru challenging the direction by Madras high court to register FIR against him in a corruption case. The court said the present order will not preclude him from raising his defence at the appropriate stage.

HC RECONSTITUTES S.I.T PROBING KPSC HIRING GAPS CASE

BENGALURU: The Karnataka High Court has replaced two IPS officers and ordered the re-inclusion of another in the special investigation team (SIT) probing alleged irregularities in Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) recruitments, people aware of the matter said on Monday.

The court replaced IPS officers Alok Kumar and Divya Gopinath with ADGP (law and order), R Hitendra, and ADGP (administration) Soumyendra Mukherjee.

Justice M Nagaprasanna said the bench would not make any further changes to the team and directed the state government to bring back IPS officer Kushal Chouksey, who had been transferred after being nominated to the SIT by the court in its September 21 order. The court also allowed ED to be impleaded in the proceedings. ARUN DEV

Andhra, Odisha brace for 2nd cyclone

HT Correspondents
letters@hindustantimes.com

HYDERABAD/CHENNAI/BHUBANESWAR: Thousands of people have been relocated to safer areas in Odisha and at least 19 domestic flights have been cancelled in Andhra Pradesh as the eastern states are bracing for a fresh severe cyclone "Murasu" within a week after a very severe cyclone, even as some parts received heavy rainfall on Monday.

According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), Cyclone Murasu was centred over the west-central Bay of Bengal, about 120 km east-southeast of Nellore in Andhra Pradesh, and expects to make landfall between Nellore and Narsapur between late Monday and early Tuesday, with wind speed expected to cross 100 kilometre-per-hour. The wind speed will gradually reduce to 60-70 kmph six to seven hours after the landfall, the met department said.

A fishing boat sails in the Bay of Bengal amid high waves triggered by cyclone Murasu in Chennai on Monday. ANI

In Odisha, more than 160,000 people have been moved to safer areas and the state government is expected to relocate a total of 330,000 people. Some southern Odisha districts have announced closure of schools and colleges till November 3.

In Andhra Pradesh, at least 19 domestic flights were cancelled at Vijayawada, Tirupati and Visakhapatnam airports in Andhra Pradesh on Monday. Three NDRF teams of 90 personnel have been deployed to support disaster management efforts.

In Tamil Nadu, heavy rains lashed several parts of Chennai and Tiruvallur on Monday with more rain expected on Tuesday. Over the past 24 hours, Madharavam recorded 11 cm of rainfall, while Ennore Port recorded 10 cm. Nungambakkam also reported significant rainfall of 10 cm, an official said.

RESCUE OP ON TO FIND 12 PEOPLE DAYS AFTER ODISHA LANDSLIDE

BHUBANESWAR: Five days after a landslide buried seven houses in a remote village in Ganjam district in Odisha, nearly 200 rescuers are struggling to reach 12 missing people beneath tonnes of earth and massive boulders, with difficult terrain and the absence of motorable access delaying efforts to clear the debris, officials said.

Three sniffer dogs, life-detection equipment and radars have been deployed, while rescuers are preparing to blast massive rocks with gelatine sticks to create an opening in the debris and intensify the search.

SC warns against quashing rape cases over settlements

Utkarsh Anand
letters@hindustantimes.com

The case came up in a petition for pre-arrest bail by an accused in a rape case.

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has warned courts against quashing criminal cases involving serious offences, particularly rape, merely because the accused and complainant have reached a settlement, observing that a trial could be the best way to establish whether a complaint was false and motivated by the prospect of a financial settlement or whether the compromise was secured through coercion.

The court underlined that settlements in such cases could be driven by pressure from the accused, while also flagging the possibility of false accusations raised in the hope of extracting money through a compromise. It said both possibilities needed serious examination. "...we cannot but reiterate our caution insofar as false accusations being raised on the lure of a financial settlement and also on the other hand settlements, motivated by coercion," a bench of justices JB Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran observed.

Setting aside a Madhya Pradesh high court order that had quashed a rape complaint against a man by invoking its inherent powers after the parties reportedly entered into a compromise, the Supreme Court directed that the trial proceed, while separately granting the accused anticipatory bail.

The case came before the top court in a rape accused's petition seeking anticipatory bail, earlier rejected by the high court. During the proceedings, the bench was informed that the complainant and the accused had settled their differences and that the high court had subsequently quashed the criminal complaint under Section 528 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which confers inherent powers on high courts.

The bench pointed out that rape is a serious, non-compoundable offence and cannot be treated as a purely private dispute amenable to settlement between the parties.It arranged for the complainant to interact with it virtually from the office of the district legal services authority in Rajgarh district's Pachore, while its secretary was present.

The interaction reinforced the court's apprehensions.

The woman told the judges that she had been coerced into entering the settlement, was not willing to accept it, and needed money for a settlement. She categorically maintained that she had lodged the complaint and that the allegations made in it were true.

The bench clarified that the veracity of her allegations would have to be tested during the trial and that it was not expressing any opinion on the merits of the case. It also said its observations should not influence the trial.

In examining the legal position, the court distinguished earlier rulings which allowed quashing of criminal proceedings after settlements.

It pointed out that those cases largely concerned disputes of a personal, civil or commercial nature, where continuation of the criminal process served little purpose.

Referring to its judgments in Gian Singh Vs State of Punjab (2012) and Narinder Singh vs State of Punjab (2014), among others, the bench reiterated that the inherent powers of high courts to quash criminal proceedings under Section 482 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (now Section 528 of the BNSS) are distinct from the statutory power to compound offences under Section 320 of the CrPC. While inherent powers could be used to secure the ends of justice and prevent abuse of the court's process, the court said it could not be invoked to terminate proceedings involving heinous and serious offences such as rape, murder and dacoity merely due to a settlement.

While restoring the criminal proceedings, the court allowed the plea of the accused for bail, directing that he be released subject to the conditions imposed by the trial court.

It also required him to cooperate with the investigation and appear before the trial court whenever summoned.

KOCHI MERC CASE: JUDGE BOOKED FOR TRYING TO DESTROY EVIDENCE

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: The additional district judge whose 17-year-old son rammed his Mercedes into a scooter and killed the rider in Kochi last month, was booked under fresh charges of trying to destroy evidence on Monday following a complaint by the victim's family, police said.

The judge was earlier booked on charges of culpable homicide not amounting to murder, along with rash and negligent driving of the BNS, and under provisions of the Motor Vehicle Act.

The family of the victim, Jayabalakrishnan, on Sunday registered a fresh complaint, alleging he spent a lot of time at the accident site in a bid to destroy evidence and also forced a police officer to delete a photograph of his son clicked by a member of the victim's family. Kochi police commissioner R Nishanthini confirmed the complaint.

The judge was granted interim protection from arrest by the high court on Thursday. After the court's order, Jayalakshmi, the victim's niece, said: "The accused judge is trying all the tricks to get himself relieved from the case."

{ TAMIL NADU ACCOUNTS FOR MOST VACANCIES }

Spl NEET-UG round to help fill 944 MBBS vacant seats

Sanjay Maurya and Ridhima Gupta
letters@hindustantimes.com

Results will be declared on November 7, and candidates must report to their allotted colleges by November 16.

NEW DELHI: The Medical Counselling Committee (MCC) has scheduled a special stray vacancy round for NEET-UG 2026 after 944 MBBS seats remained vacant following four rounds of counselling, including the regular stray round that concluded on October 26. Of these, 920 seats are in deemed universities and 24 in government medical colleges. Tamil Nadu accounts for the highest number of vacancies at 686, followed by Puducherry with 186, officials told HT.

Besides Tamil Nadu and Puducherry, vacancies in deemed universities are concentrated in Karnataka (25), Maharashtra (10) and Telangana (4), among other states. Andhra Pradesh accounts for the highest number of vacant seats in government medical colleges, with five.

The special round will run from November 2 to 16. Registration closes on November 4 at 3pm, with payment open until 6pm. Choice filling and locking will continue until 11am on November 5, followed by seat-allotment processing on November 5 and 6. Results will be declared on November 7, and candidates must report to their allotted colleges by November 16. MCC has held additional rounds in 2021, 2023, 2024 and 2025. This year's counselling follows the NEET-UG paper leak controversy, which led to cancellation of the May 3 exam and a retest on June 21.

Under the Directorate General of Health Services, MCC handles 15% All India Quota seats in state government colleges, all deemed-university seats and MBBS seats at central institutions such as AIIMS, JIPMER and BHU. States handle the remaining government-college seats and counselling for private colleges affiliated with state universities.

India has 140,664 MBBS seats for 2026-27, including 64,121 in government colleges and 76,543 in private institutions, according to the National Medical Commission's seat matrix. MCC's counselling pool comprised 27,292 seats, including 16,975 in deemed universities and 10,317 in other institutions.

Concerns over high fees

The large number of vacancies in deemed universities has renewed concerns over the cost of medical education. Annual tuition at several such institutions ranges from ₹25 lakh to ₹35 lakh. Students pay tuition for 4.5 years of the five-and-a-half-year MBBS programme, which includes a compulsory one-year internship.

Dr Lakshya Mittal, chairperson of the United Doctors Front, said fee disparities were forcing even high-scoring NEET candidates to forgo seats. "In one state, MBBS fees are around ₹5 lakh, while in another state like Tamil Nadu, they are around ₹20 lakh. Why is there such a huge difference when the education is the same?" he said, calling for fee rationalisation through an effective regulatory mechanism.

Private medical colleges are generally trust- or society-run, affiliated with state universities and regulated by state fee committees. Deemed universities, granted status under Section 3 of the UGC Act, can award degrees independently and have greater fee-setting flexibility, subject to regulations.

The difference can be substantial. Dhanalakshmi Srinivasan Medical College in Perambalur, established in 2011, was previously affiliated with Tamil Nadu Dr MGR Medical University. After obtaining deemed-university status for 2026-27, its annual MBBS tuition rose to ₹24 lakh, from earlier state-regulated fees of ₹5.4 lakh for state-quota seats and ₹16.2 lakh for management-quota seats. Tuition for 4.5 years is estimated at ₹1.09 crore, excluding hostel and mess charges.

In March 2022, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced that fees for half the seats in private medical colleges would be at par with government colleges. NMC guidelines issued that year provided for government-college-equivalent fees for 50% of sanctioned seats, with preference to candidates allotted government-quota seats. The NMC separately directed deemed universities to implement the provisions from the 2022-23 academic session.

The Association of Health Sciences Institutes, representing unaided private medical and nursing institutions in West Bengal, challenged the guidelines in 2022, arguing that fee fixation was a state-level responsibility. The Supreme Court transferred similar petitions to itself in January 2024 and admitted them for final hearing in April. Proceedings have since been deferred.

In June 2026, the Supreme Court refused to entertain an EWS medical student's plea to reduce his ₹18.9-lakh annual fee at a private Rajasthan college, but left the broader question of NMC's fee-parity guidelines open.

The NMC did not respond to HT's queries. A senior official said fee fixation was ultimately a state-level matter and the recommendations had not been adopted uniformly.

"Among the states, only Telangana is following the recommendations, with 50% of seats being charged at par with government medical colleges in the respective state," the official said, requesting anonymity.

CCTV cameras on a property can't hinder privacy of neighbours: HC

Jitendra Sarin
letters@hindustantimes.com

PRAYAGRAJ: The Allahabad high court has ruled that private CCTV cameras cannot be installed in a manner that interferes with the privacy of a neighbour.

A division bench of justices Ajit Kumar and Garima Prashad made the observation while disposing of a writ petition filed by Yogendra Maurya, who submitted that his neighbour positioned a CCTV camera to cover the entry and exit points of his residence. He argued that this orientation recorded the movements of individuals entering or leaving the premises, violating his right to privacy. Advocate Akhilesh Kumar Yadav served as Maurya's counsel.

THE BENCH ORDERED THE PETITIONER TO FILE AN APPLICATION TO THE DISTRICT MAGISTRATE

The bench, in its order, which was dated October 26, observed that, "In our considered view, no private CCTV camera can be installed and positioned in such a manner as to interfere with the privacy of a neighbour."

Rather than issuing a direct order to remove or alter the camera, the Bench directed the petitioner to file an application before the district magistrate.

"In these circumstances, we dispose of this petition with a direction to the petitioner to file an application before the District Magistrate concerned. In the event, the petitioner files such an application, the District Magistrate concerned shall consider and decide the same within a period of one month," ordered the bench.

Veeramani identified in jail by victim: Police

S Vijay Karthik
letters@hindustantimes.com

R Veeramani

CHENNAI: One of the minor victims of alleged sexual assault by Tamil Nadu granite businessman R Veeramani has identified him in an identification parade conducted in Chennai's Puzhal Central Jail,a senior police officer said on Sotondor.

The officer said that so far, eight minors have recorded statements alleging sexual assault in court against Veeramani.

Meanwhile, the special investigation team (SIT) probing the case is trying to get the passport of Prakash K, one of the key accused in the case, impounded and have him extradited, as he is absconding and is believed to be in the United Kingdom (UK), people aware of the matter said. He has been identified as one of the people involved in financial transactions, including with police personnel, to help Veeramani , evade arrest in the case.

Public Work Department
Office of the Executive Engineer Public Works (West) Division Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar
Address :- Public Works Premise, Padampura, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar- 431005
E-mail address :- westaurangabad.ee@mahapwd.gov.in
Telephone/Fax Number :- 0240 2331288

E-Tender Notice No.(16) of 2026-27

E-Tender for the following work in B-1 Tender Form is invited via online e- tendering system from Eligible Contractor by the Executive Engineer, Public Works (west) Division, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar on behalf of Public Works Department, Government of Maharashtra Tender Document are downloaded from government portal **https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in** Right to select or reject is reserved by Executive Engineer, Public works (west) Division, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar. Conditional Tender will be not accepted. (Number of 03 Works)
All information of e-tender is available on following portal.)
A) **https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in**
B) **https://mahatenders.gov.in**
If any change made in this e-tender is informed on above portal.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer,
Public works (west) Division,
Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar

DGIPR/2026-27/ROC 3539

PUBLIC NOTICE
MUNICIPAL CORPORATION GURUGRAM
Plot No. C-1, Info City, Sector-34, Gurugram
[Under the proviso to section 217(2) of the Haryana Municipal Corporation Act, 1994]

INVITING OBJECTIONS/SUGGESTIONS ON THE PROPOSED PERMANENT CLOSURE OF A PART OF THE PUBLIC STREET IN KHASRA NO. 764, VILLAGE NATHUPUR, GURUGRAM

1. Notice is hereby given that the Municipal Corporation Gurugram has under consideration a proposal, under section 217(2) of the Haryana Municipal Corporation Act, 1994, for the permanent closure of approximately 2.00 acres (8,141 sq. metres) of the land comprised in Khasra No. 764, Village Nathupur, Tehsil and District Gurugram (total area approx. 5.38 acres, recorded as "Gair Mumkin Rasta"), and for the re-planning of the remaining portion as an 18.00-metre-wide public road, maintaining access to the Government School and the adjoining areas.
2. The detailed notice, along with the existing and re-planned layout plans, is available on the website of the Corporation at **https://www.mcg.gov.in/** and may be inspected on any working day during office hours at the office of the Senior Town Planner, MCG office, Plot No. C-1, Info City, Sector-34, Gurugram.
3. Residents likely to be affected and other concerned persons may submit their objections/suggestions in writing to the Commissioner, Municipal Corporation Gurugram, at the above address or by e-mail at **cmc@mcg.gov.in** & **stp@mcg.gov.in**, **within one month from the date of publication of this notice, i.e. up to 5:00 PM on 30.11.2026**. Objections received thereafter shall not be considered.

Date: 31.10.2026

Commissioner
Municipal Corporation Gurugram

RO No. 1078/11/1150/2027/50710/C/19/7

नालको NALCO
National Aluminium Company Limited
(A Government of India Enterprise)

NALCO Bhawan, Plot No. P/1, Nayapalli, Bhubaneswar-751013, Odisha
(CIN : L27203OR1981GOI000920)
A NAVRATNA COMPANY

NOTICE

The Board of Directors in their meeting held on 02nd November, 2026 has declared interim dividend @ Rs. 4.50/- per share for the financial year 2026-27.

In this connection, notice is hereby given that 06th November, 2026 has been fixed as 'Record Date' for payment of interim dividend for the financial year 2026-27.

Interim Dividend will be paid to those shareholders whose names appear:

a. as beneficial owners as at the end of the business hours on 06.11.2026 as per the beneficial owners position to be downloaded by NSDL & CDSL in respect of the shares held in the electronic form and

b. as members in the Register of Members of the Company, after giving effect to transmission/ transposition if any, in physical form lodged with the Company on or before 06.11.2026.

Dividend income is taxable in the hands of the shareholders w.e.f. 01.04.2020 and starting from April 1, 2025, the TDS threshold on dividend income for resident shareholders increases from Rs. 5,000 to Rs. 10,000 per financial year.

Information about the record date is also available on the website of the Company i.e. **www.nalcoindia.com** and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com.**

Further, it is brought to the notice of shareholders that pursuant to the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Fifth Amendment Regulations, 2025, notified on 18th November 2025, issuance of Payable-at-Par Warrants/ Cheques for dividend payments has been withdrawn. Accordingly, the Company will make the dividend payment only through electronic modes. No Demand Drafts will also be issued against electronic remittances rejected for any reason. Shareholders are requested to ensure that their bank account details are updated and validated in their demat account (for electronic holdings) and with the Registrar and Transfer Agent (for physical holdings) to enable seamless electronic credit of dividends.

For **National Aluminium Company Limited**
Sd/-
(B. K. Sahu)
CGM & Company Secretary

Place : Bhubaneswar
Date : 02.11.2026

MADHYA PRADESH TOURISM BOARD
6th Floor, Lily Trade Wing, Jahangirabad, Bhopal M.P.
India. Pin Code-462008, Web. : www.tourism.mp.gov.in
CIN: U75302MP2017NPL043078

"REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL"

Nit & System No.	Project Name
NIT No.:6177/ योजना/म.प्र.टू.बो/ 2026 and SYSTEM No.:2026_ MPTB_547154 Dated 02.11.2026	1. Request for Proposal for Appointment of Agency for Development of Tourist Experience/Museum & Immersive Experience Centre and for Operations, Maintenance & Management of Ahilya Lok at Maheshwar, Madhya Pradesh, India.
NIT No.: 6177/ योजना/म.प्र.टू.बो/ 2026 and SYSTEM No.:2026_ MPTB_547162 Dated 02.11.2026	2. Request for Proposal for Appointment of Agency for Development of Experience Curation & Development for Immersive Experience, Interactive Exhibits in museum and for Operations, Maintenance & Management of Atal Smarak Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh, India.

MPTB invites offers for **"Request for Proposal for Appointment of Agencies for Execution/Development of projects as detailed above for Operations, Maintenance & Management of Ahilya Lok Maheshwar and Atal Smarak Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh, India"** The detailed terms & conditions can be downloaded from website https://www.mptenders.gov.in/www.tourism.mp.gov.in For any other information please contact. **Mob. No. +91-9993574567** or e-mail at **jdplg.mptb@mp.gov.in.** Last Date and Time for online submission of the RFP is 19.11.2026 @ 17:00 Hr.

M.P. Madhyam/128902/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Sunil Parbhu Ji S/o:** Unknown **R/o** Unknown, was found Dead on 28.10.2026, from Dr. BSA Hospital, Sector-6, Rohini, Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 31A, Dated 28.10.2026,** has been lodged at **Police Station Kanjhawala, Rohini Distt., Delhi.** Identification of unidentified dead body of male is as under:

Sex: Male, **Age:** 55 Yrs, **Height:** 5'4", **Complexion:** Shallow **Wearing:** White & Blue Lining Kurta. The dead body of deceased has been preserved for 72 hours in Dr. Baba Saheb Ambedkar, Hospital Mortuary, Delhi for identification.

If any one having any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be informed undersigned.

SHO,
Police Station Kanjhawala,
Rohini Distt., Delhi
DP/15813/RD/2026 **Ph.: 9968014740**

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Anshu Devi

General Public is hereby informed that one girl namely **Anshu Devi D/o Shyam Lal R/o Village Laxmanpur, P.O. Manikpur Kalyanpur, Distt. Chitrakoot, Uttar Pradesh Age:** 19 Years, **Height:** 5', **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Built:** Normal, **Face:** Round, wearing Pink colour Top and Blue colour Jeans, has been missing from B-1/209, Unity Amayrillis Society, Kishan Ganj, Delhi since **21.10.2026** at 01:00 P.M. In this regard a missing report vide **FIR No. 391/2026 dated 27.10.2026 U/s 140(3) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, has been registered at P.S. Desh Bandhu Gupta Road, Delhi.**

Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to trace out the girl but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone having any information about her please inform to the undersigned.

Website : http://cbi.nic.in
E-mail : cic@cbi.gov.in
Fax: 011-24368639
Ph. No. : 011-24368638, 24368641

SHO
P.S. Desh Bandhu Gupta Road, Delhi
DP/15762/CD/2026 **Ph.: 9968210135, 8750870429**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Unknown S/o:** Unknown **R/o** Unknown, was found Dead on 04.10.2026, from Safdarjung Hospital, New Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 28A, Dated 04.10.2026,** has been lodged at **Police Station Safdarjung Enclave, South-West Distt., New Delhi.** Identification of unidentified dead body of male is as under:

Sex: Male, **Age:** 72 Yrs, **Height:** 165 CM, **Complexion:** Fair, **Identification Mark:** Old Scar Mark on Left Leg, **Wearing:** White Shirt & Black Pant. The dead body of deceased has been preserved for 72 hours in Safdarjung Hospital Mortuary, Delhi for identification.

If any one having any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be informed undersigned.

SHO,
Police Station Safdarjung Enclave,
South-West Distt., New Delhi
DP/15765/SW/2026 **Ph.: 9970912375**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that this Person **Named:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** 60 years, **Sex:** Male, **Height:** 5'7", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **ID Mark:** Mole on it side of cheeck, **Wearing:** Linedar Blue & White colour Shirt & White colour Pant with Black colour Belt, **Place of Recovery:** He was admitted in SGM Hospital Emergency, Mangol Puri, Delhi on Date 26.10.2026, where **MLC No. 28732/2026** during the treatment Dr. declared brought him dead on . In this regard **DD No. 06A, Dated: 26.10.2026,** has been registered at P.S.: Mangol Puri, Delhi.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about identity of this person but no clue has come to light so far. If any person having any information or clue about this person may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S.: Mangol Puri, Delhi
DP/15802/OD/2026 **Ph.: 7065036122, 8700403771**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified male namely **Unknown, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown was found dead on 30.10.2026 from the place of Pul Mithai Lahori Gate, Delhi.** In this regard **DD No. 23A, Dated: 30.10.2026** has been lodged at Police Station **Lahori Gate, Delhi.** The body has been kept at preserved in Subzi Mandi Mortuary under Token No. 688/26 for identification. Physical Description of unidentified male dead body is as under:

Name: Unknown, Age: About 40-45 Years, Height: 5'2", Complexion: Wheatish, Face: Round, Built: Medium, Wearing: Blue and Red Colour Full Sleeve T-shirt & Black Colour Lower, ID Mark: A black Mole on Chest.

If anyone have any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be inform undersigned.

SHO
Police Station Lahori Gate, Delhi
DP/15837/N/2026 **Ph.: 9318430923, 9013341499**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that a Male (depicted in the photo) Namely: **Unknown, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown** was found dead at **Pole No. 252 KM No. 1011-1012, Near Nala, Car Parking Hanuman Mandir, Yamuna Bazar, Delhi on 24.10.2026 at 10.51 P.M.** In this regard vide **DD No.51A dated 24.10.2026** has been registered at **P.S. Old Delhi Railway Station, Railway District, Delhi.**

The description of the deceased is given as below:

Name: Unknown, **Sex:** Male, **Age:** 45-50 Years (Approx.), **Height:** 5'5", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Identification Mark:** Tatoo Jitender on Right Hand, **Wearing:** Black Pant and Brown Kurta.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to identify the man but no clue has come to light so far. Anyone having information about the person, please inform the undersigned.

SHO
P.S Old Delhi Railway Station, Delhi
Ph.: 011-23961522,
DP/15843/RLY/2026 **8178126028, 8178126028**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Alok Mishra, S/o. Gajender Mishra, R/o. H.No. 144/87, DDA Flat South Enclave, Dakshin Puri, Pushpa Bhawan, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No. 489/2024 U/S 209 BNS** registered at **P.S Neb Sarai, South Distt, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Alok Mishra** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Alok Mishra** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Alok Mishra**, accused of **FIR No. 489/2024 U/S 209 BNS, P.S Neb Sarai, South Distt, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.12.2026.**

By Order, Ms. Devanshi Janmeja,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
DP/15659/SD/2026 **South District, Room No. 212, Second Floor**
(Court Matter) **Saket Courts, New Delhi.**

Appeal for Identification

General public is hereby informed that one male person **Namely:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** 50 Yrs. **Height:** 5'1", **Sex:** Male, **Complexion:** Shallow **Identification Mark:** "S+T" Tattoo Mark on Right Hand **Wearing:** Brown Colour Payjama **Place of Recovery:** Near Mayapuri Metro Parking Delhi The dead body has been preserved in Deen Dayal Upadhyay Hospital Mortuary Delhi, for identification.

In this regard **DD No. 37A Dated: 30/08/2026** has been lodged at **Police Station: Mayapuri, Delhi** Any clue come to notice please inform undersign.

SHO
P.S.: Mayapuri, Delhi
DP/15823/WD/2026 **Phone: 9891717821, 9540114693**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of a male namely **Suresh S/o Unknown R/o Unknown Age:** 50 Years, **Height:** 5'8", **Complexion:** Dark, **ID Mark:** Mole over left side of neck, was wearing Red colour T-shirt and Black colour Pant, was found at Safdarjung Hospital, Delhi on 20.10.2026 at 09:32 A.M. In this regard a case **DD No. 27A dated 20.10.2026 U/s 194 BNSS has been lodged at P.S. Defence Colony, Delhi.**

His dead body has been preserved in Safdarjung Hospital Mortuary. Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address or telephone numbers.

SHO
P.S. Defence Colony, Delhi
DP/15810/SD/2026 **Ph.: 9953493338**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that this person (depicted in the photo) **Name:** Unknown **S/o:** Unknown **R/o:** Unknown **Age:** About 35 years, **Sex:** Male, **Height:** About 5 feet 6 inch, **Face:** NA, **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Built:** NA, **Wearing:** Maroon Black-Color T-shirt and Blue Jeans, was Founded Hanged on a tree, Railway Colony, Anguri Bagh, Delhi on **dated 31.10.2026** under area of **P.S. Kotwali, Delhi.**

In this regard a **DD No.51A dated 31.10.2026,** has been lodged at **P.S. Kotwali, Delhi.**

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about this person but no clue has come to light so far. If any person having any information or clue about this person may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S.- Kotwali, Delhi
DP/15881/N/2026 **Ph.: 8572827818, 8750870121**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

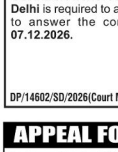
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Govind S/o Prem Chand R/o H.no. 674, Laxmi Apartment, Nai Basti, Devli, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 980/15 U/S 420 IPC, PS Neb Sarai, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Govind** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Govind** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Govind** of **FIR No. 980/15 U/S 420 IPC, PS Neb Sarai, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **07.12.2026.**

By Order,
Ms. Devanshi Janmeja
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (South)
DP/14602/SD/2026(Court Matter) **Room No. 212, Second Floor**
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION



General public is hereby informed that a male namely **Unknown, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown was found in unconscious Condition on 04.10.2026 From Shalimar Bagh, Delhi.** He was admitted to BJRM Hospital on Vide MLC No. 11805/26 by CAT Ambulance, from where he was referred to LNJP Hospital, during treatment doctor declared him dead on **24.10.2026**. In this regard **DD No. 59A, Dated: 24.10.2026** has been lodged at Police Station **Shalimar Bagh, Delhi.** Physical Description of unidentified male dead body is as under:

Name: Unknown, Age: About 30 Years, Height: 5'4", Complexion: Wheatish, Face: Long, Built: Medium, ID Mark: Tattoo Over Right Hand, Wearing: Blue Colour Shirt and Metallic Colour Pant.

If anyone have any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be inform undersigned.

SHO
Police Station Shalimar Bagh, Delhi
DP/15669/NW/2026 **Ph.: 9871276007, 8750870224**

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

SC-RAM TEMPLE

shankar Mishra, Subhash Srivastava and Ram Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu, all associated with handling or counting donations at the temple.

The state government has maintained that the investigation found no evidence warranting prosecution of senior trust functionaries, including former general secretary Champat Rai and former trustee Anil Mishra, who were instead examined as witnesses. Both resigned from their positions after allegations of irregularities in handling devotees' donations at the Ram temple surfaced. The Opposition, particularly the Samajwadi Party, has alleged that the probe caught the "small fish" while sparing senior functionaries and bank employees whose supervisory roles needed scrutiny.

The court on Monday was also informed about a fresh petition filed by the Ram Janmabhoomi Case Trust seeking directions with regard to the SC's 2019 judgment that paved the way for the construction of the temple. This plea sought an independent, technically qualified survey and verification of the land adjudicated in the 2019 judgment to determine whether the present temple stands on the exact adjudicated premises.

The bench told the trust that it could approach a civil court with these prayers.

The court intervened in the matter in July and constituted a second special investigation team (SIT) to investigate allegations of pilferage of donations and irregularities in the handling of valuables at the temple. The charge sheet was filed before the anti-corruption court in Ayodhya in September.

The SIT identified 105 instances of alleged unauthorised removal or concealment of cash during the counting of donations inside the temple premises, according to the state's submissions in the top court.

The probe covered three broad areas—cash collections and their handling, valuable donations received by the temple, and the financial dealings and assets of the accused.

The SIT also physically verified 803 valuable articles for which receipts had been generated through the temple trust's software and another 86 articles for which receipts were not available. It found no discrepancy, officials said.

The investigation examined the financial transactions, properties, vehicles and jewellery of the eight accused and their close relatives. As many as 173 witnesses, including temple functionaries, donation-counting personnel, bank officials, security staff, CCTV operators, chartered accountants and vendors, were examined. The controversy surfaced on June 7 when SP leader Tej Narayan 'Pawan' Pandey alleged that donations worth ₹5 crore to ₹7.5 crore had been siphoned off from the temple offerings. The state constituted an SIT, following which eight employees associated with the handling and counting of donations were held on June 26.

Review rejected Form 6 claims to ensure eligible voters on rolls: UP CEO

Rajesh Kumar Singh
letters@hindustantimes.com

Manish Garg (right) with Navdeep Rinwa

LUCKNOW: Uttar Pradesh chief electoral officer Navdeep Rinwa on Monday directed all district election officers (DEOs) to re-examine all rejected Form 6 applications in order to include eligible citizens in the voter list.

Missing voters should be included in the voter list by matching the electoral rolls of panchayat and assembly constituencies, he said at a meeting in Meerut on Monday.

He issued the directive while he, along with senior deputy election commissioner Manish Garg, and other senior officials of the Election Commission of India reviewed preparations for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh assembly elections in 18 districts under the Meerut, Saharanpur, Moradabad and Aligarh divisions.

Rinwa also directed the DEOs/DMs to re-examine all Forms 6, 7, and 8 submitted by computer assistants since completion of the special intensive revision (SIR) on April 10. He instructed the officers to ensure that applicants enter their mobile phone number and complete address correctly while filling Form 6 for enrolment as a voter.

Operators of public convenience centres should be trained regarding the online application process for Form 6 and prevent multiple entries, he said.

He added: "The district magistrate and superintendent of police should jointly inspect polling party departure points and material storage points. The Essential Basic Facilities at polling stations should also be updated on the ECINET app."

Garg instructed officers to ensure that voter information slips were distributed and marked in the BLO register five days before polling day.

Garg had come under the spotlight after it emerged that Election Commissioners Sukhbir Sandhu and Vivek Joshi had written to the Cabinet Secretary earlier this year regarding his alleged misconduct. Their letter was accompanied by a copy of Garg's order allocating work to himself and other ECI officials after he was given additional charge on July 28.

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED GIRL

Khushi

General Public is hereby informed that a girl (depicted in the photo) namely **Khushi D/o** Jitender **R/o** HN 30, Gali No.7, Tihar Village Delhi **Age** - 16 Years has been reported missing since 29.09.2026 from her house. In this regard a **FIR No. 274/26, U/s 137(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 Dated 29.09.2026** has been lodged at Police Station-Hari Nagar, New Delhi.

Her physical description is as under:-

Complexion: Wheatish, **Height:** 4'10" **Clothing:** Black Color Suit and Salwar

Any person having any information/Clue about this missing girl, may inform **SHO, Hari Nagar, New Delhi on following Telephones/e-mails:-**

E-mail : cic@cbi.gov.nic.in or website : http://cbi.nic.in
Tele No. : 11-24368638 or 24368641
Fax No. : 11-24368639

SHO
P.S., Hari Nagar, Delhi
Ph.: 011-28125719
8750871128
DP/14189/WD/2026

FIVE OF FAMILY FOUND DEAD IN SUSPECTED MURDER-SUICIDE

BHOPAL: Police found four members of a family dead at their home in Bhopal on Monday after reaching the house to inform them that the body of their 35-year-old family member had been found on a railway track earlier in the day, officers said. They added that the preliminary probe suggested murder-suicide.

Those found dead in the house included the dead man's 51-year-old mother, his 29-year-old wife, 10-year-old daughter and six-year-old son.

"We received an alert on the FRV system this morning about an incident near the railway track. The man died after being run over by a train. Police reached his house to share information but found all four members of the same household dead. Upon examining the bodies of the four family members, it appeared that their throats had been slit," said Zone 4 DCP Adarsh Kant Shukla. Police found CCTV footage showing the man leaving his home between 7.30am and 8.00am.

Investigators said the man was reportedly struggling with a ₹40-lakh debt after his businesses shut down. **SHRUTI TOMAR**

ALL STATE CAPITALS TO HAVE FRRO OFFICES BY 2027

NEW DELHI: The number of Foreigners Regional Registration Offices (FRROs) in India has expanded to 20, with the Centre aiming to establish offices in all state capitals by 2027 to improve access to immigration and visa-related services for foreign nationals visiting or residing in the country, the ministry said in a press release on Monday.

Citing a substantial increase in the number of foreign nationals visiting India for tourism, medical treatment and education, the Union ministry of home affairs said the expansion was aimed at improving access to services, strengthening regulatory compliance and making India a more attractive destination for foreign visitors.

"Identifying this need, Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation, Shri Amit Shah has directed to establish FRROs in all state capitals by 2027," the release state.

The expansion aims to facilitate travel and stay for foreign nationals in India by improving access to consular and immigration services including visa extensions, conversions and immigration compliance. **PRAGATI CHAWLA**

NAGAR NIGAM FIROZABAD (NNF)
(UTTAR PRADESH, INDIA)

Letter No: 1152 /NNF/2026-27 **Dt. 02-11-2026**

Notice Inviting Tenders (NIT)

Municipal Commissioner (MC), Nagar Nigam Firozabad invites item Bids for the work mentioned below through e-Procurement in conformity with the terms and conditions of this advertisement and the detailed tender call notice in two Bid systems (Part- I: General& Technical Bid and Part-II: financial Bid/Price Bid/BOQ) from intending bidders fulfilling the eligibility criteria mentioned in this Notice and other qualifying requirements mentioned in this RFP. Bidders can participate in the bidding after registering them on E- tendering portal http://etender.up.nic.in. Bidder can download the RFP from http://etender.up.nic.in after paying the tender cost through online payment in the name of Nagar Nigam Firozabad, Bank Name- Punjab National Bank. Account No.- 03822011009820, IFSC- PUNB0038210 Bidder will have to upload the scanned copy of transaction slip along with technical bid failing this; the Bid is liable to be rejected. The Bidder should deposit the Earnest Money online in above mentioned account number or through FDR from a Nationalized Bank pledged in favor of Municipal Commissioner, Nagar Nigam Firozabad. The scanned copy of the transaction slip should be uploaded along with technical bid. The bidders should have necessary Portal enrollment (Digital Signature Certificate) under e-procurement process of Govt. of Uttar Pradesh in required class/category. In case of any queries on this RFP, intending bidders may contact Executive Engineer, Nagar Nigam Firozabad.

S.No	Name of the Work	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Tender fee with GST @ 18%(Rs.)
1	Selection of Monitoring, Perfomance Improvement and Technical Support Unit at Firozabad Municipal Corporation (FMC).	3,00,000	11,800

Time schedule for Bidding:-

S. No	Description	Critical Dates
1	Upload/Publish of RFP	03-11-2026
2	Bid start Date of RFP	03-11-2026
3	Pre-Bid Date/Time	13-11-2026
4	Bid Closing Date/Time of RFP	23-11-2026 (02:00 PM)
5	Technical Bid Opening Date/Time	23-11-2026 (04:00 PM)
6	Financial Bid Opening Date/Time	To be notified

1. Other details can be seen on website http://etender.up.nic.in (for view, download and bidding).
2. Subsequent corrigendum, if required, shall appear in these websites.
3. For any other queries, please contact Executive Engineer, Nagar Nigam Firozabad. Also, for any further queries, the bidders are advised to send an email to: nagarnigamfzd@gmail.com

Chief Engineer
Nagar Nigam Firozabad

8 electrocuted during Raj roadwork

Pulkit Bhardwaj
letters@hindustantimes.com

JAIPUR/JHUNJHUNU: Eight workers were electrocuted and five others sustained burn injuries after a concrete mixer touched an overhead power line during road construction in Rajasthan's Jhunjhunu district on Monday, police said. The incident triggered a protest by locals, who alleged that the electricity department and administration ignored warnings about low hanging power lines.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed grief over the deaths and announced grant of ₹2 lakh to the families of the deceased; the injured will receive ₹50,000 each .

"Saddened by the loss of lives due to a mishap in Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan. My condolences to the bereaved families...," his office wrote on X.

Chief minister Bhajan Lal Sharma also expressed on X and said he has directed officials to ensure treatment for the injured, provide immediate assistance to affected families, and investigate the incident.

Udaipurwati SHO Rampal said the incident took place on the Chhapoli-Kadamb Kund road. The deceased were identified as Hariram Gurjar (30), Mangalchand Gurjar (22), Kaluram Gurjar (29), and Pawan Gurjar (23), all residents of Haleda Mandawara; and Vishnu Saini (38), Surendra alias Suresh Saini (30), Mukesh Saini (27), and Fatehchand Saini (32), all residents of Chhapoli.

Locals have alleged that the electricity department and the administration ignored warnings about low-hanging power lines in the area. ANI

The injured were indentified as Mahendra (46), Geeta Devi (45), Santara Devi (35), Gida Ram Saini (45), and Manju Devi (38), all residents of Chapoli, according to an officer aware of the matter.

"There were 12-13 people at the site," said Gida Ram.

The villagers staged a protest at the site, alleging that no staff were present at the grid substation when they called to have the power supply switched off. Their allegations couldn't be independently verified.

The protest ended around 5pm after assurances of compensation and contractual jobs for the victims' families.

State minister Jhabar Singh Kharra said, "The dependents of the deceased will be given ₹15 lakh in compensation and one member each of the bereaved families will get a contractual job."

State energy minister Heeralal Nagar said that preliminary information indicated the road was being built with public participation but that the work was being carried out privately on a small scale. "If any departmental or technical lapse is found, action will be taken," he said.

CBI gets 2-day transit remand of Chandrakar in Mahadev app case

Arnabjit Sur and Neeraj Chauhan
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Monday granted two-day transit remand of Mahadev betting app promoter Sourabh Chandrakar to the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI), allowing the agency to take him to Raipur and produce him before a special court in connection with the alleged illegal betting syndicate.

Principal district and sessions Judge-cum-Special Judge (CBI) Nikhil Chopra of Rouse Avenue court granted the remand after hearing arguments from CBI and Chandrakar's lawyers, who challenged the legality of his arrest in India, contending that the agency had violated the conditions under which he was extradited from Oman. The court permitted CBI to produce Chandrakar before the Special Judge for CBI cases in Raipur on or before November 4.

Sourabh Chandrakar

Chandrakar was extradited on the orders of the Muscat Court of Appeal in Oman, which ruled in India's favour, while rejecting a competing extradition request from the UAE. During the proceedings, legal counsel for Chandrakar argued against his extradition, presenting a defence that he had renounced his Indian citizenship in 2020 at the Indian Embassy in Dubai and subsequently acquired nationality in Vanuatu.

According to the order seen by HT, the Muscat court dismissed this argument after the Public Prosecution obtained an official diplomatic clarification from the Indian Embassy in Muscat, which confirmed that Chandrakar remains an Indian citizen wanted for extradition.

Chandrakar was arrested on November 1, after being surrendered to India by the Sultanate of Oman, where he had been detained over alleged illegal entry using forged travel documents, the CBI told the court.

Refusing to term the arrest illegal, the court said its immediate task was limited to deciding the transit remand. The judge observed: "At present this court has to consider only the question of transit remand and not as to whether the judicial authority will not pursue, try, or punish the accused."

However, Chandrakar's lawyer, advocate Tushar Giri, argued that his arrest was illegal because CBI's extradition request had not been accepted by the Omani authorities, while the extradition request made by ED had been allowed.

A FIRST IN 47 YRS: NO OPERATIONAL FATALITY IN CRPF FOR 12 MONTHS

NEW DELHI: The paramilitary Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) has not suffered a single operational fatality anywhere in the country over a year for the first time in 47 years. In 2025, eight out of nine CRPF personnel were killed in action in the Naxal-hit areas. One CRPF jawan died in field firing practice. In 2024, 12 deaths were reported from Chhattisgarh, Jammu & Kashmir, and Manipur. No fatalities since October 30, 2025, have coincided with the government's announcement in Parliament about meeting the March 31 deadline for ending LWE. There is no longer any Maoist-hit district in the country. India had over 100 LWE-hit districts at the peak of Maoism in the mid-2000s. In a post on X, CRPF chief GP Singh said, "We remain committed to keep the country peaceful & safe for all its citizens." HTC

2 brothers held for killing cheetah cub near Kuno park, gun found

Shruti Tomar
letters@hindustantimes.com

BHOPAL: The Madhya Pradesh Special Task Force (STF) has arrested two brothers for allegedly killing a 19-month-old cheetah cub, officially known as Kuno Nirva Gaurav or KNG-22, outside the Kuno National Park and recovered the licenced double-barrel gun they used in the crime, police said on Monday.

According to an STF officer, the male cub (KNG-22) was rescued in an injured condition from compartment No. 748 of Sheopur forest division on October 25, however it died during treatment two days later. Doctors found five pellets inside its body, the officer said.

The four-member STF arrested Bhagwan Singh, a resident of Morena district, on October 31. His brother was arrested later in the day. Both were remanded in two-day judicial custody on October 31 and produced before the court again on Monday, which sent them to judicial custody, a senior forest department official said.

This is the first case of a cheetah being shot dead since they were reintroduced in India four years ago.

During interrogation, Singh allegedly confessed that on October 24, he and Pritam Singh had gone to the forest to hunt a wild boar. When they spotted the movement of the cheetah, he fired at it and fled the spot. A case was registered against both under sections 9 and 51 of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 (Amended 2022).

The officer said they are probing the illegal wildlife trade and organised crime angle in the case. This is the first case of a cheetah being shot dead since the big cats were reintroduced in India four years ago. As many as eight forest officials of Morena and Sheopur were suspended for neglect of their duties, the officer added.

The death of KNG22 is the first such killing in the country since cheetahs were reintroduced four years ago.

Under India's cheetah reintroduction programme, eight cheetahs were brought from Namibia in September 2022, followed by 20 from South Africa in February 2023. Earlier this year, nine more cheetahs were translocated from Botswana.

M.P. COP KILLED BY TRUCK SMUGGLING ILLICIT LIQUOR

Shruti Tomar
letters@hindustantimes.com

BHOPAL: A town inspector (TI) in Madhya Pradesh's Khategaon was killed after a truck driver ran him over when he stopped the vehicle for inspection in Dewas district on Sunday night, an officer said on Monday.

The incident took place around 1.30 am on Indore-Betul highway. The driver then drove the truck over the road divider to the opposite side and abandoned it near Sandalpur before fleeing the spot.

The inspector was rushed to hospital where he succumbed to his injuries, Dewas superintendent of police Aditya Mishra said.

Police said the vehicle has been seized with illicit liquor and taken to Sandalpur police station. An FIR was registered at Khategaon Police Station under sections of BNS and Excise Act.

State must use preventive detention powers with caution, says top court

Ayesha Arvind
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday said the State must exercise preventive detention powers, given their direct impact on personal liberty, with utmost caution, circumspection and in strict conformity with the requirements of law.

A bench of justices Vikram Nath, R Mahadevan, and AK Singh said all public authorities must anyway be guided by the law and that such appreciation of facts and the law assumed greater significance in matters of preventive detention since it directly affects a person's fundamental right to life and liberty.

SC SAID PUBLIC AUTHORITY MUST BE GUIDED BY A CAREFUL APPRECIATION OF THE FACTS AND APPLICABLE LAW

"The public authority must be guided by a careful appreciation of the facts and the applicable law. This assumes particular significance in matters of preventive detention, where the exercise of statutory power directly affects the liberty of an individual. Such power must, therefore, be exercised with utmost circumspection and in strict conformity with the requirements of law," the court said.

The bench made the observations while allowing an appeal filed by senior IPS officer A Arun, seeking to expunge certain "adverse remarks" made against him by the Madras high court in May this year.

iitf
Organiser India Trade Promotion Organisation
45TH INDIA INTERNATIONAL TRADE FAIR
13 – 27 November 2026
Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
Celebrating India's Progress and Heritage with an International Touch
INAUGURATION CEREMONY
To be inaugurated by
Shri Piyush Goyal
Hon'ble Union Minister of Commerce & Industry
Followed by an enchanting Odissi performance by
Padma Shri Guru Madhavi Mudgal & Group
13 November 2026 | Auditorium 2, Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
Kindly be seated by 6:30 PM | Entry through Gate No. 7
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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP/AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1	HARYANA AGRO INDUSTRIES CORPORATION LIMITED	EXPRESSION OF INTEREST FOR EMPANELMENT OF SUPPLIERS WITH HAICL FOR PARTICIPATION IN E-BIDDING FOR SUPPLY OF ESSENTIAL COMMODITY ITEMS FOR HARHITH RETAIL PROJECT OF HARYANA AGRO INDUSTRIES CORPORATION LIMITED.	03.11.2026 30.11.2026	-	https://www.haic.co.in	01722561305 haicpkl@gmail.com
2	HARYANA AGRO INDUSTRIES CORPORATION LIMITED	EXPRESSION OF INTEREST FOR EMPANELMENT OF SUPPLIERS WITH HAICL FOR PARTICIPATION IN E-BIDDING FOR SUPPLY OF ESSENTIAL COMMODITY ITEMS FOR HARHITH RETAIL PROJECT OF HARYANA AGRO INDUSTRIES CORPORATION LIMITED FOR INSTITUTIONAL SUPPLY PURPOSE.	03.11.2026 30.11.2026	-	https://www.haic.co.in	01722561305 haicpkl@gmail.com
3	HARYANA AGRO INDUSTRIES CORPORATION LIMITED	PUBLICATION OF ADVERTISEMENT FOR APPOINTMENT OF HANDLING CONTRACTOR FOR HAICL GODOWNS-SHAHABAD (KKR).	03.11.2026 13.11.2026	1,00,000/-	https://www.haic.co.in	01722561305 haicpkl@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO 13/2027/80/50715/1/19/7

HT Power Jobs

काशी हिन्दू विश्वविद्यालय BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY
An Institution of National Importance established by an Act of Parliament
(Advt. No - 03/2026- 2027)
(Non-teaching posts Group 'A' & 'C' Computer Centre)
Banaras Hindu University, invites ONLINE applications from eligible Indian Citizens possessing the prescribed qualifications for filling up the posts of Group 'A' & 'C', Computer Centre.
Last date for online submission of application form is 25.11.2026. The downloaded application form along with supporting documents should reach to the Office of the Registrar, Recruitment & Assessment Cell, Holkar House, BHU, Vararansi-221005 on or before 30.11.2026 upto 5:00 p.m.
For details of qualifications and other instructions, please visit University website: http://www.bhu.ac.in/rac.
Date: 26.10.2026 REGISTRAR

एन टी पी सी स्कूल ऑफ बिजनेस NTPC School of Business
(Under the aegis of NTPC Education and Research Society)
DIRECTOR
NTPC School of Business (NSB) is looking for a leader who will be its chief executive and committed to leading world-class value driven energy institute.
He / She must have proven experience in academic administration, institution building and ability to serve the interest of diversified stakeholders.
The incumbent shall have a tenure of appointment of five years and should be below 60 years of age as on closing date. The remuneration of the Director shall be at par with top management schools of India.
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Please send application in prescribed format along with Curriculum Vitae to Chairman, Selection Committee at ssc@nsb.ac.in before 20.11.2026.

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{ OUR TAKE }

Why the midterms matter... and don't

If the Democrats gain, they will build pressure on the administration, but Trump's promise to use his veto powers will thwart major policy changes

All eyes are on US President Donald Trump as he enters the midterm polls with an aggregated approval rating of 36% in October, and only eight out of the 50 states giving him a net positive rating. The numbers suggest that Trump's unpopularity may drive away Republican voters even in the staunchly red states such as Kentucky and South Carolina. Whether this is enough for Democrats to seize Congress (Senate, House, or both) electorally remains to be seen. Should that happen, the second half of the Trump presidency can look very different.

In terms of the economy — the top issue for both Democratic and Republican voters — Democrats' pressure can change the way American AI and other big tech companies confront regulatory guardrails and innovation. To be sure, the US economy grew 3.4% in the last quarter, largely driven by investments in AI. Potential Democratic interventions on AI regulation, as signalled by several senators including Elizabeth Warren, are likely to create a global ripple effect, including an impact on equity markets.

In terms of geopolitics, if Congress flips, strained ties with Europe might receive some salve, even if there is no significant policy movement on the Iran situation. Democrats do not really have a plan yet. Increased fuel prices, primarily due to the war with Iran, have angered voters, putting cost of living at the forefront of domestic concerns. This is unlikely to be addressed in the short term, irrespective of the midterm results. There isn't a lack of hawkishness on Iran even in the Democratic camp. At best, votes on war powers, oversight committees, and impeachment of members can be moved, but Trump is prepared to use his veto to annul any legislative steps. And this will characterise the rest of his presidency. History shows that any assertion of Democratic strength makes Trump double down on his policies; he's already promised to become "Mr Veto".

India is in the middle of trade negotiations with the US. A delay in negotiations can be expected if Democrats, emboldened by a strong midterm performance, insist on revisiting the terms. This may not necessarily be bad for New Delhi as it would give a buffer for getting more favourable terms. India has enough to stay interested in the results.

Air Force needs an urgent hardware boost

It has become *de rigueur* for both incoming and outgoing chiefs of the Air Force to reiterate the urgent need to plug its hardware gap, which has left the service short on operational squadrons relative to its sanctioned strength. Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit, too, has made his foremost task the rebuilding of the IAF's combat strength through indigenisation. Dixit's thrust on indigenisation needs to be seen as a signal to Indian defence manufacturers to get their house in order in terms of timely deliveries and ingenuity.

Inducting and operationalising the LCA Mk-1A is Dixit's immediate priority as the IAF's long-serving MiG-21s were finally mothballed last year. Deliveries of the aircraft by State-owned manufacturer HAL have been held up, ironically, by delayed engine imports. The IAF is to receive 180 LCA Mk-1A fighter jets from HAL in two tranches, with subsequent plans to procure the more advanced LCA Mk-2 versions to replace foreign-made jets such as the Jaguars, Mirage 2000s, and MiG-29s. The vision is simple: Reduce dependence on imports for critical needs and streamline the fighting portfolio by eliminating the potpourri of platforms. The diversity in the makes and models of IAF hardware has been the result of India's insistence on strategic autonomy, thus steering clear of any disproportionate reliance on a single platform.

The government is right to give indigenous companies the mandate to supply the armed forces with their fighting machines, but this single-source system must not create the dependence India has always sought to avoid. More importantly, the push for indigenisation should not compromise fighting power. Modernisation and indigenisation need to be complementary, not contradictory. For that, any slippage on the part of the suppliers needs to be tackled with an equal and efficient zero-tolerance policy.

India's interests must guide space partnerships

New Delhi should move with a clear understanding of what each partnership enables, what it restricts and what happens if cooperation ends

With competition in space accelerating, India will need partners for missions it cannot yet undertake alone. ANI

Syed Akbaruddin

No country owns the Moon. The powers that shape the rules of space may find that they do not need to. On October 23, China published its position paper on space governance as a bid for influence over those rules. India had already signed the US-led Artemis Accords in June 2023. New Delhi must now weigh Beijing's proposals against its existing commitments, while preserving choices it may need as its capabilities grow.

Much of the legal framework governing space was written decades ago. Commercial ventures and new technologies are now testing how those rules apply to activities at a scale their authors could barely have imagined. Whether this leads to new agreements or disputes over existing ones, India should prepare for another round of diplomatic jostling.

China wants the United Nations to remain the main forum for writing the rules of space. Its proposals cover commercial operators, information sharing and arms control. The paper has political weight: Chinese foreign minister Wang Yi announced it among eight practical actions under Beijing's wider governance agenda. Developing countries are promised a larger say. Part of President Xi Jinping's Global Governance Initiative, it seeks to turn their frustration with existing arrangements into support for China's claim to global leadership.

Many countries depend on satellites they do not own and services whose operating conditions they had little role in shaping. Their fear is that powerful governments and companies will settle the rules among themselves. India's experience of using space technology for development gives it common ground with countries seeking affordable, reliable access to these services.

China's call to stop commercial space companies from unlawfully intervening in conflicts appears aimed partly at services such as Starlink in Ukraine. When a private satellite network becomes vital to a military campaign, responsibility cannot simply stop at the company's registered address. But who decides when support becomes unlawful, and would China accept the same rule for its own firms?

China's destruction of a satellite in 2007 left thousands of persistent debris fragments in orbit. India has demonstrated an anti-satellite capability too. Both have reason to prevent an arms race. Beijing's paper offers principles of restraint, but leaves specific obligations and verification arrangements to future negotiations.

Under the Artemis Accords, India has endorsed principles promoted by the US for civil space exploration. These include the view that extracting lunar resources does not in itself amount to claiming national ownership of territory. The Accords also envisage temporary safety zones, where operators coordinate their activities to avoid harmful interference. These confer no territorial ownership. How large they become, and how they are used, will nevertheless matter to countries arriving later.

The Accords do not bar cooperation with China. They are legally non-binding political commitments, although endorsing contradictory principles elsewhere could carry a diplomatic cost. Once a mission is designed around a partner's equipment and data systems, changing partners can mean redesigning the mission. Separate technology restrictions and project contracts may narrow the choices further. Freedom may remain on paper even as the cost of using it rises.

Access to advanced technology and shared infrastructure can also make missions that India could not undertake alone possible. Refusing such opportunities in the name of independence could leave it with fewer capabilities and fewer choices. Negotiators should ask what Indian teams will learn to design, maintain and operate themselves, and which essential functions will continue to depend on foreign assistance.

At the BRICS summit in New Delhi in September 2026, India joined a declaration supporting negotiations on space arms control. It also recognised the Russian and Chinese draft treaty as an important step towards preventing an arms race. Joining the Artemis Accords did not prevent India from taking that position. That support does not mean India must accept every treaty provision that Russia or China favours.

India's serious political differences and strategic rivalry with China limit how far such cooperation can go. Exchanging collision warnings requires a different level of trust from sharing sensitive infrastructure or relying on Chinese systems for an essential service. India must consider whether deeper cooperation would allow Beijing to interrupt a vital service or exert pressure.

The Indian government's space reforms have opened more activities to private companies and eased foreign investment rules. ISRO, diplomats, defence planners and commercial operators need to identify where India is vulnerable. Which satellite services could be interrupted by a foreign decision? How quickly could essential suppliers be replaced? The answers should inform the agreements India signs and the domestic capabilities it funds.

India need not wait for negotiations to offer something useful. It could expand cooperation with countries that need satellite data to anticipate floods, monitor crops and assess disaster damage, while training local teams to use it. Such work would also show India which problems any future rules should address. Those relationships would be worth building whether or not Beijing's UN proposals lead to substantive negotiations.

With competition in space accelerating, India will need partners for missions it cannot yet undertake alone. It should negotiate with a clear understanding of what each partnership enables, what it restricts and what would happen if cooperation ended. The most revealing question is what India could still do on the day a partner said no.

Syed Akbaruddin served as India's permanent representative to the United Nations in New York and, currently, is dean, Kautilya School of Public Policy. The views expressed are personal

French Halloween: Horrors of a broken social contract

Jean-Luc Racine

It was an unusual Halloween in Paris this year. The youth-led cost-of-living protests in France saw isolated clashes in the capital and other cities on Saturday, and have now inspired the youth in neighbouring Germany to also take to the streets over similar pains and anxieties.

This movement started on September 17, at a secondary school in Créteil, a Paris suburb, when teachers protested against the lack of resources and staff. Some students supported the movement and decided to blockade the building. One week later, on TikTok, an interview with the students highlighted their complaints. The video was viewed more than one million times, and the movement expanded in the greater Paris region, and then across the country. The protesters' had several demands: upgrading of decrepit schools, avoiding extended time schedules with gaps between courses — the result of reforms multiplying course options — and dropping the unclear process called *Parcoursup* determining entry into universities or vocational institutes; the last two issues resulted from reforms implemented during President Emmanuel Macron's first mandate (2017-2022). Sociologist François Dubet has argued that such a selection system fails to democratise access to a better life through education.

The protests soon extended, by solidarity, even to the prestigious Latin Quarter, and then to universities. In a piece published on October 17, economist Thomas Piketty underlined that during Macron's two mandates, the nominal higher education budget rose by 17%, but the real budget per student fell by almost 20% because of inflation and rising student numbers. These trends reveal, at the very least, the power corridors' failure to anticipate these. Some critics believe these result from a philosophy focused mostly on the future elites of the "start-up nation" dear to Macron, but leaving behind many disenchanted with the mainstream public education system.

By the end of September, the students' movement had spread across dozens of French cities, while clashes between protesters and the police opened a new debate about the intensity of the repression that had left some young students seriously wounded. On October 2, the minister for education received secondary school student unions and opened a platform for gathering students' views. That was not enough, and a new dynamic emerged, enlarging the protests through a call for the "convergence of struggles": During the October 6 demonstration, students from schools and universities were joined by teachers and education staff, national trade unions, parents' associations, and leaders of Left parties.

On October 17, at the margins of the marchers, two types of actors marked the day: First, the hardcore militants from the ultra-Left, called the black blocs because of their black attire, attacked public buildings in a number of cities. Second, young vandals, amid the chaos, loot many shops, including small businesses. The home minister, who had adopted a hard line on "maintaining order," offered to resign; Macron refused. Overshadowing the massive and peaceful demonstrations, the images of destruction and looting went viral globally, with a number of consequences. First, since the beginning of the movement, the French government and the Right had blamed the Left party, La France insoumise (Unbowed France), for the agitation and the troubles; the party had sent some of its MPs to hear and support the students. The dubious accusations against it were amplified, despite the fact that the movement's genesis was not party-led. Scholar Luc Rouban, sees the violence of October 17 as "without doctrine", fed by the failure of the State and the weakened capacity of political parties and trade unions.

Second, the French far-Right, led by Marine Le Pen, was vocal about restoring "the rule of law", and now stands to benefit the most from the chaos. Six months before the next presidential election — to be held in 2027— Le Pen was leading the opinion polls. As a bonus for her, the current government has showed the tools for containing demonstrations: detentions in large numbers, local curfews, banning some protest marches, shifting their allowed routes, among them. Moreover, a part of the Republicans, a centre-Right party, has seceded to create a new formation that is ready to cooperate with Le Pen's National Rally. Meanwhile, a set of news TV channels owned by reactionary billionaires give hard-Right commentators significant airtime.

Third, images of the chaos in France has delighted Right-wing governments abroad: Amid growing uncertainty ahead of the US midterm polls, Donald Trump stated that France's troubles were attributable to uncontrolled immigration. The Benjamin Netanyahu government in Israel, just days before the now-concluded general elections in the country, denounced the French demonstrators as supporters of Hamas, because some protesters had carried Palestinian flags. In India, many TV channels and social networks used the Paris troubles to try to delegitimise the Cochin Janata Party, positing it as part of a (non-existent) "international Islamist-leftist network". Such disparagement, however, doesn't conceal the fact that Gen Z movements, which changed the game in Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, and Nepal, have now sprung up in many European countries, either inspired by the French protests (in Belgium and Greece), or through their own dynamics (Spain, Portugal, Italy, Albania, and Serbia, where the youth-backed Students' Lists won a snap election held on October 25, ending the rule of the Right-wing strongman Aleksandar Vučić, after a 14-year stint in power.

Finally, after another wave of successful and peaceful demonstrations across France on October 24 despite restrictions imposed by the home ministry, the French government announced on October 27 a set of measures that roll back some of the reforms implemented during Macron's first term. It also promised more funds for education and more teachers. The student organisations believe these announcements to be inadequate, and have stuck to the larger agenda for the next protests.

France's Gen Z movement is not totally similar to the May 1968 upheaval, although it refers to it. In 1968, the student movement was soon accompanied by massive workers' strikes, shaking Charles de Gaulle's presidency before the Right marched to Paris and recovered ground. The 1968 movement left a deep impact, contributing to the liberation of a number of social norms. The goal today is less a regime-change than offering everyone the possibility to study and enter into professional life without too many hindrances. Obviously, this call for equality is not disconnected from political aspirations for a fairer society. In this regard, a big question is: What will emerge from the presidential election next year?

Jean-Luc Racine is emeritus senior fellow, Centre for South Asian and Himalayan Studies, CNRS, and School for Advanced Studies in Social Sciences, Paris. The views expressed are personal

{ JENS-FREDERIK NILSEN } PRIME MINISTER, GREENLAND

If Greenland wants to be independent, we need to have a strong foundation... in terms of industry and business

At the inauguration of a new international airport at Ilulissat

Expanding urbanisation calls for governance to keep pace

Debolina Kundu

Mehebub Rahaman

India's urbanisation is extending beyond the boundaries of its recognised cities. It is taking shape in villages on the edges of cities, along industrial corridors, and in settlements where farms co-exist with factories, warehouses, and new housing. These places may not appear on the urban map, but they are already part of India's wider urban economic ecosystem. A 2026 analysis by the National Institute of Urban Affairs (NIUA) found that peripheral areas accounted for more than 80% of built- up growth across 20 major cities between 2000 and 2020. In Kerala, a spatial analysis identified more than 500 functional urban or transitional settlements in 2025 — home to nearly 9.63 million people — that are currently exhibiting urban characteristics.

India's last Census data offers an earlier glimpse of this transition. Between 2001 and 2011, the number of Census Towns rose from 1,362 to 3,894, while their contribution to incremental urban population rose from 10.2% to 31.2%, showing how economic activity and settlement patterns change long before administrative boundaries or governance arrangements change.

This urbanisation pattern creates a mismatch between the geography of growth and the geography of governance. A village may become a centre for industry, trade and housing while its infrastructure and institutions remain designed for a predominantly rural settlement. Roads, drainage, water supply, sanitation, waste management, and public transport come under pressure. Real estate and commercial development increase exponentially, while planning and service provision struggle to keep pace.

The consequences of transport-oriented development and city-based spillover extend beyond individual settlements. Workers travel across administrative boundaries, businesses depend on regional transport networks, and demand for housing and services spreads into surrounding areas. The National Capital Region illustrates this interdependence. The Union Budget 2026–27 proposed City Economic Regions (CERs), with an allocation of ₹5,000 crore per region over five years. This recognises that economic activity, infrastructure needs, and development opportunities often extend beyond individual city boundaries into wider regional territories. The Urban Challenge Fund's Operational Guidelines (2026) similarly emphasise integrating infrastructure projects with broader city and regional growth strategies, highlighting the importance of aligning investment with the wider geography of urban development. So, the question is whether public investment and governance can respond to the transition.

The Sixteenth Finance Commission's recommendation of a ₹10,000-crore Urbanisation Premium for 2026-31 offers a timely opportunity to incentivise the merger of peri-urban villages with adjoining urban local bodies having an existing population of at least one lakh. The recommended amount is calculated at ₹2,000 per person, based on the 2011 Census population of the area being incorporated. Access to this grant is linked to states formulating a Rural-to-Urban Transition Policy. The Commission also recommends identifying transitional settlements, assessing their needs and preparing transition plans covering infrastructure, service delivery, finances and institutional arrangements.

This recommendation creates an incentive for states to treat urban transition as a planned process, not merely an administrative change at the end of it. Odisha's Rural Urban Transition Policy, notified in 2023 and revised in March 2026, provides for the identification of peri-urban areas, assessment of their economic and settlement characteristics, and phased provision of urban infrastructure and services before their formal recognition as urban local bodies.

Importantly, the first step is to reliably identify where this transition is taking place. NIUA's research (2026), *Understanding the New Geography of India's Urbanisation: A Geospatial Approach*, demonstrates how geospatial evidence can identify settlements exhibiting urban characteristics beyond conventional administrative boundaries. Indicators such as population density, economic diversification, commuting patterns and access to essential services can help assess the nature and extent of this transition. These assessments can inform area-specific transition plans, setting out infrastructure priorities, service delivery, and institutional arrangements. While some settlements may need stronger coordination between existing authorities, others may be ready for notification as urban local bodies. A single administrative solution may not meet the needs of all transitional settlements.

India's Urbanisation Premium offers an opportunity to turn the recognition of peri-urban transition into a planned policy response. Realising its potential requires states to translate these assessments into priorities for public investment and define how responsibilities for planning and service delivery should evolve. A rural-to-urban transition policy can provide the framework for aligning institutional arrangements and financial support with the realities of emerging growth patterns. States must proactively formulate such policies and access the grant to ensure a planned transition towards sustainable urban development. The task is to plan for changes already underway, in the places where India's urban future is being shaped.

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Stage set for midterm showdown in US

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

DETROIT/WASHINGTON: Democrats sought to contain a rift in Michigan's US Senate race after one of their own crossed party lines to endorse the Republican, while President Donald Trump pressed his legal efforts on Monday to intervene in ballot-counting as both parties made their closing arguments a day before midterm elections that will determine control of Congress.

Over a fast-moving weekend, US Representative Haley Stevens, who lost the Michigan Democratic Senate primary to Abdul El-Sayed in a bitter contest, suddenly switched to backing Republican Mike Rogers and appeared with him at a Detroit church. The race is critical to Democrats' hopes of ending the 53-47 Senate majority hold of Trump's Republicans in Tuesday's vote.

U.S. MIDTERMS 2026

El-Sayed's campaign raises $2.4 million

A spokesperson for El-Sayed's campaign said it raised $2.4 million on Sunday, its largest single-day fundraising haul, fuelled by small-dollar donations averaging $36.74 from more than 65,000 donors.

Non-partisan analysts generally favour Democrats' chances of winning a majority in the House of Representatives. Winning control of the Senate will be trickier, with those analysts now seeing races in traditionally Republican-leaning states including Texas, Kansas and Iowa as competitive for the opposition party, giving it more options for a path to the majority.

Control of either chamber would constrain Trump's ability to pass legislation and empower Democrats to investigate his administration, while a Senate majority would also allow them to block his appointees to federal courts including the Supreme Court.

According to the University of Florida Election Lab, 55 million votes have been cast in person and by mail already, more than the 45 million cast in the 2022 midterm elections.

Stevens called on El-Sayed to condemn an outside group's ad that she said blames Israel for high grocery prices.

"That ad was very painful," Stevens told CNN on Sunday night. "There are so many Democrats who want to vote for our Democratic nominee, and they're just being told, 'Hey, this is a party you don't belong in, or this is a campaign you don't belong in.'"

El-Sayed rejected Stevens' demand, saying she was creating a distraction by revisiting a primary election she lost months prior. "You guys love to play the condemn game," he told reporters on Saturday when asked about Stevens' demand. "I've already been clear that that ad was not made by me, and I do not agree with the contents of that ad."

El-Sayed, an Egyptian American Muslim born in Michigan, has been targeted by Trump and other Republicans who have repeatedly questioned his loyalty to the US and baselessly called him a terrorist sympathizer whose election would invite attacks on Americans. El-Sayed has called questions about his loyalty to the US "shameful".

The verbal attacks fit a broader pattern of inflammatory rhetoric from some Republicans targeting Arab Americans, Muslims and transgender people and portraying Democrats as communists and dangerous radicals ahead of the midterms.

Stevens' mother, Maria Marcotte, said her daughter decided to endorse Rogers because of what she described as dangerous political rhetoric from El-Sayed, pointing in part to his past appearances with Hasan Piker, a left-wing streamer who has been criticized for his comments about Israel and American Jews.

"She's really reached a point where she felt like her constituents, the people that she cares about, and the people she knows and loves are scared and frightened by some rhetoric that's coming out," Marcotte said in an interview with Reuters from the porch of her home in Birmingham, a northern Detroit suburb.

Democratic voter Pamela Johnson, 72, criticised Stevens after casting her ballot for El-Sayed in Warren, a Detroit suburb: "Haley Stevens is a traitor."

It's unclear how Stevens' reversal might affect the race, where Democrats are trying to keep their hold on a seat occupied by the retiring Gary Peters. Nearly 30% of the state's registered voters had cast ballots by the time of Stevens' appearance with Rogers, according to the Michigan Department of State

Trump says he would offer pardons to Musk, aides if necessary

President Donald Trump said he would be willing to offer protective pardons to Elon Musk and close aides if Democrats take control of Congress after the midterm elections.

The president in an interview dismissed a suggestion that Democrats would move to nationalize Musk's Space X, but said he would "protect" the billionaire entrepreneur and any aides who were targeted by Congressional investigators, including Edward Coristine, who was part of Musk's DOGE project to slash government programs.

Trump confirmed that could mean pre-emptive pardons if necessary. "I would if I needed to, sure," he told conservative commentator Miranda Devine on her "Pod Force One" podcast. "I would not even think about."

Then President Joe Biden issued protective pardons to his son, Hunter Biden, and several government officials who may have been targeted for retaliation by a second Trump administration. Trump mentioned that precedent as justification for his own pledge to protect aides. "That's what Biden did. He gave everybody a pardon," Trump added.

Musk has spent hundreds of millions of dollars supporting Republicans in the midterms and Friday said on X that maintaining a GOP majority in the Senate was key to stopping a "permanent one-party state" under Democrats.

With inputs from Bloomberg

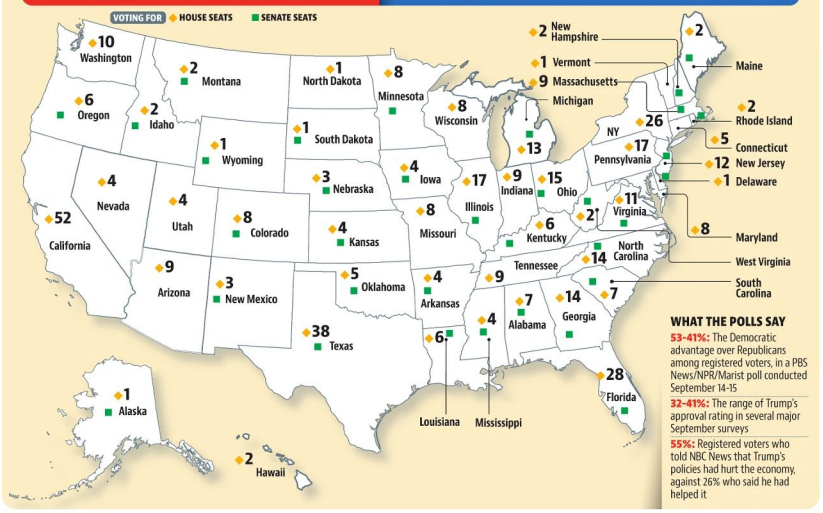
How the keenly contested polls stack up

Americans vote on Tuesday in polls which will shape the final two years of Donald Trump's presidency

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
435 Every seat in the lower chamber of Congress is contested every two years
218 The magic number for majority in the 435-seat chamber
In 2024, Republicans won a 220-215 majority, although deaths, resignations and a party switch mean the current House stands at 218 Republicans, 214 Democrats, one independent and two vacancies

SENATE
35 Senate seats being contested. 33 in the normal six-year rotation plus special elections in Florida and Ohio
Republicans now hold a 53-47 advantage in the **100-seat** chamber, counting two independents who vote with the Democrats

STATES
36 States electing governors, nearly three-quarters of the total
6,139: State legislative seats being regularly contested, across 88 of the country's 99 state legislative chambers



WHAT THE POLLS SAY
53-41%: The Democratic advantage over Republicans among registered voters, in a PBS News/NPR/Marist poll conducted September 14-15
32-41%: The range of Trump's approval rating in several major September surveys
55%: Registered voters who told NBC News that Trump's policies had hurt the economy, against 26% who said he had helped it

JUDGE TOSSES TRUMP ADMIN LAWSUIT TO BLOCK ALASKA SENATE RESULT

AFP & Reuters
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WASHINGTON: A federal judge on Sunday tossed out an extremely unusual attempt by US President Donald Trump's administration to hold up midterm election results in Alaska should the Democratic Senate candidate win.

The judge dismissed the closely watched lawsuit, saying it would be unworkable.

The Department of Justice (DOJ) had asked the court to block certification of the results if incumbent Republican Dan Sullivan loses on Tuesday, because a second candidate also named Dan Sullivan would have drawn away votes.

According to Trump and the lawsuit, the Democratic candidate in Alaska, Mary Peltola, has tried to get an unfair advantage by recruiting another person named Sullivan to run and confuse voters who intended to back the incumbent Republican Senator Sullivan.

California ballot fight

President Donald Trump's administration asked the US Supreme Court on Monday to temporarily block California from counting mail-in ballots from more than 20,000 registered voters who federal officials allege are likely non-US citizens.

Escalating a legal fight that could affect thousands of voters, the justice department filed the emergency request as it seeks to prevent counting the disputed ballots until each voter's citizenship status can be verified.

What's at stake for key players?

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WASHINGTON: Americans will vote on Tuesday in elections that will determine the control of the House of Representatives and the Senate. But the results will extend well beyond Congress. For President Donald Trump, the vote is a referendum on his second term. For the Republicans and the Democrats, and for those hoping to succeed Trump, it will shape the race for the 2028 presidential nomination and the direction each party takes after his term.

Democratic gubernatorial candidate Amy Acton addresses a campaign rally in Cleveland, Ohio. AFP

Donald Trump

For President Trump, the election will be a major referendum on his performance in office. Most indicators suggest an electoral setback is in the works for the 80-year-old commander-in-chief, amid the US's ongoing war with Iran that has led to higher fuel prices and sparked a global crisis.

Trump has to defy the odds and political gravity in order to hold on to both the House of Representatives and the Senate. If he does, his standing as one of the most consequential and powerful American politicians of the last 50 years will be greatly strengthened.

Besides, control over both chambers would shield Trump's signature policies, including global tariffs and the war on Iran, from congressional challenges over funding and oversight. Presidents in the last year or two of their terms are often referred to as "lame ducks" – capable of doing little of consequence while the country looks beyond them towards their successor. A victory for the Republicans may help Trump in shaping the race for the party's 2028 presidential nomination.

The House has the power to approve government spending and launch investigations into the administration. The Senate confirms the President's nominees, including judges and cabinet officials, holds key powers on foreign policy matters and also approves spending bills once they pass the House. Losing both the House and the Senate to the Democrats would deal the President a bruising defeat.

Republicans

For much of the last few years, the Republican party has been reduced to an instrument of Trump's will. Few modern Presidents have dominated their parties the way he has, and that dominance will be tested on Tuesday.

A recent poll by Politico found that Trump's hardline Make America Great Again (MAGA) voters are likely to back him even if he loses the midterms. In fact, 54% of them said losing both the House and the Senate would be a sign the party needed to align itself more closely with his policies.

Trump voters who do not identify as MAGA disagree. Some 44% of them said the loss of both chambers would be a sign that the party must distance itself from the President. More moderate voters have also expressed less support for the President's hardline views on immigration.

Democrats

The party suffered a major setback in 2024, when it lost the White House and the Senate to the Republicans, and failed to regain the House of Representatives. For the last two years, the Democrats have been on a quest to redeem themselves, fighting off concerns that the party is too weak, out-of-touch and disorganised to beat Trump. Winning one or both chambers will do much towards restoring its confidence ahead of the 2028 presidential election. A bad result will only further spotlight its weaknesses.

Republican 2028 hopefuls

Three Republican names stand out as potential candidates for the 2028 election: Vice President JD Vance, Texas Senator Ted Cruz and Secretary of State Marco Rubio. Rubio, however, has expressed a lack of interest in running for the polls and said he will support Vance's candidacy.

The future of the other two will depend on Tuesday's results. Vance is the frontrunner and the politician most closely tied to the President. A victory in the midterms will likely lead him to move ever closer to Trump's policies in an effort to win support from the party's base.

A Republican defeat might signal that the country is tiring of President Trump and his policies. That may pose a problem for Vance, who will have to balance loyalty to the President with enough distance to avoid being tainted by his unpopularity, a balance that Kamala Harris tried and failed to strike in 2024.

Democratic 2028 hopefuls

A long list of Democratic politicians are eyeing their party's nomination for the Presidency. Former Vice President Kamala Harris, California Governor Gavin Newsom and Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez are some of the key names in the mix. If Trump and the Republican party face severe setbacks during Tuesday's elections, it could spark an intense competition within the Democratic party.

Whoever wins the Democratic party's nomination could enter the race with an advantage, facing a Republican nominee saddled with an unpopular outgoing President, an unpopular war with Iran and high prices. Managing internal divisions and personal rivalries over the coming months could become crucial for the party.

TRUMP SAYS 'AT SOME POINT' U.S. WILL HAVE TO GIVE IRAN 'THE HAMMER'

IOWA/LONDON: US President Donald Trump on Sunday reiterated his threat to resume strikes against Iran, telling a campaign rally in Iowa that he may have to give Tehran "the hammer" at some unspecified time. "And the only reason why I'm not finished with Iran is I want to be nice. I want to try and save all those lives if I can...But at some point we're going to have to give them the hammer," Trump said

Oil price drops

Oil fell about 7% on Monday as talks between Iranian and Qatari officials on ending the US-Israeli war with Iran lifted hopes for reduced supply disruptions, while Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian said the Supreme Leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei had granted the government "certain authorities" regarding peace talks.

Brent crude futures fell $8.47, or 7.47%, to $104.96 a barrel by 10:54pm (India time). Also, since shipping through the Strait of Hormuz was disrupted , nearly 1 billion oil barrels have been drained from global inventories, the CEO of ADNOC, said on Monday. AFP & REUTERS

'We're going to crash': 9 die in Florida jet accident

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FLORIDA: The pilot of a private jet told air traffic controllers the plane was experiencing moderate turbulence and going through some precipitation just before it plummeted at 20,000 feet per minute and crashed into a residential area in Florida, killing all nine people aboard.

The Learjet 60 flew for approximately two hours after leaving Austin for the Bahamas and began its rapid descent around 12:48pm (local time) on Sunday, according to data from Flightradar24. The pilot asked controllers for a "better ride", and as the plane started climbing, she suddenly shouted, "Mayday! Mayday!" She then said the craft was descending at 8,000 feet per minute and accelerating.

A fireball rises after a Learjet crashed in a residential area in Florida, on Sunday. REUTERS

"We are in an overspeed condition, descending 20,000 feet per minute!," the unidentified pilot yelled, according to an audio recording posted online by Liveatc.net. "We're going to crash into the ground!"

The pilot then said they were "out of time", the last transmission before the aircraft smashed into the side of a street. The plane's vertical rate eventually exceeded 32,000 feet per minute, according to Flightradar24.

The New York Times interviewed a woman, who said she was the mother of one of the pilots of the aircraft — a 20-year-old named Nathalia Filgueiras. According to the report, Filgueiras earned a pilot's licence at 17 and had logged more than 1,300 hours of flight time. She worked for Upper Jets, a private charter firm based in Fort Lauderdale, the Times reported.

The plane crashed near Cresthaven, Florida, at 12:50pm, US Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy said in a post on X. Dashboard camera footage showed an almost vertical plunge before the impact and explosion alongside a highway.

"Obviously this was a catastrophic plane crash," Florida governor Ron DeSantis said.

CANADA: OVER 4,500 INDIANS REMOVED

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TORONTO: Over 4,500 Indian nationals have been removed from Canada this year, marking a historic high.

According to data published by the Canada Border Services Agency (CBSA), 4,526 Indians were removed from the country till September 30, a record. They comprised over 27% of the total enforced removals, which was 16,426.

This was also the first time since 2020 that Indians comprised the largest country cohort for removals, but the numbers back then were much lower – 1,424 out of 12,858. In the intervening years, Mexicans accounted for the highest number of removals by country of nationality.

In 2025, the previous high for removals of Indians was set when 3,779 were deemed inadmissible. That year also witnessed 4,837 Mexicans being removed out of a total of 23,160.

Ex-Israel premier backs Eisenkot to form govt

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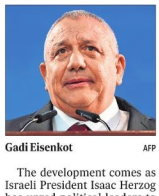
JERUSALEM: Former Israeli prime minister Naftali Bennett's 'B'Yachad' faction has thrown its support behind Yashar party chief Gadi Eisenkot, announcing that it will recommend him to President Isaac Herzog to form the next government amid a political deadlock following last week's Knesset elections.

Bennett announced the decision in a post on X.

"Throughout the election campaign, I promised to respect the decision of the voter, and that is what I am doing now. Therefore, I have decided that the 'Together' faction will recommend to the president to entrust the task of forming the government to Gadi Eisenkot. Good luck, Gadi!" Bennett said.

Responding to Bennett, Eisenkot thanked him for the support and said, "Together, we will bring Israel back to the right path!"



Gadi Eisenkot AFP

The development comes as Israeli President Isaac Herzog has urged political leaders to accept the election results and find creative solutions to prevent another election, with neither of the main political blocs securing a clear majority in the 120-member Knesset.

Meanwhile, party heads in the diverse Israeli opposition camp, led by Eisenkot, will meet on Tuesday after they all said they were endorsing the former military chief to become the next prime minister.

Binance clients pull $4.7bn as exchange reopens after hack

SINGAPORE/PARIS: Binance's customers have withdrawn a net $4.72 billion from the world's biggest cryptocurrency exchange since it reopened, after hackers stole around $6.3 billion of crypto from the platform in what could be the largest financial heist in history. The exchange froze withdrawals for about 48 hours after the hack, which which the FBI said was carried out by North Korea, then started allowing customers to withdraw again on Sunday morning. REUTERS

Garment workers demand higher wages, clash with police

DHAKA: Thousands of striking Bangladeshi garment workers clashed with police on Monday, demanding a monthly minimum wage more than double their current pay, as protests spread across industrial hubs. The protesters demand a 30,000-taka monthly wage ($241), more than double their current pay. Workers currently earn about 13,000 taka a month. AFP

Cyber attacks hit Russia, Ukraine after truce ends

KYIV: Russia said its emergency warnings app came under a "massive cyberattack" on Monday, hours after Ukraine reported a hack in an apparent exchange of blows between the foes, as their longest truce came to an end.

The cyber attacks came as the longest truce of the war, limited to Ukraine's eastern Kherson region, ended on Sunday. AFP

BUSINESS Powered by mint

FM acknowledges investor concerns

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NEW DELHI: Ahead of the Union budget, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday acknowledged investor concerns amid changing circumstances and said the government would consider the need to deepen and widen equity and bond markets while keeping its focus on trust-based taxation, ease of compliance and new-age skilling to generate employment.

Asked whether the budget would roll out a red carpet for foreign portfolio investors (FPIs), Sitharaman said she understood the sensitivity and anxiety among retail investors and equity market participants. She pointed out that the taxation structure had been similar in 2023-24, when India recorded its highest inflows. "Whilst I observe this with not being biased either way, the taxation structure was what it is today even in 2023-24 when we had good inflow into the country," she said at the Financial Express Leadership Awards in Mumbai.

"Nothing differently was done for drawing investments. But, of course, the situation is very different now. Circumstances have changed. Challenges have grown. More FII outflows, we have happened. It started resuming now. They've started coming back now," she said.

Without disclosing specific policy details ahead of the budget, Sitharaman said the government would take investor concerns into account, given the importance of sustaining economic growth.

"So, I know that circumstances have changed, and therefore, voices of concern are louder. I quite appreciate that. So, I'll consider all these, because at a time where our growth is very important, where people are putting their very best, that we are able to see sustained 7-plus growth, in order to keep that intact, we need capital and equity, particularly now," she said.

Nirmala Sitharaman, finance minister. PTI

"Although the last few years have been placing a lot of emphasis on bond market, deepening it, widening it. Now we also have this voice which says, come on, even equity needs that kind of support," she said.

When asked again whether the budget would roll out a red carpet for the dollar, Sitharaman cautioned against framing the issue as favouring foreign investors over domestic ones.

"He [interviewer] would be gracious enough to say, FM said red carpet for the dollar. And, after which Indian investors would say already there's a bias for foreign investors. You didn't want red carpet for the Indian Rupee?," she said adding, "So, on that ground, I don't answer you."

FM weighs in on Tata row

Sitharaman also weighed in on the ongoing developments at the Tata group, saying the matter required commercial judgement and cordiality rather than government intervention.

"I think these are very delicate matters. And matters where a lot of commercial and business acumen will have to work, business cordiality will have to work," she said. Acknowledging the Tata group's contribution to the economy and its global standing, she said the matter should be resolved amicably within the group.

"The contributions of the Parsi community have made Tata as a huge global brand," she said, noting that the group was engaged in a wide range of activities and was a critical component of the Indian economy.

"So, this [Tata Group] is a very critical component to Indian economy, and therefore, it has to be amicably settled among themselves. So, they talk it out to make sure that it comes back quickly to some normalcy. It cannot be spilling out like this in the public. And, for the maturity of that leadership, we would like to have this scene settled sooner," she said.

Policy priorities

On policy priorities ahead of the budget, FM said the government would continue investing in skilling young people to prepare them for new-age technologies and improve their employability. She also emphasised the need to incorporate artificial intelligence (AI) into education curricula and skilling programmes.

She said the government would continue its focus on trust-based taxation, citing corporate tax reductions, personal income-tax rationalisation and indirect tax reforms under the second version of the Goods and Services Tax (GST 2.0).

Sitharaman also said the government would continue regulatory reforms and decriminalisation, and hinted at further easing of procurement rules, tender conditions, bank guarantees and project execution procedures.

She urged industry and other stakeholders to engage with the government throughout the year rather than limiting their interaction to the annual pre-budget memorandum. "They are welcome to ask the government for anything that they want. And I don't think I will be wary of any demand that they want to ask. But post that, I would also want them to keep engaging with us to say whether they're moving forward or not," she said.

Sebi's proposal on LTCG tax, RIL surge lift stock markets

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MUMBAI: A rally in Reliance Industries (RIL) shares and growing optimism over a possible rollback of long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax for foreign investors gave Dalal Street plenty to cheer about on Monday, lifting both benchmark indices nearly 2%. Buying picked up through the session, with RIL stock seeing its biggest intraday upmove since April 2020.

Sebi has recommended scrapping LTCG tax for foreign investors as India seeks to revive its underperforming equity markets, Reuters reported on Monday. The market regulator has also proposed an LTCG exemption for mutual fund investors who sell existing holdings to reinvest in other funds, the report said.

Sebi's proposal is a step in the right direction, but tax efficiency alone will not bring foreign capital back to India, said Nirav Karkera, head of research and fund manager at W by Groww, a wealth manager.

While lower capital gains taxes would improve post-tax returns, reduce friction and make Indian equities more competitive against other emerging markets, the primary drivers of foreign flows remain earnings growth, valuations, currency stability, and India's relative attractiveness within emerging markets, he added.

On Monday, Nifty 50 closed 1.68% higher at 23,440.80 and Sensex ended 1.66% up at 75,692.78. RIL, which carries a 7.3% weight in the Nifty 50, surged 11.6% on NSE, its biggest single-day gain since it jumped 11.9% on 7 April 2020, according to Bloomberg data.

Sensex jumped 1.66% to 75,693, while Nifty surged 1.68% to 23,441. REUTERS

The index started the week on a strong note, opening with a gap-up and holding on to its gains through the session. RIL, Tata Steel and JSW Steel were best performers in the benchmark index.

"The index broke out of its recent consolidation range, extending its winning streak to three sessions and signalling an improvement in near-term buying sentiment," said Sudeep Shah, head of technical and derivatives research at SBI Securities. He pointed out that the Nifty has also moved above the 38.2% Fibonacci retracement level after a sharp correction over recent months. This means the index has recovered over a third of its recent losses, indicating improving momentum and a potential turnaround in market sentiment.

Khambata exits Trusts, slams Sept 17 events

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BENGALURU/MUMBAI: Senior Supreme Court lawyer Darius Khambata has chosen not to seek another term as a trustee of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, the two principal Tata Trusts, and termed "astounding" the Tata Sons directors' rebellion against Tata Trusts chair Noel Tata, which he said is 'a day that will live in infamy'. In a four-page letter sent to Noel and Tata Trusts chief executive officer (CEO) Sidharth Sharma on Monday, Khambata was sharply critical about the Tata Sons board and two fellow Trustees, Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh.

"The sad events of 17 September 2026, a day that will live in infamy, have sullied Tata Sons' reputation and have imperilled the image of corporate India. No spin doctoring can mask what happened," Khambata wrote.

"Would the board of Tata Sons have acted as it did on 17 September, had Ratan Tata still been alive? Of course not. But duties are owed to institutions, not to individuals. And as Ratan Tata used to say, the institution is always bigger than the individual".

"In April 2026, contrary to unanimous resolutions they had been party to, Vijay and Venu suddenly told the media, though not their co-trustees, that they favoured listing, disregarding the Trusts' interests. They have not shared their reasons for this volte-face with either," he said.

Khambata's stint at both SDTT and SRTT, which own 27.98% and 23.56%, respectively, of Tata Sons, ends later this week. With him leaving, SDTT will have five trustees, while SRTT will have four. Besides Noel, Srinivasan and Singh, SDTT's two other trustees include Noel's son Neville Tata and former Titan Co. CEO Bhaskar Bhat. SRTT's four trustees are Noel, Srinivasan, Pune-based businessman and philanthropist Jehangir H.C. Jehangir, and Jimmy Tata. Khambata also questioned Srinivasan's choice to ignore the Trusts' instructions a day before the 17 September board meeting, where Srinivasan's key vote supporting Tata Sons chair Chandrasekaran helped him secure a third term.

Khambata's stint at both SDTT and SRTT ends later this week. REUTERS

"It is now untenable to say that a nominee director of a public charitable trust, particularly a sitting Trustee, may act against the Trust's interests merely because he also owes a duty to the company; he sits on that board precisely to protect the Trusts," Khambata wrote, citing an earlier ruling by the Supreme Court in Tata's earlier case against former chairman Cyrus Mistry. "There cannot be two classes of trustees," he wrote.

On the question of listing Tata Sons, Khambata described the Tata model as a "living example of Mahatma Gandhiji's trusteeship idea: India's most famous industrial and charitable group, a national treasure where neither part is important without the other"."That this model is now threatened by those who, ironically citing its success, would decouple Tata Sons from the Trusts, is not objective judgement," he said.

Khambata praised Noel's leadership, calling his two-year period 'eventful', which he handled with 'calm dedication'.

"My stand and approach has at times differed from others', including Noel's; I appreciate Noel's democratic acceptance of this. That is the old Tata way," Khambata wrote.

Khambata's decision not to seek another term at Tata Trusts comes about eight months after former Citibank India head Pramit Jhaveri also chose not to seek reappointment at SDTT.

Trustee appointments and reappointments require unanimous approval from all trustees. However, because Srinivasan and Singh's views don't align with those of the other trustees, Khambata's reappointment could have become problematic, according to an executive. For this reason, Khambata, despite being asked by Noel to continue, decided not to seek another term.

India's manufacturing growth momentum eases in Oct

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NEW DELHI: India's manufacturing sector activity lost some growth momentum in October compared to September as output and new orders increased only marginally, according to HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) data released by S&P Global on Monday.

The headline figure, the manufacturing PMI — tracks factory conditions based on new orders, output, employment, suppliers' delivery time, and stock of purchases — stood at 54.7 in October, compared to 55.1 in September. To be sure, manufacturing activity remained in expansion, as the index stood above 50.

"India's manufacturing PMI softened to 54.7 in October from 55.1 in the previous month, but remained firmly in expansionary territory and above its long-run average," said Pranjul Bhandari, chief India economist at HSBC.

New business increased in October reflecting sustained demand for manufacturing goods. Growth softened marginally from September, which recorded a seven-month high, though it remained strong by historical standards. Firms cited favourable demand trends, new client wins and successful marketing campaigns for the growth. International orders increased at the fastest rate in six months and contributed to the index's expansion.

SC rejects Centre's plea in Vedanta-Ravva case

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NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday dismissed the Union government's appeal against a Delhi High Court order allowing Vedanta Ltd and Ravva Oil (Singapore) Pvt Ltd to enforce foreign arbitration awards involving claims of $99 million, criticising the Centre for resisting enforcement of awards that date back more than two decades and warning that such litigation could undermine confidence in India's arbitration regime.

A bench of justices JB Pardiwala and Manmohan questioned the government's approach to arbitration, asking why it was frustrating enforcement of an arbitral award even after the dispute had been adjudicated by foreign courts. The bench also questioned the Centre's commitment to promoting arbitration as an effective means of dispute resolution.

"What are these arguments? You are frustrating an arbitral award like this? At the stage of enforcement of it?" remarked the court, expressing concern over the message such litigation would send to international investors and parties choosing India as an arbitration destination.

"And we talk about all of this arbitration and seat and this and that?...Nobody will trust you," said the court, questioning the government's continued resistance to the awards.

The bench ultimately found no reason to interfere with the high court's July 1, 2026 judgment, which had rejected the Centre's objections to enforcement of the awards passed in 2004 and 2016 by an arbitral tribunal seated in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia.

"We are of the view that no error, not to speak of any error of law, could be said to have been committed by the high court in passing the impugned judgment and order," said the Supreme Court while dismissing the appeal.

The Supreme Court's dismissal of the Centre's appeal now leaves the high court's directions undisturbed.

Tata battery venture's China director leaves

NEW DELHI: The sole representative of Agratas Energy Storage Solutions Pvt. Ltd's Chinese-owned technology partner, AESC Apollo, has stepped down from the board of the Tata Group's battery venture less than two years after joining it and just ahead of the firm's move towards commercialization, regulatory filings show.

The departure of Gordon Louis Chin comes amid a decline in outstanding payments for its services and equipment to AESC and Agratas building its own manufacturing capabilities. The move marks a shift in the partnership's boardlevel representation just as the Tata firm prepares to scale up manufacturing in India and the UK.

Agratas is building a 40 GWh battery plant in Somerset, UK, and a 20 GWh facility in Sanand, Gujarat. Its research and development expenditure increased to £20.9 million in FY26 from £7.7 million in FY25 as it develops both LFP and NMC battery technologies.

According to company filings with the corporate affairs ministry reviewed by Mint, the two firms had entered into an intellectual property agreement in FY26 covering two types of lithium battery technologies for electric vehicles (EVs), nickel manganese cobalt (NMC) and lithium ferrous phosphate (LFP) battery technologies.

Agratas is looking to scale up battery manufacturing, with a 20 GWh plant in Gujarat and a 40 GWh facility in the UK, with Jaguar Land Rover lined up as its first major customer as part of a ₹5,000-crore deal between the two firms.

The board member's exit is significant because AESC's presence on the board gave the technology partner a say in Agratas' strategy and growth plans as the company prepares to begin manufacturing and scale up operations. *Mint* could not independently ascertain why Chin, who serves as AESC's general counsel, stepped down.

Agratas declined to comment on the issue, while AESC did not respond to emailed requests for comment. AYAAN KARTIK

GOVT PROMISES TO RESOLVE SCOTCH TARIFF DISPUTE

NEW DELHI: India assured industry executives on Monday it would honour a trade pact with Britain and resolve a dispute over Scotch whisky tariffs, easing concerns for companies such as Diageo and Pernod Ricard, six people with direct knowledge of the matter said.

In the first major dispute linked to the landmark India-UK trade pact, implemented in July, New Delhi in recent weeks launched investigations into major liquor companies and told them bulk Scotch imports were not eligible for the tariff cut to 75% from 150% agreed under the agreement, *Reuters* has reported.

At a closed-door meeting on Monday, commerce ministry officials told liquor industry executives that New Delhi would honour the pact in letter and spirit.

"We are potentially moving towards a resolution. Bulk Scotch whisky imports are indeed part of concessions under the trade deal," said one government source familiar with the discussions. REUTERS

TRAI mandates AI-led complaint centres, 16-hour human support

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NEW DELHI: The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) has directed telecom operators and internet service providers (ISPs) to run round-the-clock complaint centres that can be handled by AI agents, while mandating human assistance for at least 16 hours a day.

It has also introduced penalties of up to ₹20 lakh per quarter per service area for improper disposal or handling of consumer disputes, under amended telecom consumer complaint redressal rules released on Monday.

TRAI said that the rules would be published in the gazette.

For the first time, the telecom regulator has included AI-based customer care services in a binding rule under the Telecom Consumer Complaint Redressal (Fourth Amendment) Regulations, 2026. The rules, amended after more than a decade, were last revised on July 1, 2014.

TRAI said that the rules would be published in the gazette. MINT

The amended regulation 3(3) requires AI systems to "operate with appropriate human oversight" and consumers to receive "a notification" that they are speaking to an AI agent.

Under the amended rules, service providers will be charged ₹1,000 for every complaint and ₹5,000 for every appeal found to have been wrongly disposed of, with penalties capped at ₹20 lakh per quarter per service area.

TRAI also directed operators to submit quarterly performance reports, including number of complaints and appeals received, disposed of and pending, time taken for disposal and feedback survey results, in a format specified by the regulator.

Late submission of quarterly reports will attract penalties of up to ₹5,000 a day for 15 days and ₹20,000 a day thereafter, capped at ₹10 lakh per licensed service area.

The draft regulations were released on May 7, with stakeholder comments invited until June 12 and countercomments until June 19. TRAI received 32 comments and 24 countercomments, which it uploaded to its website. An open house discussion was held on July 17.

Operators opposed the 24x7 complaint-centre requirement on cost grounds.

Adani airport capacity cuts draw opposition

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NEW DELHI: A proposed reduction in Mumbai airport's capacity from April 2027 has intensified a standoff between airlines and Adani Airport, with foreign carriers resisting a plan to shift part of their international operations to the newly opened Navi Mumbai airport.

The Airline Operators Committee-Mumbai (AOC-Mumbai), which represents 46 airlines operating from the airport, again approached the aviation ministry on Monday, seeking protection for existing flight slots. It has argued that airport operator Mumbai International Airport Ltd (MIAL) has not adequately justified the proposed cut.

The dispute centres on MIAL's plan to shut Terminal 1 for redevelopment from April and shift 265 of the 770 weekly international departure slots at Terminal 2 to Navi Mumbai, about 50 km away. The move would cut Mumbai airport's passenger-handling capacity by 5 million passengers a year. Adani is not looking to defer the redevelopment further. MIAL is a JV between Adani Airport Holdings Ltd and state-run Airports Authority of India. Adani also operates Navi Mumbai airport.

In an email to civil aviation secretary Samir Kumar Sinha on November 2, AOC-Mumbai described the proposed cuts as unilateral and questioned the lack of justification and transparency. "We are concerned about MIAL's decision to reduce airport capacity by 5 MPPA from S-27 (April), which was categorically communicated by its senior official to all airlines present at the meeting on October 28, 2026, as a unilateral decision, without adequate justification or transparent disclosure of the actual available capacity at CSMIA," the committee said. *Mint* has reviewed a copy of the email.

{ THE CROSSWORDS }

CRYPTIC CLUES

ACROSS

1 Faulter when reduced to weeping (7)
5 Quick-tempered holy man cutting dried grass (5)
8 Unit for office or kitchen (9)
9 One about to display anger (3)
10 Badly hurt widow who married a wealthy farmer (4)
12 Biased team and what may be done about it (3-5)
14 Slightly sensitive? (6)
15 It returned having departed as ordered (6)
17 Make a deduction (8)
18 Manages to hit back and bring down (4)
21 She cut the first man short (3)
22 Complete journey to meet train perhaps (9)
24 She writes a letter in French (5)
25 Be prepared to defend (5,2)

DOWN

1 Fixed a trip to see an animal (5)
2 An attempt made in the past (3)
3 Generous ransom (4)
4 What is wrong in a record being beaten? (6)
5 An ironclad excuse for not buying luxuries (8)
6 Salt-water spray (9)
7 Bore fruit and let go (7)
11 Extremely handy sort of sketch (9)
13 She hurried round to a furniture designer (8)
14 Willingly die? (7)
16 Wins points for musical arrangements (6)
19 Devotion is a major point in compassion (5)
20 Very keen to rise as a singer (4)
23 Help I had with an article (3)

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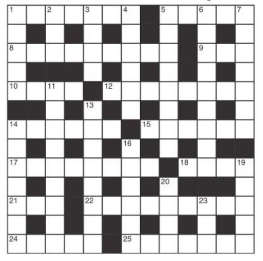


QUICK CLUES

ACROSS

1 Chivalrous (7)
5 Come into the mind (5)
8 All things considered (2,7)
9 Thick heavy mat (3)
10 Kind of long upholstered seat (4)
12 Capital of Hungary (8)
14 Price-fixing consortium (6)
15 Room attached to a church (6)
17 Indecorous (8)
18 An unfounded notion (4)
21 Only a handful (3)
22 Without precedent (7-2)
24 Tend in illness (5)
25 Pay no heed to orders (7)

DOWN

1 A dozen dozen (5)
2 Hit ball in high arc (3)
3 Competent (4)
4 Language (6)
5 Daunted (8)
6 At present (9)
7 With justification (7)
11 Destructive capacity of guns (9)
13 Firm of purpose (8)
14 Light diaphanous fabric (7)
16 Orderly arrangement (6)
19 Big and strong (5)
20 A raised floor (4)
23 To nickname (3)

YESTERDAY'S SOLUTIONS (17632)

CRYPTIC

O	V	E	R	C	A	S	T	■	S	P	A	R	■	■
A	■	G	■	H	■	T	■	L	■	R	■	E	■	■
K	Y	O	T	O	■	R	U	I	N	O	U	S	■	■
S	■	T	■	R	A	G	■	E	■	■	■	■	■	■
■	F	I	R	E	L	I	G	H	T	E	R	S	■	■
I	■	S	■	N	■	T	■	■	■	T	■	■	■	■
N	O	T	I	C	E	■	C	H	A	I	S	E	■	■
T	■	A	■	■	■	E	■	■	■	D	■	■	■	■
R	E	V	E	R	B	E	R	A	T	E	D	■	■	■
E	■	E	■	■	■	R	■	■	■	R	■	B	■	■
P	R	E	P	E	R	S	■	T	I	A	R	A	■	■
I	■	W	■	T	■	F	■	■	■	R	■	T	■	■
D	A	S	H	■	W	A	R	D	R	E	S	S	■	■

QUICK

F	E	E	D	B	A	C	K	■	J	A	V	A	■	■
S	U	I	T	E	■	G	O	U	L	A	S	H	■	■
T	■	G	■	A	■	E	■	T	■	R	■	E	■	■
■	P	E	C	K	I	N	G	O	R	D	E	R	■	■
S	■	N	■	T	■	F	■	■	■	E	■	■	■	■
P	A	T	C	H	Y	■	D	E	A	D	E	N	■	■
I	■	R	■	S	■	A	■	E	■	T	■	■	■	■
T	U	R	N	O	F	F	H	A	P	H	R	A	S	E
E	■	A	■	■	■	E	■	S	■	P	■	I	■	■
F	A	T	I	G	U	E	■	H	O	A	R	D	■	■
U	■	I	■	H	■	D	■	O	■	I	■	E	■	■
L	O	O	T	■	H	Y	S	T	E	R	I	A	■	■

{ SUDOKU }

DIFFICULTY LEVEL ★★★★

7					1		3	2
	2				7			6
		8	9	2		1		
4			1			5		
				3				
	6				5			9
		4		5	2	7		
1			9				6	
6	9		8					4

Fill in all the squares in the grid so that each row, column and each of the 9X9 squares contains all the digits from 1 to 9.

GAME ZONE: Scan the QR code for more daily puzzles and brain teasers

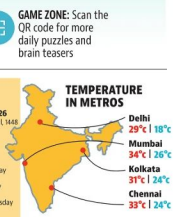
{ WEATHER }

TEMPERATURE ▪HIGH ▪LOW

TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY
Mainly clear sky mist in the morning hours	Mainly clear sky mist in the morning hours	Mainly clear sky
29°C | 16°C	28°C | 15°C	29°C | 16°C

ALMANAC
Today is
3rd November 2026
22 Jumada Al-Awwal, 1448
10, Kartika, Krishna Paksha, 10
Samvat 2083
Sunset: Tuesday at 05.34 p.m.
Sunrise: Wednesday at 06.35 a.m.
Moonset: Tuesday at 02.02 p.m.
Moonrise: Wednesday at 01.43 a.m.

TEMPERATURE IN METROS



कार्यालय नगर परिषद बून्दी

क्रमांक:– 8737 दिनांक:– 26.10.2026

–:: निविदा सूचना ::–

नगर परिषद बून्दी द्वारा जारी निविदा सं:- 8729 दिनांक 26/10/2026 की निविदा दिनांक 02/11/2026 से दिनांक 23/11/2026 06.00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन विक्रय की जावेगी। उक्त कार्य की BG (Bank Guarantee) दिनांक 25/11/2026 को प्रात: 10.00 बजे सायः 6.00 बजे तक जमा करवाई जा सकती है। निविदा दिनांक 26/11/2026 को 04.00 बजे ऑनलाईन खोली जावेगी। विस्तृत शर्तें व विवरण निविदा **sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** **eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर **DLB2627WLOB23247**, तथा कार्यालय समय मे किसी भी कार्यदिवस को नगर परिषद मे देखा जा सकता है। आयुक्त

राज.संवाद/सी/26/12739 नगर परिषद, बून्दी

संचालनालय खेल और युवा कल्याण

टी.टी. नगर स्टेडियम, भोपाल (म.प्र.)

ई-निविदा सूचना

संचालनालय खेल और युवा कल्याण, मध्यप्रदेश द्वारा **"ट्रॉफी, स्मृति चिन्ह, मेडल (फायबर/क्रिस्टल/वुडन/ब्रास/3डी) व अन्य सामग्री क्रय हेतु"** निर्माता अथवा उनके अधिकृत प्रतिनिधि से ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा प्रपत्र व निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें **www.mptenders.gov.in** पर उपलब्ध हैं। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरांत निविदा में कोई संशोधन व परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र उपरोक्त उल्लेखित ई-टेण्डर पोर्टल पर ही उपलब्ध रहेगा।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128890/2026 संचालक

संचालनालय खेल और युवा कल्याण

टी.टी. नगर स्टेडियम, भोपाल, मध्यप्रदेश

ई-निविदा सूचना

संचालनालय खेल और युवा कल्याण, मध्यप्रदेश, द्वारा **"आउटडोर सिंथेटिक बॉस्केटबॉल/व्हालीबॉल/लॉन टेनिस कोर्ट स्थापना/निर्माण हेतु"** निर्माता अथवा उनके अधिकृत प्रतिनिधि से ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र व निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें **www.mptenders.gov.in** पर उपलब्ध हैं। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरांत निविदा में कोई संशोधन व परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र उपरोक्त उल्लेखित ई-टेण्डर पोर्टल पर ही उपलब्ध रहेगा।

म.प्र. माध्यम/128910/2026 संचालक

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Office of the Superintending Engineer, DS Circle, PSPCL, Patiala, 66 KV Grid Sub Station Colony, DCW Road, Patiala-147001 (Punjab), 96461-01201, 96461-10963, E-mail: circlepatiala1@gmail.com
Reg. Office: PSPCL Head Office, The Mall, Patiala (Punjab)

Tender Enquiry No. 42/SE/DS Circle, Patiala/2026-27 Dated: 02.11.2026

Superintending Engineer/DS Circle, PSPCL Patiala invites e-tender for Outsourcing of Labour Part for Erection, Testing & Commissioning of New 11KVLT/HTLines on Rail/PCC Poles, Distribution T/Fs, Augmentation/Sagging of ACSR of HT/LT Lines, Cables laying, Guarding, Stay Set for Various Works such as Releasing of T/Well Connections, GSC/ISC Connections, Deloading of Overloaded T/Fs, Shifting of Meters Outside Consumer Premises, Preventive maintenance of HT/LT lines not involving conductor replacement or insertion of extra poles Earthing of DTs/Lines or any Development Works under DS Division EAST Patiala under DS Circle Patiala for F.Y. 2027-28.

For detailed NIT and Tender Specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from **02.11.2026, 06.00 PM onwards.**

NOTE: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C1044/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16722

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

REGD. OFFICE:- PSEB HEAD OFFICE, THE MALL, PATIALA 147001
CORPORATION IDENTITY NUMBER(CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
WEBSITE:- www.pspcl.in. Contact Number (96461-22942)

Tender Inquiry No: 14/MHC/2026-27, 15/MHC/2026-27, 16/MHC/2026-27 Dated: 02.11.2026

Sr. Xen/Civil, MHC O&M Division Talwara invites E-Tender for following as per technical specification:

1. Rostoration of damaged CC Lining slabs in between RD 1846 M to RD 2975 M on both sides of MHC-II during the year 2026-27. **(14/MHC/2026-27)**
2. Filling of cavities behind CC lining slabs by coarse sand grouting in between RD 31722 M to RD 35500 M on both sides of MHC-I during the year 2026-27 **(15/MHC/2026-27)**
3. OUTSOURCING OF ACTIVITY/SERVICES FOR WATCH & WARD, CUTTING & CLEARANCE OF WILD GROWTH FROM THE JOINTS OF CEMENT CONCRETE LINING SLABS, INTERNAL SIDE SLOPES/EMBANKMENTS/DRAIN, STONE PITCHING ETC. OF MHC-I&II FOR THE PERIOD OF ONE YEAR." **(16/MHC/2026-27)**

For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 03.11.2026, from 05.00 PM onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

RO No. 1079/12/2026/27/16713 C1039/26

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Regd. office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001
Corporate Identity Number: U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
(Contact no. 96461-20640)

Tender Enquiry no. 1965/Th.Op/O&M/PC-2834 Dated: 02.11.2026

Chief Engineer/O&M (P&P Cell-I), GHTP, Lehra Mohabbat- 151111 Distt. Bathinda invites E-tender for the **Procurement of 140 MT of Sulphuric Acid for GHTP Lehra Mohabbat.** Quantity as per NIT. For detailed NIT & Tender Specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 02.11.2026 from 1700 hrs. Onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and Addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

GHTP-81/26 RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16731

L&T Realty

PUBLIC NOTICE

It has come to our attention that certain unauthorized persons/entities are advertising, marketing, soliciting bookings, or falsely claiming association with International Green Scapes Limited, c/o L&T Realty Properties Limited, in relation to the proposed project at Sectors 81 & 86, Gurugram, Haryana.

The public is hereby informed that the Company has not authorized any person, broker, channel partner, marketing agency, or third party to advertise, market, promote, or solicit bookings for the said project. The Company is also not currently undertaking any marketing, promotional, or booking activities for this project.

Accordingly, any advertisement, offer, communication, or booking invitation relating to the project should be treated with caution and independently verified with the Company. The Company shall not be responsible for any loss or consequences arising from dealings with unauthorized persons or reliance on unauthorized representations.

Appropriate legal action, including civil and/or criminal proceedings, may be initiated against any person or entity misrepresenting an association with the Company or dealing with the project without prior written authorization.

For International Green Scapes Limited
c/o L&T Realty Properties Limited

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

The **Deputy Chief Engineer/Const./Northern Railway, Shivaji Bridge, New Delhi,** for and on behalf of the President of India invites **open e-tender** under **Single Packet System** for the following work:-

Name of Work and location	"Composite Tender for Earth Work in Filling, Cutting, Mechanical Compaction, provision of Blanketing, Construction of Minor Bridge and Platform Extension & linking of BG track; turnouts, provision of glued joints; SEJs, dismantling of existing track; turnouts, handling, lifting, loading, leading, unloading and subsequent packing & palletization following Specification IS/RDSOGE/0001:2023 (February 2023) and latest correction slips, from Ramkumarpura mining area, Village Ramkumarpura, Tehsil Khetri, District Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan, or Khanak mining area (under the control of HSIIDC), Tehsil Tosham, District Bhiwani, Haryana, or any other mining source producing similar quality machine crushed hard stone ballast as above, at cess/bank, handling of P way material involving a BH/NH period and other allied works in c/w "Gurgaon- Yard remodelling along with the Development of Passenger Amenities at GGN station in c/w Re Development of NDLS"
Completion period of the work	12 (Twelve) Months
Approx. Cost of work	₹828.55 Lakh
Earnest Money to be deposited	₹16,57,100/-
Sale/availability of tender document on Rly. Website	Tender documents will be available on IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** from **02.11.2026 to 25.11.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs.**
Last date/Time of upload of tenders	**25.11.2026** upto 15:00 hrs. Tender documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS website w.e.f. **11.11.2026 to 25.11.2026**
Date and Time of opening of tender	**25.11.2026** at 15:00 hrs.

No.: 554-ACS-GGN-YARD-CSB Dated: 02.11.2026 3833/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Advertisement for Recruitment

Online applications are invited from eligible candidates for Water Testing Laboratories of Department of Water Supply and Sanitation, Punjab for the following posts on purely contract basis initially for a period of one year (extendable upon the performance of the candidate & requirement of the Department):-

Sr. No.	Laboratory	Posts	
		Senior Chemist	Chemist
Consolidated Pay per month/per post		56,000/-	48,000/-
1	Regional Water Testing Laboratory, Amritsar	1	1
2	Regional Water Testing Laboratory, Sangrur	1	0
3	Regional Water Testing Laboratory, Hoshiarpur	0	1
	Total	**2***	**2***

*For the post of Senior Chemist: 01 seat is reserved for SC category and 01 post for General category.

*For the post of Chemist: 01 seat is reserved for SC category (Woman) and 01 post for Ex Serviceman.

Interested candidates will have to apply for each post separately. The selected candidates will be given final posting on the basis of merit. However, decision of competent authority of department will be final. A Screening written Test for each post will be held for short listed candidates (fulfilling the Qualification and experience criteria) only. The shortlisted candidates (fulfilling the Qualification and experience criteria) will be required to appear in written test and further in interview as detailed in TOR as decided by Department. These posts are non transferable except in rare cases due to administrative reasons.

The job profile, qualification, experience, other conditions and prescribed application form may be downloaded from the Department's Website **https://dwss.punjab.gov.in/** w.e.f. 03.11.2026 Last date for filling up applications online is 23.11.2026 upto 5.00 pm. Only online application submitted on department's website will be accepted. No hard copy or email shall be entertained in this respect.

Note: Date of screening test, any other information & any corrigendum(s) shall be published on above website only.

Head,
Department of Water Supply & Sanitation, Punjab,
Water Works Complex, Phase 2, S.A.S. Nagar
Phone No. 0172-2270101, 4330317

RO NO. 1040/12/2026/27/16689

HT Classifieds {Tuesday}

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www.htclassifieds.com

EMPLOYMENT/ ACADEMIC

दिल्ली कॉलेज ऑफ आर्ट्स एण्ड कॉमर्स
DELHI COLLEGE OF ARTS & COMMERCE
दिल्ली विश्वविद्यालय
(University of Delhi)
नेताजी नगर, नई दिल्ली–110023
Netaji Nagar, New Delhi - 110023

Advt. No.DCAC/Advt./Principal/2026/677 Dated: 20.08.2026

Online applications are invited in the prescribed Application Form from eligible candidates for appointment to the post of

PRINCIPAL

in the Academic Pay Level 14 of 7th Central Pay Commission Pay Matrix, in the College. The last date for receipt of application is 21.11.2026 or two weeks from the date of publication of the advertisement in the Employment News, whichever is later. For details, please visit the College website: https://dcac.du.ac.in

Any addendum/corrigendum shall be posted only on the College website.

Web link for applying the post online: https://rec.uod.ac.in

CHAIRMAN, GOVERNING BODY

Important Note:
The details regarding qualifications, publications, experience, screening guidelines and indicative proforma etc. are available on the College website i.e. https://dcac.du.ac.in along with this advertisement. The applicants are required to read these details before filling up the form.

TAGORE PUBLIC School, D Block, Naraina Vihar, New Delhi requires Trained Teachers - Maths (VI-VIII), Hindi (V-VIII), Primary & Nursery. Contact School Personally with Resume & Photo

K.S.K. ACADEMY
(CBSE AFFILIATED)
Website: www.kskacademy.ac.in
Ph: 9810086205, 9810052205

REQUIRES

INVITING APPLICATIONS FOR THE FOLLOWING POSTS:
PGT- English, Painting
TGT- English, Sanskrit
PRT- S.St., Maths, Sports, Yoga
Apply online immediately on Teacher's Application Form which is available under "Recruitment Section" of school website. Only Shortlisted candidates will be called for Interview. Principal

CANTERBURY
PUBLIC SCHOOL
B-1 Block, Yamuna Vihar, Delhi-53

REQUIRES

English Medium FEMALE Trained Staff on Contractual Basis
- Asstt. Trs. (Nur) / NTT
- Asstt. Trs. (Primary)
- Music & Dance Trs.
- Computer Trs.
- Account Asstt. (Female)
- Computer Operators (M/F)
- Office Clerk (M/F)

EXCELLENT SALARY
WALK IN INTERVIEW (8am-12 noon)
Contact immediately to Principal

Shiv Vani M. S. S. School
ESTD. 1981
(Affiliated to CBSE)
ISO 9001:2015 certified School
Mahavir Enclave, Palam - Dabri Road, Dwarka, New Delhi-110045
Walk-in-Interview
4th, 5th & 6th Nov., 2026
10 a.m. to 11.30 am
1. **Computer Science Teacher** (Leave Vacancy)
2. **PRT Mother Teacher**
3. **Accountant** (Min. 10 years of experience)
4. **Band Master (Brass)** (Retired from Armed Forces)

- Candidates who have applied earlier need not attend.

shivvani1981@gmail.com
PRINCIPAL

REQD. FEMALE Staff- PGT-Biology TGT- Science, Maths, English, Sanskrit, PET, Nurse & Recep. G.D. Lancer's Pub School, RJ/43, Sainik Enc, Mohan Gdn, Uttam Ngr, ND-59, M:9773847418, 8130193829

REQD PHYSICAL Education PGT Teacher (PET), Special Educator, Computer Teacher & Accountant in Reputed School, New Delhi - 110046, Phone - 9350663319, Email: clpjgarg@gmail.com

SALES & MARKETING

REAL ESTATE company urgently requires Sales Executives (min 3 yr exp in real estate). Cont: Height Developer Dwarka. Ph: 8796837009, 8796847009.

ENGINEER/ PROD/TECHNICAL

REQUIRED SR. Civil Engineer/ Sr. Architect/ Sr. Project Coordinator/ Retired Government/ MES Engineers. Integral Designs International Studio Pvt. Ltd. E-90, Anand Niketan, ND-21, Email: jobs@integraldesigns.in

MEDICAL

WANTED MEDICAL Representatives & Area Sales Manager for Delhi/NCR Minimum 1 year's experience in the respective role in a pharmaceutical organisation. Attractive salary + incentives Omshree Sidha Pharma Manufacturers of quality Ayurvedic medicines. Send CV: WhatsApp: 9846992789 Email: info@omshreeayur.com

DOCTORS REQD. - Urology Hospital, Central Delhi. 1. BAMS (M/F, Hindu) 2. Research Assistant for Scientific Publication. Contact: 9999346278.

STENO–TYPIST/ OFFICE ASST

FEMALE OFFICE Assistant Needed For Transport Company at Karol Bagh, Delhi. Qualification. 12th above + Exp.- 2 years, Age- 22 to 26 yrs. Call. 8882556316, WhatsApp: 7982921692

HOTEL/RESTAURANT

URGENTLY NEED Stewards (Salary 12000/- to 14000/-) and Captain (Salary 17000/- to 20000/-) at Saffron Restaurant, Paharganj, New Delhi -55 Contact 9958798486

PART TIME JOB

WE ARE hiring Part/Full Time for Noida, age 30-65yrs education: Graduate+pref-retired, h/wife, VRS, self empl earn 50k-1lac fix+vari+fun trip # 9582848400 / 9971096664

PART TIME JOB

PART TIME / Full time Job, speci. retd. person & Housewives, Govt. job prof. Grad. & above M/F , Pay - Fix + Vari. pay + Frgn. trip, Noida / Fully Digi. , 9718285424, 8178244407

COMPUTER OPERATOR

REQUIRED COMPUTER operator having Experience in M.S Office /Back office work /Filling work Min 5 Yrs exp. Contact At. 9818396974

PROPERTY

SOUTH DELHI

ANAND NIKETAN
ADPL Nayan Singh 9811109597

FOR SALE Anand Niketan, Builder floor, New Second Floor, South West Facing Plot Size- 272 Sq. Yards 3 BHK + 1 Study with Washroom , 2 Car Still Parking. Contact 9811109597

SARVODAYA ENCLAVE
ADPL Nayan Singh 9811109597

SARVODAYA ENCLAVE. 200 sq yds First Floor/2nd Floor, park Facing, separate gate, parking 2 Car, New Height Ready to Move, Many more options in South Delhi. # 9811109597

ANAND NIKETAN
ADPL Pooja 9211061709

ANAND NIKETAN 200 yards, Ground Floor +Basement, 3 Bedrooms, 2 car Parking , Corner Plot. Many more options Available in South Delhi. Pooja 9211061709

VASANT VIHAR
ADPL Pooja 9211061709

VASANT VIHAR 400 Sq. Yards , Third Floor with Terrace, 4 Bedrooms, stilt 2 Car Parking, Many More Options Available in South Delhi. Pooja 9211061709

JANGPURA EXTENSION
THE IND REALTY
Real Estate Solutions
92288 12243

JANGPURA EXTENSION, 300 sqyd, Second Floor with Terrace, Prime Location, Ample Parking Outside, Price @ 1D Cr, Call Rihan for Visit & Details # Call 9228812243

ANAND LOK
THE IND REALTY
Real Estate Solutions
99109 14358

ANAND LOK- 400Sqyd, first floor, 4 BHK, Park Facing, Lounge Area, Separate Gate Parking, Also TT+ Terrace, well maintained, attractive price. Call # Aman 9910914358

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200 Bigha
Residential / Farm House
9811527999

LAND FOR Sale 200 Bigha Land, ideal for Residential and Farm House Projects at Garh Mukteshwar, Uttar Pradesh. 120071 Contact number 9811527999

SOUTH DELHI

UDAY PARK SAFDARJUNG ENCLAVE
Since 1965 MALIK ESTATES 9810039071

217VD/300YD FLOORS, Both Ground Floor+ Basement 3/4BHK, also 3rd with Terrace Ready for possession. Contact: Sanjay Malik 9810039071 Visit: www.malikestateagents.com

SHOWROOM GREEN PARK MARKET
Since 1965 MALIK ESTATES 9810039071

RENTED GROUND Floor to Top Coffee Shop Brand, First Floor Rented to Top Dermatologist Brand. Also vacant 2nd Floor with roof, attractive deal. Call: Sanjay Malik 9810039071

Safdarjung Enclave
READY FLOORS
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I, SMITA W/o No-1569094AK Nav Vinod Singh Raghuwanshi R/o At/Post- Morkha, Teh-Amla, Dist-Betul, MP-460661, have changed my name from Smita to Smita Raghuvanshi for all purposes vide Public Notary Delhi affidavit dt 31-10-2026.

I, SUMIT S/o Sh. Rajender Yadav R/o H.No. B.358, Gali No.1, Tirkha Colony, Ballabgarh, Faridabad, Haryana-121001 declare that my father's name Rajendera and Rajender Yadav is the one one and same person.

I, AIRES Father Furtado S/o Philip Furtado R/o Archbishop House, 1, Ashoka Palace, New Delhi - 110001 have changed my name to Aires Vincent Furtado for all future Purposes.

I, AFSAR Jahan W/O Mohd Salman born on 27/01/1987 residing at 2952, Gali Ijechi Masjid Kali Masjid Turkman Gate, have changed my name to Kehkashan vide affidavit dated Affidavit date 30/10/26 at South Delhi.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, SELIA Tyagi W/o Rahul Tyagi R/o A-166/F No.302, 3rd Floor, Chattarpur Enclave Phase-2, Delhi-110074 have changed my name Selia for all future purposes.

I DEEPAK Kumar S/O Brij Mohan Shah R/O Kh.No-51 ,Gali No 14 Block D Jagran Chowk Mutavidhar Mukand Pur ,Delhi -42 have changed my name from Deepak to Deepak Kumar for all purposes.

I, MOHAMMAD Nader Wafa, Son Of Haider Ali, Resident Of C20/1, Ganesh Nagar, Delhi-110018, Hereby State That I Have Changed My Name From Md Nader To Mohammad Nader Wafa, My Minor Daughter's Name From Zahra To Zahra Wafa And Her Mother's Name From Zainab To Zainab Wafa. Therefore, In Future, We Should Be Known And Identified By These New Names In All Educational And Official Documents.

I, MANDEEP Singh., S/o S. Gajinder Pal Singh Makar, R/o F/58, 1st Floor, Subhash Nagar, New Delhi-110027, have changed my name to Mandeep Singh Maker vide Affidavit dated 31.10.2026 before Notary Anupama Sethi, Delhi. All concerned note.

I, VIDUSHA, D/O Jagannath Mittal, R/O Rohini, Delhi, have changed my name to Vidusha Goyal

I, SIMMI Menon W/o Santosh TT R/O A-40, Second Floor, Kaushambi, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201010, have Changed name from Simmi Simmi Menon to Simmi Kamboj for all future purposes and legal documents

I, VIKRANT Kumar Verma, S/o Sh. Chandra Narayan Verma, R/o H. No. 799, Raja Garden, Sector-19, Old Faridabad, Haryana- 121002, have changed the name of my minor son Hardik Verma, aged 13 years to Aaryan Verma. Henceforth, my son shall be known as Aaryan Verma for all purposes.

I, SUSHILA W/o Ram Lakhan Yadav R/o Extra-35/10, Trilok Puri, Delhi-110091 have changed my name from to Sushila Devi to Sushila in future for all purposes.

I, ALBATTANI Zulkarnain Golam Ahmad S/o Golam Yazdani, R/o H-38/A, Abul Fazal Enclave-1, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name from Albattani Zulkarnain Golam Ahmad to Albattani Zulkarnain for all future purposes

I, MRS. Vina W/O Late Shri Kailash Singh R/O 1914, Vandana Enclave, Sihoda Colony, Ghaziabad, holding Aadhaar Card No. 8775 2202 8409, hereby declare that the correct name of my husband is Kailash Singh Rawat instead of Kailash Singh, Lailash Singh and Kailash Singh Rawat refer to one and the same person. Henceforth, his correct name shall be considered as Kailash Singh Rawat Affidavit Dt: 07.09.2026

I, SANJANA S Sonkar, wife of Adarsh kumar Srivastava, resident of Flat no.7, Block D, Bhorgarh, Sector G-2, Pocket-2, VTC-Narela, P.O.-Narela, District -Northwest Delhi, State-Delhi, Have changed my Surname From Sanjana S Sonkar to Sanjana Srivastava after marriage. henceforth i shall be known as Sanjana Srivastava for all purpose and all concerned are requested to note the change

I, SAVITA Devi W/o Chotan Kumar R/o B-57, Near Mandir Gali, Amar Colony, Phase-3, Manglol, Nilothi, West Delhi, 110041 have changed my minor daughter's name from Laxmini Kumari to Chandni for all future Purposes.

I, SANTOSH Menon S/o Thankappan Pillai R/o A-40, Second Floor, Kaushambi, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201010, have changed my name from Santosh Menon to Santosh TT for all future purposes and legal documents.

I, MUSAB Rafiq Agwan S/o Abdul Rashid Agwan, R/o H-19, 4th Floor, Abul Fazal Enclave-1, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, New Delhi-110025 have changed my name from Musab Rafiq Agwan to Musab Rafeeq for all future purposes.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, CHANDRAKANTA, R/O A-9, Brotherhood Apartment, Vikas Puri, Delhi, changed my name as Astha Verma W/o Ashish Verma.

I, KAPIL Kumar, S/O Shiv Nandan Gupta, 48/1 Street No.2 Pratap Ngr Mayur Vihar, New Delhi-91, have changes my name to Kapil Kumar Gupta, for all purposes.

I VAISHNAVI D/o Mr. Sanjeev Kumar Has pased ICSE(2023) and ISC(2025) From St. Thomas english Medium School Meerut and have changed my name Vaishnavi Thakur. Henceforth i shall be known as Vaishnavi Thakur For all purposes.

I, TAMOOR Husain S/O Karrar Husain R/O House No. A-68, Brita-1, Greater Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP have changed my name to Taimoor Husain for all future purpose.

I, JC-314086N SB Raj Kumar Sharma, Presently serving in Indian Army R/o 514, Nagalia Takkar, Bulandshahr, UP-203129, declare that my wife's name is wrongly mentioned as Nirmala Sharma in my service record and her correct name is Nirmla Sharma for all future purposes vide Public Notary Delhi affidavit dt 02-11-2026.

I, VIDUSHA, D/O Jagannath Mittal, R/O Rohini, Delhi, have changed my name to Vidusha Goyal

I AVNISH Kumar, S/O Shri Balram Sahu, R/O D-157/2 F/F Bapu Park Ram Sahu Raj Nagar II Palam Colony New Delhi 110077 do hereby declare that Avnish Kumar and Avnish Sahu refer to the Same Person

LOST & FOUND

I, AVINASH Kumar Jha ,S/O Sh. Janardan Jha, has lost my original GPA Property Document No.IN-DL75820365921682M on 28.10.26 at Dwarka, South West Delhi. The loss has been reported to Delhi Police vide Information Report I.R No.761922/2026 dated 30.10.2026. P.S. Dwarka North.The document was lost Near Chandra Park, Kakrola, Dwarka, South West Delhi - 110078. finder please Cont- 7048907262

I INDRA Kumari Jha, lost 2 payment receipt 760 762 Dt 21/12/22, Allotment Letter with cossing page Dt 29/11/18, Possession Certificate Dt 30/03/23, Possession Letter Dt 30/03/23 of flat 0302, Ambience Tivertan Noida.

I, B. Sekar S/o Late Shri K Ramamurthy R/O 37-B, OCS Apartment, Mayur Vihar Phase-I Extension, Delhi 110091 have lost Original Possession Slip of flat No. 207-F Pocket-I Mayur Vihar Phase-I Delhi-9.File No.7-941290JUL/G/82MMU. Finder contact +91 9319739847

PERSONAL

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Date: 31.10.2026
Place: New Delhi
Karnik Rajat (Advocate)
D/1013/99
D-246, First Floor, Defence Colony, New Delhi-110024
Mobile: 9811074147

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Kimi's meteoric rise to F1 immortality

This balance of staggering maturity and youthful exuberance defined his championship run

Sandip Sikdar
sandip.sikdar@htlive.com

NEW DELHI: For 73 years, an entire nation steeped in motorsport history waited. Not since Alberto Ascari claimed the crown in 1953 had the 'Tricolore' flown over the Formula 1 paddock. The Italian grandstands had grown weary of hope deferred, yearning for a new idol to capture the nation's fiery passion for racing.

Then came Andrea Kimi Antonelli.

At just 20 years and 68 days, the Bologna-born prodigy did not merely find a place in the history books, he rewrote them. By shattering Sebastian Vettel's long-standing record to become the youngest world champion in Formula 1 history, Antonelli completed a meteoric rise that left the motorsport world breathless.

The roots of this extraordinary journey trace back to his childhood in Emilia-Romagna, where motorsport was a family language. Nurtured by his father's racing background, Kimi tore through the karting ranks with terrifying speed, collecting European titles before catching the discerning eye of Mercedes team principal Toto Wolff. Enrolled in the Mercedes junior programme as a pre-teen in 2019, Antonelli was destined for greatness, but destiny was fast-tracked when seismic shifts shook the driver market.

When Lewis Hamilton announced his blockbuster departure for Ferrari, Mercedes needed a miracle. Wolff's solution was to pluck Antonelli from the junior categories and thrust him straight into a Silver Arrow for the 2025 season. At the time, the decision was met with fierce skepticism and external pressure. Sponsors balked, critics scoffed, and the paddock whispered: "Who is this kid?"

Reflecting on the gamble, Wolff said: "When Lewis told me he was going to Ferrari, it was my immediate reaction to put him (Antonelli) in the car. We had sponsors leaving us for that decision. 'Who is this kid?' It was a difficult year, but the others have got the full reward. A difficult year and now — this. I'm so proud of the team for their trust and that we delivered."

Delivering is an understatement. Paired alongside George Russell, a seasoned and fast benchmark within the Mercedes garage, Antonelli faced a major internal trial. But rather than being swallowed by the pressure, the youngster systematically usurped the existing order.

Displaying extraordinary race craft and poise that belied his years, Antonelli went toe-to-toe with Russell, ultimately outshining his more experienced teammate across a gruelling campaign.

Peer recognition came swiftly. Outgoing world champion Lando Norris captured the sentiment of the paddock perfectly. "He's done an insane job," said the McLaren driver. "I feel like people are somehow not giving him enough credit for what he's achieved this year. He's beaten a teammate that's been in the sport 4-5 times longer than him, who's also very good, and took the battle to Lewis."

What makes Antonelli truly unique is the duality of his character. On the asphalt, he is a ruthless but calculated driver, hunting with breathtaking speed. Outside the cockpit, he remains an unpretentious, infectious personality who completely transformed the atmosphere inside the Brackley-based team.

"In the team, there are all these stiff and unemotional English people and then in comes this Italian boy who hugs everybody and he changes the environment and now all the Brits are hugging each other. And he's still a kid, just 20 years old. It's so great to see. He does the meetings and then he goes to the water park with his friends," says an elated Wolff.

This balance of staggering maturity and youthful exuberance defined his championship run. Across the season, Antonelli delivered masterclass performances that left competitors stunned.

From his sensational maiden victory in China to tactical masterstrokes under changing weather conditions in Europe, he stood out from a field stacked with multiple world champions. In only his second year in the sport, Antonelli handled the championship burden with a stable head, absorbing every ounce of pressure and expectation without ever sinking under the weight.

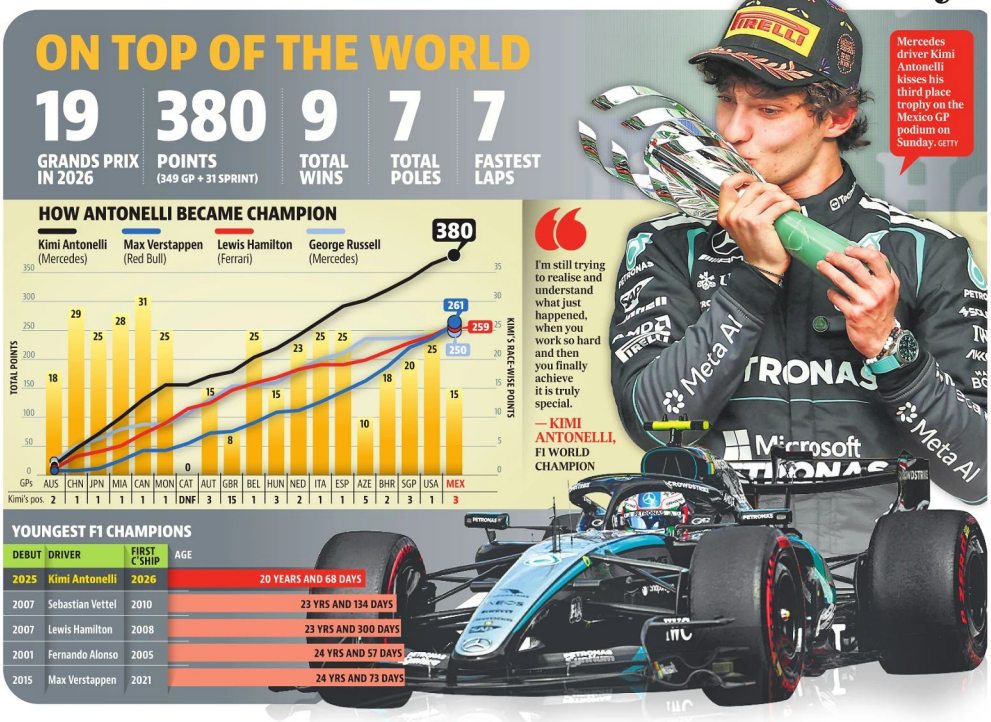
The cinematic climax of his coronation arrived in the vibrant Mexico City. Following a high-stakes Grand Prix at the Autodromo Hermanos Rodriguez, the podium ceremony delivered a poignant passing of the torch.

There stood Antonelli, flanked by race winner Max Verstappen and seven-time world champion Lewis Hamilton, the very man whose legacy he had inherited at Mercedes two seasons prior.

In a moment of pure sporting brotherhood and profound respect, Verstappen and Hamilton hoisted the young Italian onto their shoulders, lifting him high above the roaring stadium complex. It was a picturesque passing of the baton from the sport's established titans to its undisputed future.

F1 CEO Stefano Domenicali encapsulated the gravity of the afternoon perfectly. "Greatness is measured not only by records, but by the generations it inspires. Kimi has captured the imagination of millions of fans around the world and shown young people everywhere that there are no limits to what can be achieved through dedication, belief and hard work," said Domenicali. "Today, his name joins the legends of our sport. A new chapter in Formula 1 history has been written, and I firmly believe this is only the beginning of an extraordinary legacy."

As the champagne sprayed over Mexico City and the echoes of the Italian national anthem resonated across the circuit, the reality set in. Antonelli is no longer just "the kid" Wolff gambled on. He is the benchmark, a world champion, an embodiment of Italy's 73-year dream fulfilled.



Mercedes driver Kimi Antonelli kisses his third place trophy on the Mexico GP podium on Sunday. GETTY

Italy had Farina and Ascari... 73 years before Kimi

Sandip Sikdar
sandip.sikdar@htlive.com

NEW DELHI: As Kimi Antonelli leaves Mexico having rewritten the record books, Italian motorsport finally bids adieu to a heavy, echoing past and embraces the euphoria of a young champion's arrival.

Amid the sleek corporate hospitality suites of the paddock and the roaring hybrid power units (PU) in the garages, it is easy to forget that Italy is one of Grand Prix racing's foundational cornerstones. Yet, despite being one of motorsport's spiritual homes, Italy had lived through an agonising drought until Sunday when Antonelli was crowned the world champion.

More than 70 years had passed since an Italian driver last stood atop the Formula 1 world. In fact, only two Italians have ever claimed the world drivers' championship — Giuseppe 'Nino' Farina in 1950 and Alberto Ascari in 1952 and 1953.

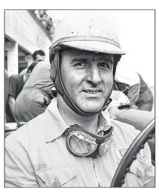
For the current generation of fans, whose F1 vocabulary is shaped by Lewis Hamilton, Max Verstappen and the rising wave of young talent, these names are perhaps long forgotten. To understand the weight of Antonelli's modern charge, one must look back at the two men who etched Italy's name into the sport's immortal text.

Gladiator Farina

When the inaugural season of the FIA Formula 1 World Championship kicked off at Silverstone on May 13, 1950, the man who conquered the afternoon was an aristocratic Turin-born lawyer with a penchant for high speed.

Farina was a study in contrasts. Cultured, educated and physically imposing, Farina earned a doctoral degree in law and had an elite athletic background. Yet behind the wheel of the Alfa Romeo supercharged 158 'Alfetta' he was an unyielding, fearless competitor.

Farina's drive at the 1950 British Grand Prix was absolute dominance. Pole position, fastest lap and victory. He was devastatingly fast, but his career was defined by a razor-thin margin between brilliance and disaster.


Giuseppe 'Nino' Farina. GETTY

Alberto Ascari. GETTY

Enzo Ferrari famously remarked that Farina was a man of steel who acted like a high-strung thoroughbred, regularly visiting the hospital after pushing his machines far beyond their limits.

He clinched the inaugural title at Monza later that year, roared on by a delirious home crowd. Though he raced until 1955 — 1950-51 for Alfa Romeo and 1952-55 for Ferrari — Farina's legacy remains anchored to that historic dawn of F1. He ultimately met a tragic end in 1966, ironically killed in a road accident while traveling to watch the French Grand Prix.

Ascari, the maestro

Ascari remains Ferrari's only Italian world champion and the last driver from the peninsula to conquer the sport.

Born in Milan in 1918, Ascari carried a heavy surname. His father, Antonio Ascari, was a legendary pre-war racing icon who died at the 1925 French Grand Prix when Alberto was just seven. Despite the trauma, Alberto recognised his bloodline and answered to the call of speed by initially starting on motorcycles before shifting to four wheels under the watchful eyes of family friend, Enzo Ferrari.

Affectionately nicknamed 'Ciccio' by Italian fans, Ascari defied stereotypes. He drove not recklessly but with impressive precision, calculating every apex and managing his machinery with peerless mechanical empathy.

When regulatory changes forced F1 to run to Formula 2 specifications in 1952 and 1953, Ascari and the revolutionary Ferrari 500 created an era of absolute hegemony. He won six of the seven championship rounds in 1952, and five in 1953, securing back-to-back world titles — a feat matched at Scuderia Ferrari only by the legendary Michael Schumacher decades later.

Off the track, Ascari was endearingly human, crippled by superstitious quirks. He abhorred black cats, feared unlucky numbers, and guarded his lucky blue helmet and jersey obsessively.

Tragically, his life mirrored his father's. In May 1955, while testing a sports car at Monza, Ascari crashed and died at the young age of 36, the same age as his father.

A seven-decade silence

For 73 years, the spirits of Farina and Ascari have hung heavily over Italian motorsport. As decades rolled by, Italian fans witnessed generations of exceptional talents. Michele Alboreto, Giancarlo Fisichella and Riccardo Patrese won multiple races, but the supreme prize always slipped away.

Foreign titans claimed the red cars of Maranello while the championship trophy migrated to Britain, Germany, Brazil and beyond. Now, Antonelli's meteoric rise has turned the ghosts of Turin and Milan from quiet watchers into active participants.

Farina and Ascari proved that Italian grit, precision and passion could conquer the world. As the modern grid hurtles toward the final stretch of the season, the legacy of F1's original Italian kings is closer than ever to being claimed anew.

Everyone knows I don't have support in life, says emotional Sarfaraz Khan

Rasesh Mandani
rasesh.mandani@htlive.com

MUMBAI: Sarfaraz Khan is a bitter man. After playing 6 Test matches for India where he scored a hundred and 3 fifties and averaged 37.10, he finds himself in and out of the Indian Test team.

The middle-order batter was given a call-up to join the squad for the Test tour of Sri Lanka, but didn't get a game. Subsequently, he wasn't picked for Test matches against New Zealand or the three A matches there.

"I didn't even know I would get a call for the Sri Lanka tour. Then, I came back to play for Mumbai. I am not able to understand anything (about the future)," an emotional Sarfaraz told reporters at the Brabourne stadium on Monday. "Whenever and wherever I get a chance to play, I will play - whether it is India or India A or Mumbai."

Sarfaraz has shed 22 kilos, becoming much leaner. "No one told me to. I just heard on social media and other places and I started working hard on losing weight," he said.

"I think I was scoring more heavily when I was fat," he joked.

"It's difficult to restart every season. Scoring runs is not easy. I am following the same routines that I did when I started with my abbu (father). Not taking off days in the off-season, practicing. I don't know how many runs I will score. I still work as hard as I did when I started playing Ranji Trophy a decade ago. People know if you want to find Sarfaraz Khan, don't go to his home address, but at the Azad or Cross maidan at 6am," he said. "Sometimes you find success, sometimes not. It's tough. But this is what you have to do, can't do much about."

Mumbai's Sarfaraz Khan in the Ranji match against Railways. PRAKASH PARSEKAR

Asked if he has lost motivation in the journey, Sarfaraz replied, "I ask myself the same question. Why get up at 5am and go for practice?

"I have played for India. With normal effort, I can easily keep playing Ranji Trophy for Mumbai. I am still scoring hundreds. But when I see my father working hard, and him sweating it out, I work hard for him."

At a certain point in time during the interaction, Sarfaraz got despondent. "Everyone knows I don't have support in life," he said. "If anyone has supported me, it's my father. Nobody else. I worked hard and fulfilled my father's dream. I have scored big hundreds to get there. It is not easy to play for India in today's generation."

"The motivation is to keep playing cricket. I think I am made for cricket. I don't like to sit at home," he added, before joining a teammate's cake cutting celebrations.

For a few fleeting moments, Sarfaraz was happy again.

Brief scores:
In Mumbai: Mumbai 247/6 (Angkrish Raghuvanshi 78, Sarfaraz Khan 55; Himanshu Sangwan 3/32) vs Railways.
In Chandigarh: Tamil Nadu 320/4 (N Jagadeesan 52, Pradosh Paul 138*, Baba Indrajith 51) vs Chandigarh.
In Dehradun: Haryana 153 (Mayank Mishra 6/57). Uttarakhand 59/0.
In Dharamsala: Rajasthan 78 (Abhishek Kumar 5/14) & 8/0. Himachal 153 (Ankush Bains 56, Pukhraj Mann 42; Sahil Dhiwan 5/50).
In New Delhi: Services 266 (Rajat Paliwal 110*, Aman Chaudhary 4/79) vs Delhi
In Kolkata: Bengal 143 (Abishek Porel 54, Pradipta Pramanik 31, Pradeep Dadhe 3/45, Tanay Sanghvi 3/42). Maharashtra 21/2 (Mohammed Shami 2/6).
In Ahmedabad: Gujarat 300/5 (Aarya Desai 95, Urvil Patel 63*, Vishal Jayaswal 50*) vs Kerala.
In Bhubaneswar: Jharkhand 37/3 (Rajesh Mohanty 2/15) vs Odisha.
In Guwahati: Tripura: 135 (Ritesh Bhatkal 5/35, Shikhar Shetty 5/53) vs Karnataka 180/2 (Rohan Patil 89, Mayank Agarwal 57*).
In Agartala: Tripura: 219/7 (Sridam Paul 86, Sentu Sarkar 46; Parth Bhut 3/52) vs Saurashtra.
In Mullanpur: Punjab: 276/5 (Salil Arora 111*, Sanvir Singh 100*; K Saiteja 3/65) vs Andhra.
In Secunderabad: Chhattisgarh 279/7 (Anuj Tiwary 72, Vikalp Tiwari 69) vs Hyderabad.
In Nagpur: Madhya Pradesh 209 (Atharva Mahajan 85; Harsh Dubey 9/53) vs Vidarbha 56/4 (Kumar Kartikeya 3/23).
In Kanpur: Baroda 269/6 (Dhruv Patel 124*; Karan Sharma 3/39) vs Uttar Pradesh.
In Panaji: Goa 288/6 (Snehal Kauthankar 116, Abhinav Tejrana 73) vs Bihar.
In Srinagar: Puducherry 261/6 (Neyan Shyam Kangayan 70, Mohit Kale 73; Sunil Kumar 3/59) vs Jammu and Kashmir.

Dhinidhi clinches historic bronze, Khushbu bags silver

Susan Ninan
susan.ninan@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: On Monday, Dhinidhi Desinghu slapped the touchpad, lifted her goggles and looked up at history. The 16-year-old became the first Indian swimmer to win a medal at the Youth Olympic Games. Swimming in lane three in the 100m freestyle final in Dakar, the Bengaluru teen was not in contention at the halfway mark. The race appeared to belong to Turkey, Croatia and New Zealand.

But over the final 15 metres, Dhinidhi summoned a remarkable burst of speed, going past Turkey's Beren Basaran in lane 6, and into Indian swimming history. She won bronze with a timing of 56.27secs, a national record. It bettered her own previous record – 56.57s – set at the Senior National Championships in June. The gold and silver went to Croatia's Ana Bobanovic and New Zealand's Alyssa Lawson, respectively.

Earlier in the day, Dhinidhi topped her heat clocking 56.80s, becoming the first Indian female swimmer to make the Youth Olympics final. The 100m freestyle isn't her primary event.

"It's brilliant that she could win a medal in this event and break her own national record by a sizeable margin. It really puts her in a great position to medal in her main event, the 200m freestyle," coach Nihar Ameen told HT. She holds the national record in the women's 200m freestyle with a timing of 2:01.81, set at the Asian Age Group C'ships in July.

Dhinidhi Desinghu. HT

Most athletes go from the Youth Olympics to the Olympics. Dhinidhi is doing it the other way around. Having competed in Paris at 14, she's competing at the Dakar Youth Olympics at 16, with considerably more experience and greater expectations.

She was the youngest member of the Indian contingent at the 2024 Paris Olympics. "Paris was more of a life experience. I was overwhelmed with so many other things than just what was happening in the pool. I was like a kid at a candy store...Youth Olympics feels more intense, more serious with a lot more expectations and pressure. We've put a lot of work into it. Since it's happening towards the end of the year, all the training was with this competition in mind," Dhinidhi told HT.

Dhinidhi went from hating to be in the water when she was younger to growing to love it and becoming India's fastest female swimmer. Aside from being gifted, for someone still in the weeds of teen years, Dhinidhi comes across as remarkably clear headed. A Class II student, she journals when her thoughts feel overwhelming and mind muddled, and is okay to trade a regular teen life for the path she's chosen.

Silver for judoka

Judoka Khushbu Rajakbhai Darjada (15) claimed a silver, after running into a formidable opponent in Germany's reigning cadet world champion Jolina Reinhold in the women's 63kg final. The Indian who stood just one victory away from a historic gold saw her challenge meet a swift end as Reinhold pinned her to the mat and secured an ippon, walking away with gold.

Thangjam Tababi Devi is India's only other judo medallist at the Youth Olympic Games, her silver coming in the women's 44 kg at the 2018 edition in Buenos Aires.

The curious case of new No. 1 Zverev

The German's numbers are less flattering compared to his recent year-ending No.1 predecessors

Rutvick Mehta
rutvick.mehta@htlive.com

MUMBAI: Rankings, as it is often said in elite sport, don't always reflect the true picture. Sometimes, though, they truly do.

When Temba Bavuma's men dethroned the Australians from the top of the Tests tree, they did so by destroying them on a manic last day of the memorable series. Are South Africa, who swept past India in India and rallied to beat the Aussies at home, the best men's Test team at present? Undoubtedly so.

When Elena Rybakina dethroned Aryna Sabalenka from the top of the WTA chart at this season's last Grand Slam, she backed it up by defeating the two-time defending champion in the final. Is Rybakina, the 2026 US Open winner who also picked up a WTA title in Ningbo, the best women's tennis player at the moment? Hard to argue.

When Alexander Zverev guaranteed his rise to the top of the ATP rankings with a Round of 16 win in Vienna last week, he followed it with a semi-final defeat to Alex de Minaur. Is Zverev, the two-time major winner of a season in which he will end as the world No.1, the best male player currently?

On paper, and on Monday's latest ATP rankings, he sure is. The German French Open and US Open champion became the 30th member in the elite top club after knocking off the 29th, Jannik Sinner. At age 29, Zverev is the second-oldest first-time world No.1 (after John Newcombe in 1974), who scaled the peak four years after first reaching the second position – a nice tick to his perseverance.

On paper, however, some numbers cannot be overlooked.

Zverev's loss in Vienna to de Minaur, the world No.8 Australian who Carlos Alcaraz brushed aside a day later in the final, was his ninth defeat in 12 matches against top 10 opponents so far. The only players in that ranking he has managed to take down this year are Ben Shelton (for the US Open title), Taylor Fritz (at Wimbledon) and de Minaur (in Shanghai). None of them were in the top 5 at that time.

Zverev's losses have come at the hands of de Minaur (twice), Fritz, Alcaraz and Sinner. He is 0-5 against Sinner and 0-1 against Alcaraz this year, having been halted by both in the two Slams that the lanky German did not capture. Sinner and Alcaraz have taken turns to be sidelined at different points this season due to injuries, and the context of their absence was not lost on Zverev himself after winning the US Open.

Asked if he believed he was the world's best player then, he replied, "With Sinner injured and Alcaraz coming back after four months, right now, probably yes. Both of them healthy and both of them at the top of their game? Maybe not."

Zverev, on his part, did well to cash in on the missing younger rivals and finally unlock the Slam triumph he had been craving for years.

And yet, he hasn't quite cashed in to script a dominant season. The kind his year-ending world No.1 predecessors had. Alcaraz finished 2025 as the world No.1 with a 71-9 win-loss statement. Sinner went 73-6 in 2024, and Novak Djokovic signed off 2023 at 56-7.

Zverev's 65-17 record so far, even if it is his most successful season with room to improve the wins in a couple more ATP tournaments, has a lot more losses. Losses also include those to Alexandra Davidovich Fokina, Tommy Paul, Tallon Griekspoor, Luciano Darderi and Miomir Kecmanovic, to name a few of his lower-ranked opponents.

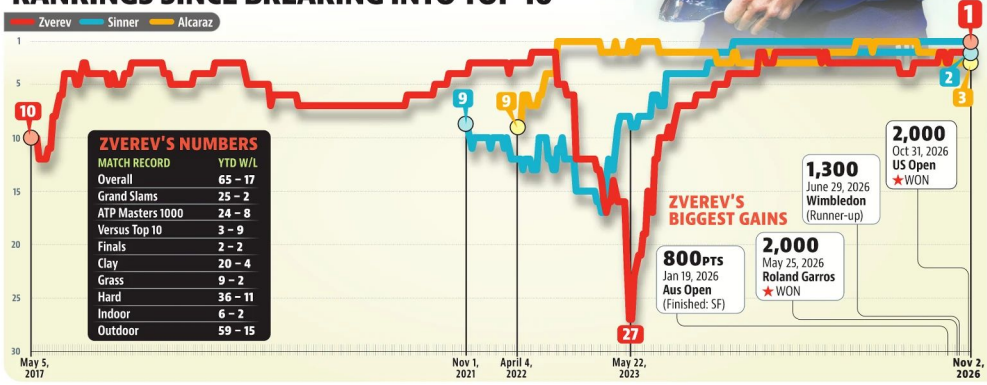
And against top 10 opponents, his 3-9 record sticks out like a sore thumb in comparison to Alcaraz in 2025 (17-4), Sinner in 2024 (18-5) and Djokovic in 2023 (17-3).

What also stands out is the trophies cabinet. Zverev has two titles so far, both through solid Slam shows around patchy performances on the tour. In 2025, Alcaraz had 8 titles, including two Slams and three ATP Masters. Sinner had the same volume in 2024, topping it with the ATP Finals. In 2023, Djokovic had seven titles, sliced into three Slams, two Masters and the ATP Finals cherry.

The season-ending Finals, starting in a couple of weeks, is bound to carry greater significance for Zverev. He is now the world No.1, and will be the world No.1 to close the year. A title at a stage where he is set to run into a pack of top 10 opponents will provide a much-needed stamp to his summit spot.

Alexander Zverev of Germany holds the ATP's World No. 1 trophy on Monday. GETTY IMAGES

RANKINGS SINCE BREAKING INTO TOP 10



Abhishek, Vaibhav named in India A squad for Asia Cup

Press Trust of India
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India opener Abhishek Sharma and teenage batting sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi were on Monday named in a strong 15-member India A squad for the ACC Men's Rising Stars Asia Cup to be held in Doha from November 19 to 29. Tilak Varma will lead the side with Rajat Patidar his deputy, BCCI said in a press release.

The squad also features wicketkeeper-batters Prabhsimran Singh and Kumar Kushagra, along with Rinku Singh, Suryansh Shedge and Shahbaz Ahmed. All-rounders Vipraj Nigam, Harsh Dubey and Tanush Kotian have also been included, while the pace attack comprises Harshit Rana, Prince Yadav and Arshad Khan.

India A have been placed in Group B alongside Pakistan A, Nepal and the United Arab Emirates, while Group A comprises Bangladesh A, Sri Lanka A, Afghanistan A and Hong Kong, China.

India A will open their campaign against Nepal on November 20 before taking on Pakistan A on November 22. Their final group-stage fixture will be against the UAE on November 24.

Tilak Verma to lead. PTI

All three matches will be played in Doha, with the first two scheduled at the West End Park International Stadium and the UAE fixture at the University of Doha for Science and Technology.

The top two teams from each group will qualify for the semifinals, scheduled for November 26 and 27. The final will be played on November 29.

Squad: Abhishek Sharma, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Prabhsimran Singh (wk), Tilak Varma (c), Rajat Patidar (vc), Rinku Singh, Kumar Kushagra (wk), Suryansh Shedge, Shahbaz Ahmed, Vipraj Nigam, Harsh Dubey, Tanush Kotian, Harshit Rana, Prince Yadav, Arshad Khan..

Siraj gets 4, Mukesh takes 5 for India A

CHRISTCHURCH: Mohammed Siraj took four wickets in 35 overs for India A but New Zealand A's lower order showed grit to earn a 78-run first innings lead on the penultimate day of the second unofficial Test. Replying to India A's 346, NZ A, who were 338/8, finished at 424. Siraj took 4/118 while Mukesh Kumar grabbed 5/87. At stumps, India A were 32/0.

India blank South Korea 8-0 in ACT

JALANDHAR: India continued their unbeaten run, staying on course for a title defence by blanking South Korea 8-0 in their fifth and final round-robin match of the Asian Champions Trophy hockey. India finished on top of the standings with a maximum 15 points from five wins, ahead of Japan, Malaysia and South Korea.

Chapman, Ravindra ruled out of ODIs

AUCKLAND: Mark Chapman and Rachin Ravindra have been ruled out of the five-match ODI series against India starting Wednesday, New Zealand Cricket said on Monday. Chapman is undergoing rehabilitation for his hamstring injury while Ravindra is yet to recover from his shoulder niggle.

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1.	HPGCL	OVERHAULING OF FLUE GAS DUCTING, REPLACEMENT OF METALLIC EXPANSION BELLOWS / JOINTS AND REPLACEMENT OF FABRIC COMPENSATOR OF FLUE GAS DUCTS /RAH DUCTS OF BOILER DURING OVERHAULING OF 250 MW UNIT-7 PTPS, PANIPAT	27.10.2026 12.11.2026	1,09,14,579/-	www.hpgcl.org.in https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01802566015 xennptcplg1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO No. 13/2027/40/506981/1/19/7

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1.	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, TOHANA	CONSTRUCTION OF MAHARAJA AGGARSAIN GATE IN MC TOHANA. + 15 WORKS	30.10.2026 06.11.2026	1,86,90,135/-	https:// etenders.hry.nic.in	8930314172 mctohana1@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO No. 13/2027/40/50718/1/19/7

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1	THE SONIPAT CO-OPERATIVE SUGAR MILLS LTD.	RATE CONTRACT OF BOILERS CHEMICALS FOR MAINTAINING PH, AND TDS + 08 OTHER WORK	OPENING CLOSING DATE 11.11.2026	RS. 1,00,00,000/	https:// etenders. hry.nic.in	9996250570 sonipatsugar@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO 13/2027/40/50716/1/19/7

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1.	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, BHIWANI	PAVEMENT OF KACHI BERM (FOOTPATH) BOTH SIDE (ROHTAK GATE TO HANNUMAL PYAU), MC BHIWANI + 6 WORKS	29.10.2026 20.11.2026	3,85,86,625/-	https:// etenders.hry.nic.in	9996629555 me.mcbhiwani@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO No. 13/2027/40/50719/1/19/7

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER & BASIN MANAGER
TEL BASIN, BHABANIPATANA
NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)
32001/1211/2627

"e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE NO.- CE&BM, TEL —P1-07/2026-27
Bid Identification No: CETEL-KLID-02/2026-27

The Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana (WR Department) on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage rate bid in Double Cover system to be received in on ONLINE MODE only for the construction of works as detailed in the table below :-

1	Nature of work	Civil Works
2	Number of works	01 (One)
3	Approximate amount put to tender.	Rs. 9,44,74,172 /-
4	Class of Contractor	'A' & 'Special' Class
5	Period of completion	9(Nine) Calendar months.
6	Date & time of availability of Bid document in the portal	Dt 05.11.2026 -10.00 hours to 26.11.2026 up to 17.00 hours
7	Last date & time of seeking Tender clarification.	Dt. 20.11.2026 up to 17.30 hours
8	Last date & time of Receipt of Bids in the portal	Dt. 26.11.2026 - up to 17.00 hours
9.	Date ,time & place of opening of Technical bids of Double Cover.	Dt. 27.11.2026 at 11.00 hours- in the office of the Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana

The bidders have to participate in online bidding only. The website for online bidding is http://www.tendersodisha.gov.in.

Chief Engineer & Basin Manager
Tel Basin, Bhabanipatana
OIPR - 32001/32317/1/26-27/0013

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA — TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP/ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1.	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF AYURVEDIC MEDICINES FOR DH, CHC, PHC, GAD AND HOSPITALS IN THE STATE OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS.	30.10.2026 20.11.2026	31,48,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	0172-478822 hmsctenders@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO. 13/2027/40/50696/1/19/7

Addendum/Corrigendum

कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता :- मध्य प्रदेश राज्य आपदा प्रबंधन प्राधिकरण, ई -5 पर्यावरण परिसर अरेरा कॉलोनी भोपाल

ई निविदा क्रमांक :- **Tender ID: 2026_502243_1**

"Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning & Training of Disaster Preparedness, Capacity Building, Emergency Response and Control Room Display Infrastructure" हेतु ई-निविदा पोर्टल **https://mptenders.gov.in** पर Tender ID: 2026_502243_1 के अंतर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की गई है।

उक्त निविदा के संबंध में Addendum/Corrigendum जारी किया गया है, जिसे ई-निविदा पोर्टल **https://mptenders.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है। निविदा प्रस्तुत करने की अंतिम तिथि 04 नवंबर 2026 निर्धारित है।

उप-संचालक
G-20899/26 म.प्र. राज्य आपदा प्रबंधन प्राधिकरण

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER
ANUGOLA IRRIGATION CIRCLE, ANUGOLA, ODISHA, PIN — 759143
email :aceanguliricircle@gmail.com
Government of Odisha "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
Bid Identification No. ACEAIC- 06 /2026-27
32001/1208/2627

Sl. No.	Name of work	Tendered Amount	Class of Contractor	Period of completion	Date and Time of availability of bid document in the portal	Last date/time for receipt of bid in the portal	Name & Address of the Officer Inviting Bid
01	Flood Protection to Left bank of river Mankada from Shiva temple to Sasan Sahi of Pallahara under .Pallahara Block.	Rs. 379.32 Lakh	"A"	08(Eight Calendar Months)	03.11.2026 at 10.00 AM	18.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM	Additional Chief Engineer, Anugola Irrigation Circle, Anugola
02	Renovation and Modernization of Mordang Minor, Ratakhandi Minor and Basantapur Minor in Gohira Right Canal System under Debagada Irrigation Division, Debagada	Rs.482.17 lakh	"A"	08(Eight Calendar Months)	03.11.2026 at 10.00 AM	18.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM	

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal http://tendersodisha.gov.in.
Any corrigendum/ addendum/cancellation will be displayed in the Govt.Website only.

Additional Chief Engineer, Anugola Irrigation Circle, Anugola
OIPR - 32001/32081/1/26-27/0007

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER , UPPER INDRAVATI PROJECT
AT/PO: MUKHIGUDA DIST:KALAHANDI , ODISHA, PIN: 766026
e-mail address : ceeup1987@gmail.com / louipobsr@gmail.com
32001/1219/2627

1. Type of Work : Road Works
2. Total No. of Works : 02 nos
3. Approximate value of work : Rs. 894.44 lakhs to Rs.834.42 lakhs (Excluding GST)
4. Tender Paper Cost : Rs. 10,000/- (online)
5. Bid Security / E.M.D : Rs.8,04,500/- to Rs.8,34,500/-(Online)
6. Period of Completion : 18 (Eighteen Calendar months).
7. Class of Contractor : "A" & Special Class

Procurement Officer	e- procurement Notice No.	Bid Amount	Availability of online viewing of Tender prior to Bidding From	To	Period for seeking tender clarification	Submission & Availability bid on-line	Date & time of opening of Technical Bid
1	2		3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Upper Indravati Project, AT/PO - Mukhiguda, Dist - Kalahandi, Odisha, Pin - 766026	CCE, UIP-16/(02)/2026-27, Dt. 27.10.2026	Rs 80443737/ - to Rs 83442198/- (Excluding GST)	02.11.2026 (10.00 AM)	18.11.2026 (up to 5.30 PM)	02.11.2026 to 07.11.2026 during office hours.	02.11.2026 (10.00 AM) to 18.11.2026 (up to 5.30PM)	19.11.2026 at 11.00 AM

Date of opening of technical bid : Dt-19.11.2026 at 11.00 AM in the O/O the Chief Construction Engineer, UIP, Mukhiguda, Kalahandi, Odisha, PIN-766026. Date of opening of financial bid : To be decided after finalization of Technical Bid. Further details can be seen from the Govt. Website www.tendersorissa.gov.in

Chief Construction Engineer, Upper Indravati Project, Mukhiguda
OIPR - 32001/32352/1/26-27/0020

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NATIONAL COOPERATIVE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION
A Statutory Organization under Ministry of Cooperation, Govt. of India
4, Siri Institutional Area, Hauz Khas, New Delhi-110016

ADVT. NO. 06/2026-A & ADVT. No. 10/2026

National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC), a Statutory Corporation of Govt. of India under the Ministry of Cooperation, invites applications from eligible persons for the following posts on direct recruitment basis:-

1. Vacancy 1: Financial Adviser (Advt. No. 06/2026-A)
Remuneration : CTC based, negotiable as per market standards (Remuneration/Pay Compensation will not be a limiting factor for a deserving candidate and can be negotiated in consideration to the last/current CTC drawn)

2. Vacancy 2: Executive Director (General Management) (Advt. No. 10/2026)
Remuneration : CTC based, negotiable as per market standards (Remuneration/Pay Compensation will not be a limiting factor for a deserving candidate and can be negotiated in consideration to the last/current CTC drawn)

For information related to eligibility criteria or other terms and conditions of recruitment, interested candidates may visit NCDC website www.ncdc.in

LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF APPLICATION: 15 NOVEMBER, 2026
Candidates who have already submitted their applications for the post of Financial Adviser in response to Advertisement No. 06/2026 dated 15.07.2026 are not required to apply afresh.

नगर निगम मुरादाबाद

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10% छूट
वर्तमान बिल की मांग पर
15 नवंबर 2026 तक लाभ उठाएं।

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#Offer applicable on both, EMI and Non-EMI transactions. ^Valid on Non-EMI transactions done on Pinelabs EDC Machines only. *Terms & Conditions apply. Offers are not valid on SBI / Tata Corporate Card, Cashback SBI Card, Paytm SBI Card and Rupay Credit Card transactions done via UPI. Offers are valid on Flipkart SBI Card only on POS transactions. Offer details and dates are subject to change without prior notice. Above offers are valid on EMI transactions (6 months & above tenures only) done through select EMI aggregators (Pinelabs / Innoviti / Benow / Paytm (PPSL) / Ezetap / Razorpay) under 'Brand EMI' option & only if Instant Discount / Cashback is mentioned on charge slip. Customers are requested to retain charge slip for 180 days post program end date. The interest amount chargeable in the 1st EMI will be calculated for the period between EMI booking date and the Payment Due Date (PDD). Interest will be levied for a 30-day period 2nd EMI onwards. Above Offers are valid on one transaction per card per month.

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